六级
听力

CET-6 LISTENING

六级听力 听写本

2026—2018 · 共 30 套真题原文

每句挖出一个关键词，边听边写

朋克英语 出品

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2026年6月 第2套

听写本

怎么用这本听写本

① 先听一段录音（或看配套视频），边听边把横线处的单词写出来，编号对应答案本；② 写不出来的先空着，第二遍再听；③ 对照《听写本（答案）》改正，错的词抄进生词本，第二天再默一遍。

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hi Frank, are you working through your lunch hour again? No, not at all. It's my tenth wedding anniversary next week, and I promised Jane that I would book a city break for us, as I have annual leave to take, and it would be nice to [1]_____ somewhere warm. So I'm trying to book something in [2]_____. That sounds so romantic. I adore Barcelona. It's such a fabulous cosmopolitan city. There's so much to do there. Excellent food and that [3]_____ that they are still building after about 150 years. Very cool. I know, but the anniversary is [4]_____, and I'm still scrambling to find accommodation. Everything is either [5]_____ expensive or already fully booked. I'm starting to feel a bit frantic. Well, if you are going for a whole week, why don't you do a couple of nights in somewhere really [6]_____, and then do the rest of the week a bit further up the coast, where the accommodation is cheaper, and that will offset the cost of the expensive place. That might be a good plan. It's not too expensive to [7]_____ a car, so we could still drive into the city. Yes, there are lots of places outside the city that have [8]_____ and are all inclusive, so we wouldn't even need to pay for food or drinks. I'll send a [9]_____ now about the dates we're interested in. That sounds perfect. I'm sure that Jane will be absolutely thrilled to bits. I really do recommend visiting that cathedral. You can go all the way up to the top of it, but you need to go up a really steep spiral [10]_____ to get there. Considering Jane is terrified of heights, I think if I tried to make her do that, I would come back [11]_____. Thanks for the help, though it was turning into a [12]_____ nightmare.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Hey there, Paul. How's it going? Hi, Suzanne. Just keeping busy with the usual stuff: filling prescriptions, talking to patients about their [1]_____, that kind of thing. How about you? Same here. Although I

did have an interesting case come in this morning. A patient came in [2]_____ about a medication that had a potential interaction with another medication she was already taking. Oh, that's always tricky. What did you do? I explained the issue to her as best I could, and [3]_____ she double check with her doctor. And you know what? She actually followed my advice, and the doctor ended up switching the patient's [4]_____. Ah, that's great! You must feel quite accomplished. Totally, these moments are the highlights of my routine work, employing my [5]_____ expertise to the benefit of people's health and well-being. I fully agree. Unfortunately, the opposite is true when the patient is too [6]_____ and they refuse to listen to us. So true. In other developments, we've had a lot of people coming in to get their flu shots, which is always good to see. Good, good. I've been working on a new [7]_____ therapy management program for our patients with chronic conditions. It helps patients manage their [8]_____ more effectively. That sounds interesting. We review all of their medications and make sure that they're taking them as [9]_____. We also look for any potential drug [10]_____ or side effects. Patient response has so far been very positive. Some have reported seeing improvements in their health, which is really [11]_____ to see. That's great to hear. Do you use text message reminders? Yes, absolutely. It's a great idea. [12]_____ non-adherence is a big problem, especially for older patients. We're still in the early stages of the program, but I'm [13]_____ that it will make a real difference for our patients.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

In America, at least, [1]_____ is a word that often comes up on job descriptions and in interviews. On the whole, passionate people are thought of in a positive light and considered likely to achieve their goals, but when it comes to predicting achievement, has the importance of passion been [2]_____? According to a new study from Stanford University, passion may be less important in certain cultures, and the fact that passion is often seen as a key to achievement may reflect a [3]_____ Western model of motivation. The chief factor explored in the study was how [4]_____ a society was. In [5]_____ cultures, the researchers assert, people are more motivated by pursuing paths related to their passions, but those in collectivistic cultures are more likely to see themselves as part of a network. They often place [6]_____ obligations to others above focusing on their own interests. The [7]_____ looked at

data from nearly 60 countries. They found that in science subjects, passion was positively [8]_____ with academic achievements. Higher levels of enjoyment and interest also [9]_____ test scores, but the strength of this correlation wasn't the same across cultures. Those in [10]_____ societies such as the U.S., Australia, and the U.K. showed a stronger link between passion and achievement, the effect of passion on performance was more subtle for those in more collectivistic societies such as Colombia or Thailand. These findings were mirrored in achievement in both [11]_____ and reading. It's clear from the findings that passion isn't the only thing that [12]_____ people to achieve their goals.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Why does nature create patterns? The reason patterns often appear in nature is simple: the same basic physical or chemical processes occur in many patterned substances and [1]_____ as they form. Whether in plants and animals or rocks, foams, and ice crystals, the [2]_____ patterns that happen in nature come down to what's happening at the level of atoms and molecules. A pattern in nature is any regularly repeated [3]_____ of shapes or colors. Some of the most striking examples include the six-sided arrays of rocks at Giant's Causeway in the United Kingdom, and the colorful [4]_____ and spots on tropical fish. Patterns like these begin to form at a small scale when materials undergo processes like drying, freezing, [5]_____, diffusing, and reacting. Those changes then give rise to complex [6]_____ at a larger scale that people can see. Imagine [7]_____ frozen crystals on a window during winter. What creates that pattern? When water freezes, its [8]_____ begin clustering together. Water [9]_____ have a particular bent shape that causes them to stack into clusters as they freeze. As the cluster grows, many outside factors, including [10]_____ and temperature, begin to affect its overall shape. If the water is freezing on a window, for example, random [11]_____ on the glass surface affect the stacking and create the larger pattern. But [12]_____ do not always know the purpose of a pattern, or even if there is one. The [13]_____ processes involved are simple enough that they might generate a pattern by coincidence.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Many people, myself included, have multiple areas of life they would like to [1]_____. For example, I would like to reach more people with my writing, to lift heavier weights at the gym, and to start practicing [2]_____ more consistently. Those are just a few of the goals I find [3]_____, and you probably have a long list yourself. The problem is, even if we are committed to working hard on our goals, our natural [4]_____ is to return to our old habits at some point. Making a permanent [5]_____ change is really difficult. Recently, I've come across a few studies that will make these difficult [6]_____ changes a bit easier. As you'll see, however, the approach to mastering many areas of life is somewhat [7]_____. Research has shown that you are two to three times more likely to stick with your [8]_____ if you make a specific plan for when, where, and how you will perform the behavior. For example, in one study, scientists asked people to fill out a sentence to specify during the next week they would do at least 20 minutes of [9]_____ exercise on which day, at what time of day, and at or in what place. [10]_____ found that people who filled out this sentence were two to three times more likely to actually exercise compared to a control group who did not make plans for their future behavior. [11]_____ call these specific plans implementation intentions because they state when, where, and how you intend to implement a particular behavior. However, follow-up research has discovered [12]_____ intentions only work when you focus on one thing at a time. In fact, [13]_____ found that people who tried to accomplish multiple goals were less committed and less likely to succeed than those who focused on a single goal. Another science-based reason to focus on one thing at a time is that when you begin practicing a new habit, it requires a lot of [14]_____ effort to remember to do it. After a while, however, the [15]_____ of behavior becomes easier. Eventually, your new habit becomes a normal routine, and the process is more or less [16]_____ and automatic. The most important thing to note is that there is some tipping point at which new [17]_____ become more or less automatic. The time it takes to build a habit depends on many factors, including how difficult the habit is, your [18]_____, and more.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

It was a lazy, [1]_____, crazy day on the dwarf planet Pluto when New Horizons, a spacecraft from Earth, flew by at a speed of 31,000 miles per hour two years ago. The spacecraft took a bunch of photos, made some quick measurements of Pluto's atmosphere, and sent them all back here, giving [2]_____ scientists their first up close look of the distant dwarf planet. One of the more bizarre things they found was that the [3]_____ in Pluto's atmosphere was much thicker than previously thought. The planet also had an atmosphere much cooler than earlier estimates, topping out at minus 333.4 degrees [4]_____. Now, a study published in Nature links those two [5]_____ observations. A computer model developed by planetary scientist Xi Zhang and colleagues shows the haze of tiny [6]_____ in the upper atmosphere is likely scattering light from the sun, preventing heat from reaching the planet below. We see hazy skies on Earth too, from time to time, whenever solid particles get suspended in the air, from water-based fogs to ash from fires to the toxic [7]_____ that make up a thick smog, but on Earth the overall temperature of the planet is dominated by the distribution of gases in our atmosphere. On [8]_____, the authors suggest haze might be more influential. [9]_____ can reflect light from the sun here on Earth. It happens after volcanoes [10]_____, emitting clouds of particles that reflect the sun's rays into the atmosphere. Some people even propose [11]_____ this phenomenon to alleviate the effects of climate change. But our planet isn't [12]_____ by that process, or at least it hasn't been for a few billion years. If Pluto's atmosphere is very different from ours and from that of other nearby planets, it could help scientists expand their understanding of [13]_____ atmospheres. But right now, this is just a good guess based on data from New Horizons and a [14]_____ computer model, not direct observations of the haze's composition. There are other theories floating around to explain Pluto's cool temperatures, including blaming the cold air on gases in the [15]_____. Luckily, the authors will get a chance to test their notions when the James Webb Space [16]_____ launches later. That observatory can detect different spectrums of light, which the [17]_____ plutonian atmosphere would be positively glowing with as it scattered sunlight. The researchers just have to wait and see if the light from the telescope [18]_____ their bright idea.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Parents have a small window where they can influence their eight to 10-year-old children's music [1]_____. Researchers have concluded, the 24-month time frame comes at an age when youngsters are old enough to appreciate poetic lyrics and [2]_____ tunes, but have not yet started to be embarrassed by their mother and father's preferences. Dr. Hauke Egermann, a [3]_____ in music at the University of York, carried out a literature review into more than a dozen studies looking at parental musical influence. Children have an [4]_____ to new music, and this means parents have an important role to play in developing the musical preferences of their kids," he said. However, time is of the essence, as [5]_____ influence is most likely to be effective during the critical time period before age 10. During [6]_____, children tend to gravitate away from their parents' choices and are more influenced by their peers. A separate survey of 2,000 British parents by music streaming service Deezer also found that nearly four fifths of parents agreed that their children were far more [7]_____ to their musical suggestions before the age of 10. In contrast, just 10% of parents reported positive reactions from their [8]_____ children when they shared their favourite music. Some 79% of fathers said they had tried to [9]_____ their children's music, but just 69% of mothers. However, mothers were more effective, with 38% reporting that their kids loved the [10]_____ they shared, compared to 30% of dads who, in some cases, said their children cried or even fell asleep. Dr. Egermann claims introducing children to a variety of musical styles is the key to [11]_____ good taste in later life. By playing children a variety of genres before this critical period, research on [12]_____ suggests they will enjoy lots of different types of music as adults. He added, the benefits of having a wider taste in music include the ability to manage their emotions more effectively, [13]_____ and bond with others more easily, and to have a better understanding of other cultures as well. Dr. Egermann [14]_____ parents not to push their favourite music too hard on their children, but instead play it as background music while a child is playing. They can also help create positive memories about artists and bands by going to [15]_____ and live music events together.

2026年6月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Welcome to Business Matters. Today we have invited career development [1]_____ Lucy Williams to talk about how to get ahead at work. Hi, Lucy. Many of us never seem to get [2]_____. Why is that, and what can we do about it? One [3]_____ people make is to limit communication only to their bosses. It's important to expand your network and include your [4]_____. But some of our [5]_____ are less senior to us. Is it really necessary to connect with them? It's important not to underestimate your colleagues. Sometimes a job title might not clearly [6]_____ the influence they may have. Now many of us think that working hard creates a good [7]_____, but this isn't always true, is it? That's right. We should avoid trying to take on too much work and [8]_____ staying late just to show that you are committed. I see. So setting [9]_____ too high at the beginning can make us look bad if we don't maintain them. Yeah, it's better to make sure you are putting in quality time instead of just a large [10]_____ of time, and these efforts can easily be demonstrated by the results we achieve. What about helping others at work? Should you try and go beyond your normal [11]_____ and offer to help people with their projects? Extend your assistance to those who need it, but only as long as your own work will not go [12]_____. If someone can benefit from your [13]_____ or advice, help them out to gain their respect and trust. But it goes without saying that you shouldn't act like a know-it-all; otherwise, you'll appear [14]_____. Absolutely, be [15]_____, and you'll get a lot of time later on to show your genius.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

I think we first need to decide how to divide up the [1]_____ responsibilities. From what I recall, the [2]_____ consists of five parts, not including the introduction and conclusion. That would mean altogether we need to [3]_____ seven parts between the two of us. So we have the [4]_____, background research, the project design, the results, and the discussion portions. As the [5]_____ section only applies to the article, we needn't include it in the presentation. How would you [6]_____ we dole out

the rest? How do you feel about handling the [7] _____ bit? In this way, we can both [8] _____ the part of the project that we devoted most of our time to. Hold on a minute. You want me, the one who did the [9] _____ of the task, to also do the majority of the presentation. The background research, which was so [10] _____, took more than a month. Okay, okay, I get it. Quit your moaning. I appreciate the rigorous work ethic you applied to the research, but not the [11] _____ that comes up every time I mention it. What do you think would be a fair [12] _____? I think the best arrangement would be to split the research into two parts: before 1980 and [13] _____. I will take the before portion, and you would be [14] _____ the after 1980, leaving the project and results. I [15] _____ to describe the project, but as I struggled a bit with the statistics in the results section, how about you handling that? That's agreeable to me. I propose we both handle the discussion section in parts, along with the question and answer [16] _____, leaving only the introduction and conclusion. I will take responsibility for the [17] _____ and put you in charge of the introduction. This will make it so that we alternate presenting, so as to avoid sounding [18] _____ to the audience.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Makeup can do more than just change your appearance; it can also [1] _____ others' perceptions of you, for better or for worse. According to new research from the University of Stirling in Scotland, although both men and women [2] _____ women who wear makeup as being of a higher status, men associate makeup with prestigious positive qualities, while women view other women wearing makeup as being dominant and a potential threat. The research showed that men and women both rated the faces with [3] _____ as being more attractive, but only women rated made-up faces as being more dominant, while only men rated made-up faces as being higher in prestige. A follow-up study investigated the root cause behind these differences in perception, and found that female-on-female [4] _____ seemed to be the main cause for the differences in perception. Women rating women with makeup said they would be more jealous of them and thought they would be more attractive to men than their non-makeup-wearing [5] _____. Cosmetic products are good for more than just giving you a pretty face, it can be particularly useful for women to understand how wearing makeup alters others' perceptions of them in situations where they are trying to gain others' trust and

[6] _____. At a job interview, knowing whether the hiring committee will consist of men or women might influence a female candidate's decision about wearing [7] _____. Whether the [8] _____ will view her as attractive, dominant, and prestigious can affect the interviewer's actions and perhaps the outcome of the interview itself.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

You may have seen advertisements trumpeting methods of changing a habit that require absolutely no [1] _____ whatsoever. But can you really change a bad habit or create a good one without [2] _____? To answer this question, we first have to ask, what is [3] _____? Most people, sadly, think of it only as the ability to [4] _____ their teeth and resist attractive temptations. In this view, [5] _____ means self-denial and no fun. No wonder people hope to make changes without it. I define willpower as using only the thought of your [6] _____ to control your actions. Let's say your [7] _____ are prevent diabetes and reach a healthy weight. So, if you are at the all-you-can-eat buffet, you think about your [8] _____, avoid diabetes through weight loss, and you take small portions and avoid the dessert table. So, amazingly enough, [9] _____ begins with a thought, a bright idea, some way to improve your life or contribute to others. This bright idea is your motivator. Dr. Walter Mitchell, an expert on [10] _____ skills, uses the expressive term, a burning goal. Whether you call it a [11] _____, a burning goal, or a bright idea, this idea is the force behind your willpower. What sort of bright ideas [12] _____ make for effective willpower? In fact, any goal that you value strongly counts. The list may include good health, self-respect, a better future for your family, personal mission, and being a role model for your child. All these can certainly drive a positive change.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

For many pregnant women, understanding what [1] _____ is safe and healthy, and what should be avoided because of mercury concerns comes with a lot of worrying. In part, that's because the federal government's advice on the matter, first issued in 2004, has long been [2] _____ as vague. That guidance has included advice on how much seafood to eat, and which species pregnant and [3] _____ women should avoid

over concerns about mercury contamination. But critics say the government advisory has done more harm than good, scaring many pregnant and [4]_____ women away from eating seafood altogether. The problem is real, according to a [5]_____ for the Food and Drug Administration, or FDA for short. The agency analyzed fish consumption data from more than 1,000 pregnant women in the U.S. and found that 21% of them ate no fish whatsoever in the previous month, and those who did eat fish consumed far less than recommended by the dietary [6]_____. Some 50% ate less than two [7]_____ a week, and 75% ate less than four ounces. This week, the FDA issued an update to the advice, listing more than 60 species in a chart that [8]_____ fish as a best choice, good choice, and choices to avoid. The goal is to make it easier for mothers to be to feel confident about the type of [9]_____ they include in their diets. The new advice recommends consumers choose a variety of fish to eat, and it comes with an easy-to-understand illustration of what an appropriate portion size should be: four [10]_____ for an adult, and two ounces for children aged four to seven. And while [11]_____ mothers have long been warned to stay away from shark and four other particular types of fish from the Gulf of Mexico, now there are three new species on the list of what to avoid, but not everyone is thrilled with the new advice. [12]_____ say the new advice doesn't always agree with the agency's own scientific findings. While mercury is of great concern when people are talking about pregnant women and [13]_____, it's not the only factor contributing to anxiety. The FDA maintains that its final consumption recommendations were based on [14]_____ scientific analysis. Agency [15]_____ Cassell says the FDA believes the recommendations will increase confidence, not uncertainty. But critics disagree. They think the FDA's advice is not based on the evidence in its own detailed report, and so it [16]_____ everyone.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

know you're busy with work, but you also need to take some time off to [1]_____ those batteries. So, should you plan one big [2]_____ for the year, or should you take multiple short vacations throughout? Quantity can sometimes beat quality. First and foremost, regardless of how you use your [3]_____ days, you need to be using them and soon. The longer you put off your time off, the worse you're making things for yourself. One 9-year-long study published in [4]_____ Medicine suggests not taking at least one

vacation a year may increase your risk of mortality due to heart disease. So, not only are you killing your joy, you're [5]_____ killing yourself. Give yourself a break, folks. When you should take those breaks, however, depends on a few factors: how many days you have available to use, what activities bring you joy, whether you have a family or not, and other [6]_____ come into play. Because of that, there's no perfect [7]_____ that works for everyone, but there are still a few things everyone can try to shoot for. We know that in terms of [8]_____ relaxation, you should aim for vacations that range somewhere between seven and 11 days long. That gives you enough time to let go of your stress at work, completely loosen up, and achieve full-on [9]_____. That above-mentioned study also recommends you space out your vacations [10]_____ instead of using up all of your days at once. Eight days might sound like a lot for someone who only gets 10 days of vacation a year, but if you frame them with weekends, you can manage two evenly [11]_____ 8-day vacations a year. If you have 14 days of paid leave, that's almost three separate 8-day [12]_____ you can use to split your year into thirds. As [13]_____ as it might be to use all your days to take one long summer break, your overall goal should be to achieve the perfect balance between length plus joy and frequency. Vacation frequency is important because planning multiple breaks throughout the year means you always have something to look forward to planning things and the [14]_____ that comes with it tends to make us happier. If you only take one long vacation every year, the excitement builds much more slowly and seems so far off that it can actually lead to feelings of [15]_____.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

[1]_____ cars that can take over from drivers if they are tired or caught in the heat of an argument are being developed in Sweden. Researchers working as part of the European Union's 77 billion euro research program are developing sensor-based systems that monitor whether a driver is [2]_____, anxious, or tired. If a driver is not in a fit state to be on the road, the car automatically takes control of the [3]_____ to prevent accidents. Dr. Anna Anund from the Swedish National Road and Transport Research Institute, who is leading the project, said a driver's state can be measured using a number of sensors, including heart rate monitors and eye sensors, which track where a driver's [4]_____ is. She said the aim was to really make sure that the transition from the driver to the vehicle is done in a safe way, so we can take into consideration the driver's

state, and so we do not give control to a driver who is under pressure of [5]_____, stress, anxiety, and so on. According to data from the European Commission, Sweden has the safest roads in the EU, with the UK a close second. However, the number of road accidents in both has [6]_____ leveled out since 2010. Driver [7]_____ is thought to be responsible for as many as a fifth of road crashes across the EU, although there are certain times of the day when more accidents happen. At 6 a.m., for example, drivers are said to be 20 times more likely to have an accident than at 10 a.m. While most experts agree [8]_____ technology should help bring down accident numbers in the long term, some have questioned whether it is safe. The researchers have said the technology they are developing is seeking to bridge the gap between level three on the [9]_____ scale, in which drivers have to be ready to take control of the car at any point, and level four, in which driving is automated. Daniel Ruiz, the chief executive of the UK's connected and [10]_____ vehicle program Meridian, said, "There is a strong debate going on about how it is possible to make a level three car completely safe.". Despite advances in technology, we still have some way to go in shifting public [11]_____. With an increase in attention-grabbing [12]_____ recently, drivers now view self-driving cars as less safe than they used to.

2025年12月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

I must say, I love our canteen. It's such a great meeting point. Yeah, it really is, both for students and teachers. Shame about the food. What do you mean? I think the food is fine. I would say the food is just okay, but the prices are [1]_____. Don't you agree? I don't actually. I personally think they're perfectly appropriate. If it's [2]_____, why does it get so frantically busy at lunch times? Hmm. You make a good point. I guess a lot of it is good value, maybe even most of it. However, don't you think six bucks for a slice of apple [3]_____ is beyond most students' budgets? Ah, yes. Desserts are overpriced. I'll give you that. To be honest, I've forgotten about those as I never eat them. I never really crave sweet things or any fancy [4]_____. What I always go for is their scrambled eggs. They have such a great variety. Yeah, those are good. They also come out really fast. Actually, that's one of the best things about the [5]_____: the speed. If I fancy something more substantial than a sandwich, but I don't have much time for lunch, the university [6]_____ is always a good option. The kitchen staff work at such a [7]_____ pace; they really deserve to be complimented for it. Totally, and it's such a great environment too. Like the entire building is beautiful. It is very nice. The [8]_____ glass windows make all the difference. I think they're so cool. Apparently, they did a massive [9]_____ a few years ago. It cost them a pretty penny. I'm not surprised. It's a very [10]_____ space, suitable both for eating and relaxing, and for working. You're right, working too. I've used my [11]_____ there once or twice, and there's always a group project or meeting going on at the far end.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Hi Tony. Today we're talking about how managers can get along better with young people at work. We often hear young people today have a poor work ethic. That's not really justified, though, is it? Not really. In reality, young people of this age group are as varied and [1]_____ as any other generation. Yeah, but if you are struggling to work with young people in your [2]_____, what can you do? Well, it's [3]_____ to connect with them to learn about their values. It's also really important to [4]_____ the way young

people want to balance their work life with their personal life. So they generally don't want to [5] _____ happiness in return for career advancement. Absolutely, they are not willing to sacrifice their personal lives for their work lives, and this leads people to equate that with an [6] _____ to work hard. Right, but that couldn't be further from the truth, could it? Young people will work extremely hard during their [7] _____ work hours, but they expect to have their time off, like weekends and nights, free from work. So, how should managers go about [8] _____ young people's productivity? Generally, young people believe their productivity should not be measured by the number of hours they work, since someone can work for eight hours and [9] _____ next to nothing of significance for the company. Instead, young people measure their [10] _____ levels by the quality of the work they perform. But we often hear that young people want to feel more than just being a part of a big machine. Such a perspective can be hard to [11] _____, can't it? It's important to legitimize their work. Young workers want to work on projects that matter to themselves, the company, or the world at large. They must feel the need to stay working at a company whose values align with their own. Thanks for your advice.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Many restaurants are trying to persuade customers to eat more [1] _____, moving away from environmentally unfriendly meat towards greener dishes. Although it sounds [2] _____, restaurants which include specific vegetarian sections on their menus may be unintentionally encouraging customers to eat meat, a new study suggests. [3] _____ scientist Linda Bacon, one of the study's authors, said, "Restaurants can have a positive impact on the environment by encouraging their customers to choose more plant-based food and less meat." However, our findings suggest that while certain restaurant menu designs can encourage some [4] _____ to make pro-environmental food choices, they can have the opposite effect on others. The study involved 750 people, half of whom frequently ate [5] _____ food and half of whom rarely ate it. No vegetarians were included. They were given different [6] _____ and asked to choose a meal as if they were eating out with friends. Placing vegetarian dishes in a separate section did not have a significant effect on the choices made by [7] _____ vegetarian food eaters, but it did have a notable effect on the frequent eaters, lowering their chance of picking a vegetarian option by 65 percent. The researchers also

discovered that presenting a vegetarian dish as the chef's recommendation, or including a more appealing description of a non-meat meal, leads to a greater proportion of [8] _____ vegetarian eaters choosing a vegetarian option, but again, these altered menu designs backfired with those who ate vegetarian food more frequently, leading them to be less likely to choose a vegetarian dish.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Nottingham Trent University and the Chinese Academy of Sciences have been trying to find a way to prevent deadly outdoor air pollution from [1] _____ indoors. They found that if pollution is frozen to around minus 18 degrees Celsius in a [2] _____ tube, the particles gather together and fall to the bottom, allowing fresh, clean air to pass through. Their method was able to remove 99% of [3] _____. It is hoped that the work could pave the way for simple modification of air conditioning units, so that they can also clean [4] _____ indoor air. Outdoor air pollution in cities is a global problem, whether it be [5] _____ plaguing Kolkata or poor air impacting the health of children in London schools. While there are some existing technologies to [6] _____ indoor air, they can be inefficient, expensive, or produce harmful by-products. When outdoor air quality is poor, people tend to spend even more time [7] _____, but outdoor pollution also leads to indoor pollution, and people still suffer. It is estimated that [8] _____ is linked to over 40,000 early deaths in Britain each year. Professor Gang Pan of the Chinese Academy of Sciences said, "We have shown in our experiments that simply by circulating polluted air through a small freezing chamber, we can remove most of the fine particles and gas [9] _____. Our study makes it possible to add an air cleaner option to household [10] _____ in areas which might experience extremely poor air conditions. By controlling indoor air pollution and improving air quality in this way, this work could be greatly [11] _____ to public health.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Research recently carried out by my team [1] _____ that fish may be self-aware. A certain species of fish recently passed the well-known mirror test. This is a test that [2] _____ self-recognition in animals. Only a few animals, such as humans, [3] _____, dolphins, and some birds can recognize themselves in a mirror,

and only these animals capable of self-recognition will attempt to remove marks placed on their skin after noticing them in the reflection. This ability suggests a level of higher intelligence and [4]_____. This is not shown by children until around 18 months. Until now, no fish has demonstrated the ability, but our experiments show the fish in question will [5]_____ up against hard surfaces to remove marks placed on its body by our researchers after viewing itself in a mirror. The behaviors we observe leave little doubt that this fish [6]_____ fulfills all criteria of the mirror test as originally laid out. The fish in our study never attempted to remove the marks when no [7]_____ was present, or when the marks were just placed on the mirror. [8]_____ fish also did not attempt to remove marks from themselves when interacting with a marked fish on the other side of a window. These results show either that fish are self-aware, or that the mirror test, which is considered to be the gold standard test used to [9]_____ higher intelligence, may be flawed. What is less clear is whether these behaviours should be considered as evidence that fish are self-aware, even though in the past these same behaviours have been [10]_____ as self-awareness in so many other animals. Depending on your position, you might reject the interpretation that these behaviours in a fish satisfy passing the test at all, but on what objective basis can you do this when the behaviours they show are so [11]_____ similar to those of other species that have passed the test? Results from our research [12]_____ more questions than answers. What if self-awareness develops like an [13]_____, building layer upon layer, rather than appearing all at once. Perhaps, in order to explore self-awareness further, we should stop looking at responses to the mirror as a [14]_____ test. Only with a richer theory of the self and a larger test battery will we be able to [15]_____ all of the various levels of self-awareness, including where exactly fish fit in.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Reading with a young child is important, but does it matter whether you read from an electronic book or traditional [1]_____? As any parent knows, small children are generally keen on screens, so the finding from a new study that very young children enjoy electronic books more than [2]_____ picture books may not come as a huge surprise. But the following additional findings might: both parents and children [3]_____ differently when reading electronic versus printed picture books, and the children who read the electronic books

learned more. Previous studies of young children have suggested that electronic books, which incorporate extra features such as dictionaries and images that [4]_____ story events, may have advantages over print. In fact, multiple studies have found that electronic books support story [5]_____ and vocabulary gains beyond what is provided by printed books. But there's also work suggesting that children sometimes invest less mental effort in learning from [6]_____ books, and that parents talk less about content when sharing such books. The study we're looking at today aims to give us a better understanding of how good [7]_____ books are for young children. For this study, [8]_____ videoed children aged 17 to 26 months reading with one of their parents. Each parent and child pair was randomly [9]_____ to read either two educational electronic books or two printed books with the same content. While the parent read the words in the printed books [10]_____, the electronic books had audio of voice actors reading the text. The [11]_____ found that parents who read the printed books pointed more frequently to pages than parents who read the electronic books, but the opposite was true for the children. Children who read the electronic books also commented more on the content and learned more new words than the children who read [12]_____ books. This greater learning is ascribed to greater [13]_____ with the electronic books. It's important to note that the electronic books in the study were simple, while they included background music, [14]_____, and sound effects. There were no other extra features. It's also important to note that there's research on older children finding that electronic books don't always [15]_____ learning. Parents and educators need to beware. Extra features in electronic books may increase children's [16]_____ with them. However, if these features don't draw attention to the educational content, they may not serve as a [17]_____ feature.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Let me be honest with you. If you are living your life full of [1]_____, you're wasting your time. Why would you go through life [2]_____ the very decisions that made you who you are today? There are plenty of [3]_____ decisions we've made, but does that mean we should regret them? No. I've had many moments where I sit and think about all the things I wish I could have done [4]_____. However, just because things could be different, it doesn't [5]_____ mean they would be better. You don't have to

[6] _____ be thinking of all your past decisions and whether or not you made the right one, you can't go back and change anything. So what's the point in worrying about it? Every single decision you've ever made, positive or [7] _____, has made you the person you are today. We want to go back and change parts of our past, but what would be the benefit of that, we would have lost the valuable knowledge from the [8] _____ we learned. There are reasons you make the choices you do, and that tells us about who you are. So when it comes to any decision in life, be [9] _____ yourself, because at the end of the day, it was you who made that decision. With less time spent focused on [10] _____, you'll finally have time to focus on the more essential things in life. In any situation, you grow more as a person with every decision you make. Life is full of lessons to learn, so we can't let [11] _____ stop us from moving forward. We don't know if we've made the right or wrong choice until after it's already been made, so it can be easy to start [12] _____ your decision. But if the decision has already been made, what's the purpose of dwelling on it? There isn't one. All you can do is move forward. You can't let yourself sit there and worry about every past choice. We aren't all perfect. Whenever you make a decision, there will always be a possibility for [13] _____ later. But that's how life is supposed to be. You will make poor decisions in life. We all do. But it's what you do with the [14] _____ learned that matters. Think about every decision you've ever made. Were they always the best? Of course not. But look at how far you've come since then.

2025年12月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Today's special guest is Lord Blackwell, one of our country's most experienced and distinguished career [1]_____. Welcome. It's my pleasure. Our [2]_____ will be most interested in learning about a career in the foreign service. However, before we talk about that, I'd like to ask you about the current developments hitting the news today regarding the [3]_____ of Winopia. What can you tell us? I'm [4]_____ I don't know much beyond what we've all seen on the news. It looks like the government of Winopia seems to be undergoing some sort of crisis of [5]_____, and an interim administration has been transitionally established until a head of state is agreed on. But my career work has mostly focused around the continental [6]_____ of Europe and the Americas, and thus I've never been involved with Winopian relations. It's for this reason that I don't know anything on this matter beyond what we can all read in the newspapers. Oh, I see. Nevertheless, be rest assured that our export [7]_____ at our consulate there will be closely monitoring the situation, and I expect our bilateral relations with that country will not be affected. So, how does one get a career in foreign relations? There are many different [8]_____ one can take. All [9]_____ have their own story, but in my case, I got a degree in electrical engineering, followed by six years' service in the air force. Then I went to law school, and upon obtaining a degree in international law, I joined the [10]_____ corps, where I've been for 22 years. What would you say are the key [11]_____ one needs for the job? There are so many. Being a hard worker and good student is important. You never stop learning. In addition, a diplomat needs to be very [12]_____ in their discourse and rhetoric. Whether it is [13]_____ tension or enacting policy, people and communication skills are vital.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

It's getting late, and we're both displaying signs of [1]_____, I think we should call it a day and meet again tomorrow morning. Oh, come on, Jeff. We are so close. Don't you think we are almost done? Let's do two more hours, please. One hour, then I'm going home. Okay, fine. I think we are making good progress, and that

with a few more [2]_____, we will be all done. I'm sure looking forward to it. I'm so tired of this project. Don't get me wrong; it's a great professional opportunity for me and a [3]_____ for the company. But it's just been so long. Yeah, two months working on nothing but the same contract is a little [4]_____. [5]_____, I think that with a bit of luck, we'll be done by next week. You must be delusional. You don't think so? No chance. Sections four, five, eight, and nine still have to be [6]_____ to the new framework. Then we need to [7]_____ the whole thing and make sure all selling points are watertight. But that will all take no more than a couple of days. I wasn't finished. When we are done with it and send it [8]_____, what do you think will happen? What, they'll argue about it for like a month? There's always going to be the odd board member who intervenes and demands [9]_____ be made. They might think they're being helpful, but in reality, they're being [10]_____ and hampering progress. Oh, Jeff, you're too preoccupied and cynical. It won't be [11]_____ as bad as that. You'll see. The entire [12]_____ hierarchy wants to see this project implemented as soon as possible, and the board too is virtually unanimous in its support. Go on, then. Let's stop there and meet up again same time tomorrow.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

One thing I've learned in a quarter century of management is that there are [1]_____ gray areas in human behavior, and that there may not always be clear right or wrong solutions to employee disputes. When two people have different versions of the same event, it can be hard to know whom to believe. One such [2]_____ always comes back to me. It happened years ago, and it's a measure of the [3]_____ nature of the conflict that I no longer even recall what the dispute was about, but I definitely recall the resolution. Two talented young executives, one of whom I was managing, had [4]_____ different accounts of the same event, and it seemed likely we'd never get to the truth. We reached a deadlock, and the manager of the other individual said, "Here's something I learned from an [5]_____ manager I once worked for." He used to say, "When in doubt, assume positive [6]_____," and just like that, we had a path forward. My counterpart and I agreed we might never [7]_____ the actual facts of the matter. Quite likely, there were [8]_____ of truth in both employees' stories. We agreed to monitor their actions and relationship going forward, but to [9]_____ no further. We assumed the best about both of them and

moved on. The result was that we were able to put the [10]_____ behind us. In fact, their problems didn't recur. Over the years, this general approach has [11]_____ useful. Whenever the truth is obscure, assuming positive intent and agreeing to move on can be a [12]_____ decision.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

For some Americans, going out to dinner is a [1]_____ planned and budgeted for. For others, it's just a daily [2]_____, and that second group of people is becoming the majority as the number of Americans who enjoy cooking is declining. In the early 2000s, researcher Eddie Yoon conducted a survey to [3]_____ Americans' attitudes to cooking. The [4]_____ found that 15 percent of Americans loved to cook, 50% said they hated to cook, and 35% reported mixed feelings. When Yoon conducted the same survey 15 years later, only 10% of [5]_____ reported a love of cooking, 45% said they hated it, and 45% had mixed feelings. Yoon asserts cooking is akin to sewing. As recently as the early 20th century, many Americans [6]_____ their own clothing. Today, the vast majority of Americans buy [7]_____. Only a tiny minority still sew, and they do it mainly as a [8]_____. Yoon believes the number of home cooks will [9]_____ in a similar fashion. Currently, the average American [10]_____ spends over $3,000 per year on dining out. However, what people save in [11]_____ they lose in cash. Take buying lunch on work days, for example. People spend, on average, $10 per [12]_____ when they buy lunch. Making your own lunch, [13]_____, will cost less. One survey found people only spend, on average, $6.30 when they bring lunch [14]_____ at home. Americans' growing aversion to spending time in the kitchen [15]_____ a host of challenges for the grocery industry. It's likely to detrimentally impact family [16]_____ as well.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Every year of the more than 2.5 billion bags checked onto flights [1]_____, 26 million go missing, and of that 26 million, 1 million never make it back to their original owner. Bad weather and flight delays, miscoded [2]_____ tags, and some people simply forgetting to pick up one of their bags are a few of the reasons. But the number one reason a bag ends up lost is that it has no ID tag, and [3]_____ don't know to whom it belongs. Transferring [4]_____ from check-in to departure gates to arrival gates to baggage claim is a

delicate piece of timing. If the system moves too slowly, the bags won't make connecting flights. If it's too fast, the bags may make the connection, but the [5]_____ might miss the flight. Each airport has its own way of [6]_____ how much time a bag needs to move in transit. Some airports have sophisticated automated systems, including scanners that read baggage labels, destination-coded vehicles that load and [7]_____ the bags without stopping, and sorting machines that route baggage to the appropriate gate. Even so, all that technology may not save your [8]_____ tag from being torn off on the conveyor belt, making you the owner of a bag with no name. Once a bag goes missing and the passenger files a claim, the bag is declared [9]_____ by the carrier. [10]_____ refers to bags that have been delayed, lost, stolen, or damaged. Most [11]_____ bags are only one flight behind their owners and can be delivered within 24 hours. The other bags are [12]_____ by airline employees for clues to their ownership and destination, if the mystery is solved, those bags are returned to their owners within four or five days. Bags with no destination code or identification tag are shipped to a central warehouse and undergo a comprehensive baggage [13]_____ process over the next 90 days. Airlines inventory their [14]_____ baggage, and many use a database to match the contents with owners' descriptions. It takes about three months to go from missing in action to [15]_____ lost. Once that happens, the bags are [16]_____ to charity, sold at auction, or purchased by a company which sells them to the public, so never pack anything of real value in your checked baggage, and make sure your name is on the bag along with your phone number, so an agent can contact you.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

You've probably been with someone who ignored you while interacting with his or her [1]_____, and you've probably engaged in this behavior yourself. In a recent survey, nine out of 10 [2]_____ said they'd used their smartphone during their most recent social activity. There's also evidence that this behavior is [3]_____ harmful. It can leave people less satisfied with their face-to-face interactions, and it can generate feelings of [4]_____ and jealousy. Now, the Journal of Applied Social Psychology has [5]_____ a new study exploring the reasons for these effects. The study included 128 mostly female student [6]_____. The [7]_____ watched a three-minute animation, in which two cartoon figures interacted and engaged in a conversation. The conversation couldn't be heard, but could be [8]_____

through mouth movements. [9]_____ had to imagine themselves as the closest figure in the video, and then make judgments about the conversations and how they felt about their conversation partners. In one version of the experiment, the phone of the participant's conversation partner remained [10]_____ on the table throughout the conversation. In another version, their partner's attention was quickly drawn to something on their phone, and they spent the rest of the time interacting with their phone. A third version involved the [11]_____' partner alternating between periods of interaction with their phone and periods where they ignored their phone. If you've experienced a similar situation, you probably won't be surprised by the results of the [12]_____. The [13]_____ had a negative view of phone use during social interactions. The more it was present, the worse they considered both the quality of the [14]_____ and the quality of the relationship. The researchers believed that focusing on one's phone instead of the person one is with has this effect because it's seen as a form of social exclusion, they assert that the behavior is analogous to when people have no choice but to eat alone in the school [15]_____. The twist is that this [16]_____ occurs while sharing a physical encounter and having a conversation. Researchers found that the behavior had adverse effects on [17]_____' sense of belonging, need for meaning, and self-esteem. These negative effects are similar to those caused by traditional forms of social [18]_____. The new findings are important because they elaborate our understanding of a subtle but common aspect of our daily experience, this common behavior can create vicious cycles of [19]_____, even as we try to connect with others.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

More and more people travel for a variety of reasons, many are [1]_____, but many venture forth on personal or professional business. Whatever the reason for traveling, a common complaint of travelers is the [2]_____ accommodations they find. After spending five consecutive nights in five similar hotels, the business traveler may find it difficult to remember what happened from day to day, or even what towns were visited, and the tourist may get the mistaken impression that all cities are pretty much the same, at least as far as [3]_____, food, and service are concerned. To combat this sense of impersonal [4]_____, travelers are taking advantage of in-home hospitality or bed and breakfast arrangements, B and B's, I mean bed and

breakfast arrangements, are private homes which offer lodging and breakfast in a very personalized, friendly setting. For [5]_____, B and B's have been the classic way to visit Europe, especially the British Isles, and in fact, they are not really a new idea in America. The tradition dates back to colonial times when inns were few and far between, and the [6]_____ traveler had to depend on the kindness of strangers for a meal and a bed. But the revival of B and B's as [7]_____ accommodations is a fairly recent phenomenon. If the idea of operating a B and B [8]_____ your interest, there are several factors to consider before plunging into this business. The first [9]_____ is your property, not only the building itself but the location. If you live near a famous historical site or in a popular [10]_____ such as New York City or Washington D.C., your home can be fairly simple, yet still do well as a B and B. On the other hand, if your home is [11]_____ unique or has facilities for the traveler, such as a private entrance, private bath, or swimming pool, people may be willing to go some distance to reach you. Another important factor is the [12]_____ of you and your family. You must take into account whether all members of the family truly enjoy visitors, want to repeatedly discuss local sites and activities, and have the time and energy to handle the additional cooking, cleaning, laundry, and [13]_____ involved. The final consideration is a financial one. Potential B and B [14]_____ must be realistic about opportunities for income. While B and B's usually have low initial costs, experts [15]_____ it would take at least five rooms rented regularly for the host to earn a living from B and B.

2025年6月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

We are down to two candidates for one position, and we need to decide by the end of the day in order to [1]_____ this whole procedure. Yes, but it isn't an easy choice to make. Both applicants are quite strong. Let's get to it then. Both of them went to good universities, and both of them studied business-related subjects, so [2]_____, I'd say they're pretty much the same. What do you think? I would agree. Yes, the only difference worth noting, perhaps, is that it looks like Rachel scored [3]_____ stronger grades throughout high school and university, but as I said, only a tiny bit higher than Peter. That's true and worth noting. Thank you. In addition, Rachel interviewed very well. I thought she came across as bright and [4]_____. Yes, she asked some very good questions about the position and the company, which made me think she is very keen about the job. I thought so too. Now let's look at Peter's interview performance. I thought he also did very well. He came across as [5]_____ and professional, wouldn't you say? Calm and [6]_____, very mature for his age. Exactly. In my notes, I wrote that he seemed composed and in control of his [7]_____. I think he definitely looked more [8]_____ than Rachel. Interesting. So we agree that Rachel appeared [9]_____ and less mature than Peter, even though both candidates are the same age and have practically no work experience. When [10]_____ them side by side, yes, Peter seemed more self-assured somehow. Maybe it was something about their body language. Sure, maybe he was simply less nervous. Maybe, who knows? To be honest, I think I like Rachel better. Hmm. Really? I think I like Peter. Ah, well. If there's a tie and we can't come to an agreement, then we'll take it to John and let him cast the deciding vote.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

We're here with Clementine Ortega, head designer of the private fashion [1]_____ L'Orange, to discuss her latest collection. Ms. Ortega, how would you [2]_____ this season's look? To be honest, my preferred style has always been on the [3]_____ side, and I think this collection is even more so. I try not to adhere to social [4]_____ and expectations. Rather, I always try to [5]_____ something slightly absurd into my

aesthetic. The [6]_____ of accessories in this collection have had quite the impact on critics. The [7]_____ cape deployed at the end of the show, for example, bewildered many in the audience. What was your inspiration for this piece? Over the summer, I traveled through rural mountain villages throughout Asia in search of [8]_____ to decorate my new studio with. The [9]_____ done by the women in a particular village was so exquisite I couldn't stop thinking about it. Trying to recreate their designs would have been [10]_____, so instead I applied my own eccentric approach. Using glitter, I drew similar [11]_____ patterns onto the velvet cape. This ended up in the glamorous, [12]_____ look that concluded the show. It was indeed [13]_____, and yet, dare I say, masculine at the same time. Well, yes, that was intentional. I like to [14]_____ styles that are often at opposite ends of the fashion spectrum. Hence, the [15]_____ cape was paired with a traditional power suit you would typically see in a business setting. It was [16]_____, if I do say so myself. [17]_____ for sure, a stunning show all around. Going against stereotypes, the [18]_____ of indigenous aspects, along with your underlying signature touch, made this collection a statement of the season. You have proven yourself a [19]_____ young designer, and we can't wait to see what creations you come up with next.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Pet dogs can often readily understand a wide range of their owner's commands and gestures, but are these abilities [1]_____ or are they exclusively learned through training? To find out, a new study examined whether [2]_____ dogs could understand human gestures, the study revealed that 80 percent of participating dogs successfully followed pointing gestures to a specific location, despite having never received prior training. The results suggest that dogs can understand complex [3]_____ by simply watching humans. This could have [4]_____ in reducing conflict between stray dogs and humans. Dogs were [5]_____ 10,000 to 15,000 years ago. This means they are probably the oldest [6]_____ animals on the planet. Humans then bred dogs with the most desirable and useful [7]_____, so that they could function as companions and workers. This resulted in [8]_____ dogs that are highly responsive to human commands and gestures. However, it was not clear whether dogs understand us through training alone, or whether this was an [9]_____ ability. Why does this matter? [10]_____ dogs are a common feature in cities

around the world. They may observe and occasionally interact with people, but such dogs have never been trained and are [11]_____ wild. Conflicts between [12]_____ dogs and humans are a problem. Understanding how humans shape stray dogs' behavior may help [13]_____ this problem. According to the researchers of the new study, [14]_____ dogs are intelligent creatures. They closely [15]_____ humans and use their understanding of us to make a decision. Treating stray dogs with sensitivity and respect, and giving them space, the researchers [16]_____, can reduce much conflict.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Think your [1]_____ is just one big box of evenly cold air? Not so. The temperature inside the average [2]_____ actually varies from front to back, bottom to top, and everywhere in between. Because of this, food product placement within the [3]_____ is far more important than you probably realize. The whole purpose of the modern refrigerator is to slow the growth of bacteria, which thrive in temperatures from 4.4 to 60 degrees [4]_____. As a result, [5]_____ are typically set at or below that low end to protect foods against bacteria. Although it might seem like time spent organizing the fridge will [6]_____ your day, doing so will actually make it more user-friendly, easier to clean, and food safety-conscious. Those little bins on the inside of refrigerator doors are [7]_____, but they don't maintain a consistent temperature. So definitely refrain from putting [8]_____ foods in there. The top area is not as cold as the bottom of the fridge, so save it for the foods that don't need extra [9]_____ temperatures. Store foods that are ready to eat or already cooked on the top [10]_____. The middle [11]_____ is the most temperature-controlled part of the fridge, so place eggs here. Drinks and prepared foods can also live on the middle [12]_____ if you run out of room up top. The back of the bottom shelf is the coldest spot in the fridge, so store [13]_____ dairy products here to keep them edible longer. Never store foods with high water content here, because the water within them can and will [14]_____ effectively.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

My current research is mainly looking at factors like stress and how it [1]_____ our immune system. So the current projects that I'm quite excited about are looking at older people and [2]_____ that are important to

them. In one project, we are looking at hip [3]_____ in older people, which is a common event, and we're trying to understand the impact of depression. Often, people in hospital with a hip fracture develop depression, and these are the people that then go on to become [4]_____ a lot more quickly than others. They get infections. Often, these infections lead to death. So we're trying to slow down that [5]_____ to feebleness. So if we can better understand how these factors [6]_____, then we can actually start doing something about it. The impact that my research will have in Birmingham, first of all, is obviously for older people, because these are the people that are having hip [7]_____ and developing depression, and we're trying to improve their health and their quality of life. But this isn't just a problem in Birmingham or even in the UK. This is a problem globally. People are aging. There's a lot more people in the older generation who are living for longer, but not necessarily staying healthy for a large part of their lives. So the last part of their life can often be full of ill health, and we're trying to understand [8]_____ that can contribute to the quality of life later on. I think the thing that [9]_____ me most about my research is that it feels real and relevant. Lots of academics are probably very excited about their research, but it might not be that relevant to those around them, [10]_____ I feel that the work I do is relevant to everyone because everyone is aging. Health is an issue for everyone, regardless of their age, and what I'm trying to do is understand the factors that [11]_____ health, and how we can improve the quality of life in people. So that's one of the things that really [12]_____ me about it. One of the other things is rather than just taking one perspective, so rather than looking at aging and health just from the perspective of the psychologist, we are now bringing together a lot of different techniques and a lot of different [13]_____ to actually look at the sort of different factors affecting health.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Americans are obsessed with celebrity chefs. We talk about them and try to eat like them, but could we learn something more from them than [1]_____ and techniques? According to Marketdata [2]_____, Americans spend nearly $10 billion a year on self-help and personal organization products. The market is huge, [3]_____ because most colleges and graduate schools don't teach basic organization, but cooking schools and professional kitchens do. Perhaps the principles of cooking organization can be extended to help even those of us who aren't top [4]_____. The system that makes kitchens [5]_____ is called mise en place, or literally put

in place. It's a French phrase that means to gather and arrange the [6] _____ and tools needed for cooking. But for many professional cooks, the [7] _____ means something deeper. Some cooks call it their religion. It helps them coordinate vast amounts of labor and material, and transforms the lives of its [8] _____ through focus and self-discipline. Students at the Culinary Institute of America view it as a way of life. It's a way of concentrating their mind to only focus on the aspects that they need to be working on at the moment, to kind of rid themselves of [9] _____. And it's a [10] _____ that some students carry with them, even when they're not in the kitchen. They mise en place their life. They set up their books for class. They set up their chef whites. They shine their shoes. They know everything that they need every step of the day. Then, how does one [11] _____ this level of organization? The key to high-level organization is the [12] _____. Cooks can easily do six hours of [13] _____ for a three-hour dinner shift. Mise en place forces cooks to account for every minute of their time and every movement. Every component of one single [14] _____ is in one single corner, so their hand literally moves inches. Explains Duane Limpuma, an [15] _____ at the Culinary Institute of America. Once students set up their station, I should be able to cover up their eyes, and they should know that their knives are always here, their oil is always right here, their salt and [16] _____ is always right here. But practiced at its highest level, mise en place says that time is [17] _____, resources are precious, space is precious. Your self-respect and the respect of others are [18] _____. Use them wisely. Isn't that a philosophy for our time?

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Why do we stop making goals for ourselves and stop [1] _____ in life? One reason is the belief that we should accept who we are and not constantly [2] _____ to improve ourselves. The mistake we make with this is that whilst self-acceptance is [3] _____, it should actually be used as the basis for growth. When we're not growing, learning, and seeking improvements in our lives, we tend to [4] _____, accepting what is and stop believing we can be better. A key tool for creating goals and progressing is using our [5] _____. Yet, as is so often the case, by the time we've reached [6] _____, we've stopped dreaming about what we want to achieve and feel quite negatively about goal setting. Instead of feeling confidence, happiness, and [7] _____ from achieving our goals, we feel we are always falling short. That leads to

[8]_____, and we stop dreaming. We stop imagining the life we'd like to have or the person we'd like to be. Quickly finding ourselves [9]_____ by the pain of our reality. Up until now, unless we work in the creative industry, we've found the idea of using play a bit [10]_____. In the West, we are mostly operating from our heads, the [11]_____ mind, but it's beginning to be better understood because using our imagination is actually one of the most powerful things we could ever do. The problem with finding ourselves [12]_____ for not achieving the goal is because the goal always changes, and we're always adapting, whether we realize it or not. What happens, therefore, is that we end up feeling like we are never going to reach our goals, and herein lies one of the biggest misconceptions and reasons for failure: dissatisfaction and [13]_____. We [14]_____ against the goal rather than where we've come from, Dan Sullivan calls this the gap and the gain. We [15]_____ always against the goal, which we never feel we're reaching, rather than the gain, that is where we've come from. In [16]_____ where we've come from rather than where we're trying to get to, we see results. We see things we've taken for granted or not noticed. It's a simple yet [17]_____ change in perception, and what I love about it is the power it has to instantly shift us up a gear. It's so so simple yet has an [18]_____ positive impact on our thinking.

2025年6月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Good morning. My name is Bob Fetterman. I'm the computer technician. Didn't I call for you last week? Maybe. I work for Alpha Maintenance. I imagine someone from your office called our central office, and I'm the engineer [1]_____ to your case. Yeah, I spoke to a lady there last Tuesday, which is now 10 days ago. I made it clear it was an [2]_____ matter, and please send someone as soon as possible. Couldn't you or someone else have come [3]_____? I'm sorry, but I'm not in charge of scheduling all [4]_____. I simply do not know. All I can tell you is I got the call this week and came as soon as I could. I see. Well, I'll have you know my manager is rather [5]_____ that it's taken you this long to come. I understand it might not be your fault, but [6]_____ you should know what the feeling is around here. I understand, and I'm sorry for any [7]_____. I will try to resolve your computer problem as swiftly and [8]_____ as I can. What and where is the issue? It's this machine right here. It was running slow for a while, I guess, and [9]_____ got worse and worse. Last Tuesday, it just stopped working altogether. If you switch it on, you will see what I mean. Okay. Do you know if it's backed up? Backed up. I mean, do you know if its contents have been [10]_____ and saved somewhere else? I don't know. Well, depending on the ensuing operative scenario, if I need to wipe the system directories clean in order to [11]_____ default protocols, then my first intervention should be to intricately retrieve all inventories that I can. Otherwise, all data that was stored on its hard drive will be [12]_____ lost. My manager would know. Let me go get him.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Have you given more thought to studying law? I've been thinking about it a lot. Yes, in fact, this is why I wished to speak to you. I wanted to hear more about what it's like. A career in law is a beautiful thing, in my opinion. Many people will say it's a boring field, but I [1]_____. The thing is, there are many different [2]_____ of law and many different jobs. You are involved with buildings and construction, right? Correct. I'm a solicitor specializing in real estate. Most of my work involves [3]_____ land disputes. Do you mind

giving me an example? Sure. So, in many cases, I am employed to [4]_____ between two clashing parties. Let's say, for example, there are two landowners who are in a [5]_____ disagreement about something, like the borders of their adjacent plots. Someone may employ me to break the [6]_____ and resolve the dispute. Often, my work involves negotiating agreements. Plain and simple. So you are saying that a lot of what you do is fix people's legal issues, like you try to find a solution that benefits everyone and that prevents a problem from [7]_____. Exactly. Well put. You need to remember that. Courts, like all [8]_____, really can be very messy, frustrating, and expensive. For this reason, it's usually better to [9]_____ problems outside of court whenever possible. I see. So, [10]_____ knowing the law inside out, you need good people skills, right? Of course. Any job that involves people requires good interpersonal skills, and any law professional needs to be very [11]_____ at articulating their argument. Right. So I've been thinking about studying criminal law. I think it sounds very interesting. Yes, I'd say there's more money in property law, but the [12]_____ are higher in criminal law. I can see how you would find it more interesting.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

When a person tries to access a memory, their brains quickly [1]_____ everything stored in it to find the relevant information. But as we age, many of us have difficulty [2]_____ memories. In a review published in the journal Trends in Cognitive Sciences on February 11th, [3]_____ propose an explanation for why this might be happening. The brains of older adults [4]_____ more space to accumulated knowledge and have more material to navigate when attempting to access memories. While this wealth of prior knowledge can make memory [5]_____ challenging, the researchers say it has its upsides. This life experience can aid with [6]_____ and decision making. Researchers Tarek Amer, Jordana Wynn, and Lynn Hasher looked at several behavioral and brain imaging studies, which show that older adults have difficulty [7]_____ information that is no longer relevant, and that when searching for a specific memory, they often retrieve other irrelevant memories along with it, the studies also showed that when given a cognitive task, older adults rely more heavily on previous knowledge than younger adults do. While the researchers focus primarily on the difficulties that these [8]_____, crowded memories may pose, they also highlight a few situations in which these same memory patterns may be useful. Evidence suggests that older

adults show preserved and at times enhanced creativity as a function of [9] _____ memories. The researchers write, they further [10] _____ that older adults may be well served by their prior knowledge, when it comes to decision making, where they can pull on their accumulated wisdom.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

There are at least four major problems with work in America today. First, work can be alienating. Workers are often not in control of how they work, when they work, what is done with the [1] _____ and services they produce, and what is done with the profits made from their work. Second, workers are not paid the full value of their [2] _____. Real wages have not kept pace with productivity, driving economic [3] _____ and a decline in labor's share of income. Third, people are time poor. In the U.S., full-time employees work an average of 8.72 hours per day, despite [4] _____ increases. Long working hours contribute to the feeling of time poverty, which has an adverse effect on [5] _____ well-being. Fourth, [6] _____ puts jobs and wages at risk. Technological innovation could, in theory, liberate people from the 40-hour work week, but unless changes are made to the structure of work, automation will simply [7] _____ downward pressure on wages and further diminish work opportunities. So, what can be done to [8] _____ these problems? There are [9] _____ visions of the best way to arrive at a solution. One [10] _____ is what's known as the post-work position. The post-work [11] _____ believe that work should not hold a central position in our lives or take up so much of our time. They [12] _____ that although doing some work might be necessary, meaning, purpose, and social value reside in the communities and relationships built and sustained outside of the workplace. Thus, life should be seen as an end in itself.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Recent studies show that self-control and [1] _____ increase academic outcomes independent of IQ. Even our personal beliefs about effort can affect academic [2] _____. Children who think effort leads to achievement [3] _____ those who believe ability is a fixed trait. Given the link between [4] _____ and academic success, decisions about effort are particularly important in childhood. Yet, relatively little research has [5] _____ how young children learn what's worth the effort. We all know that

infants are keen observers of the social world, but they're not just [6]_____ watching. They are tiny learning machines. They can [7]_____ such abstract concepts as causal relationships and social roles from just a few examples. Even a 15 months old infant can [8]_____ a high-level computer in such tasks. Could infants also make broad, generalizable [9]_____ from a few examples when it comes to effort? If so, then maybe [10]_____ isn't simply a character trait. Maybe it's flexible and [11]_____, based on social context. To explore this question, we showed 15-month-old babies one of two things: an [12]_____ working hard to achieve two different goals, or an experimenter who effortlessly reached each goal. Then we introduced the baby to a novel music toy that seemed as if it could be [13]_____ by pushing a big button on top. The button could be pressed down, but didn't actually [14]_____ anything. Out of sight of the babies, we turned on the music toy with a [15]_____ button, so that they heard the toy making music. We gave the babies the music toy and left the room. Then analysts who didn't know which condition each baby was in watched [16]_____ of the experiment and counted how many times babies tried to activate the toy by pressing the button. Across one study and a pre-registered [17]_____, babies who had seen an adult persist and succeed pushed the button about twice as many times as those who saw an adult effortlessly succeed. In other words, babies learned that effort was [18]_____ after watching just two examples of an adult working hard and succeeding. Part of what's exciting about this finding is that the babies didn't just [19]_____ the adults' actions. Instead, they [20]_____ the value of effort to a novel task. The [21]_____ never demonstrated pushing a button or trying to make music. Instead, the babies learned from different examples of effortful actions, that the new toy probably also required [22]_____.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

If chronic [1]_____ has taken over your life and turned into a defining trait of who you are, it's likely that you're losing out on job offers, recreational opportunities, friendships, and more. If you're showing up late to your own life, get organized, prioritize [2]_____, and address any underlying causes. When you have to be somewhere, try to [3]_____ 15 to 30 minutes before you need to, if you always run late, that means you must be failing to account for something you always do. [4]_____ that by giving yourself extra time to arrive. Keep track of whether or not you actually do arrive early. You might find that leaving early gets you to

places exactly on time. Set two alarms. Set one [5]_____ that lets you know it's time to drop what you're doing, and a second alarm that means you need to walk out the door. Obey the alarms. As soon as the first [6]_____ goes off, stop what you're doing. If it's something you'll be coming back to like a project for work, make a note to [7]_____ yourself where you left off. [8]_____ everything you need and make sure you know how to get where you're going. Aim to be out the door and on your way before the second [9]_____ rings. This will only work if you take the [10]_____ seriously. So make sure you [11]_____ as soon as you hear them. Prepare for the day ahead. Have all of your notes and materials [12]_____ well in advance of each event, so that all you have to do is grab them and go when it's the actual day. If mornings are a [13]_____ for you, do as much as you can to ready yourself the night before. Before you go to bed, lay out your clothes and [14]_____ your bag for the next day. Learn to leave time in between [15]_____ and meetings. It soon becomes [16]_____ to shift between one meeting and another without space in between. If you overschedule yourself, however, you'll arrive late as soon as you hit a bump. As well as giving you space, this time also acts as a [17]_____ between events, which can be borrowed from should you be held up in a prior meeting, allowing you to still get to the next one on time. [18]_____ transit time between activities, and then add 10 to 30 minutes for unexpected delays.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Do you think Bostonians put out the welcome mat? Do you find other cities to be more or less [1]_____? Different cities have different feels for visitors. Some are friendly and open. Some are formal and distant. Boston tends to seem [2]_____ and sometimes a little rude. That's what some tourists have said. One study found that people here are less willing to volunteer to help strangers than those residents of other U.S. cities, take a close look next time you're in Boston, and here are some of the things you'll probably see: people smoking in the subway stations despite the frequent reminders not to do so; pedestrians walking when the [3]_____ lights say not to do so, ignoring the cars; car drivers speeding, making a loud noise with the horn, and occasionally cursing at each other. Drivers who can't be bothered to find a place to park, but instead simply turn on their [4]_____ and stop in the middle of the street. Sometimes Bostonians seem like they're just too busy to be [5]_____. Why is their city like that? Former U.S. Representative Chester Atkins says it's because the [6]_____ founding fathers were themselves impatient and bad-tempered and had little time for courtesy.

That culture has carried down to the present day, he believes. Boston College professor Thomas O'Connor thinks a contributing factor is Boston's history as a city, where each new group of immigrants was treated with suspicion and [7]_____. That's given Boston a sense of clannishness and [8]_____. He thinks the idea of a stranger [9]_____ another stranger is simply not part of the local culture. He says, "People will begin a conversation with someone they know, but not with a [10]_____." Ralph Whitehead, a professor of journalism at the University of Massachusetts at Amherst, thinks it's because Boston's upper class used [11]_____ to make class distinctions. By being snobbish about manners, proper Bostonians made other people [12]_____ of courtesy, he says. Some say that's just the way Boston is, and that the city will never change. Still, other cities with reputations for worse [13]_____ are trying hard to change their images. Paris is one example where people are trying to be [14]_____. New York City is another. There, the city is trying to persuade subway riders to be more [15]_____. If those cities can make the effort, maybe Boston should as well.

2024年12月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hi, Alan. Sorry for not calling you back sooner. You said on the phone you had something you needed to [1]_____ with me. Well, to get right down to it, I'm having second thoughts about my major. With my family situation getting more [2]_____, and the end of my university education nearing, persisting with art history just doesn't seem the right choice, Alan. In the last three years, I have heard nothing but how [3]_____ you are about the art history program. You often told fellow [4]_____ how fabulous the instructors were and that you finally felt accepted. What would cause you to abandon it? My father's current financial situation has helped me realize that a more financially [5]_____ employment opportunity is not necessarily a bad thing. Art history [6]_____ my soul, but does nothing to put food on my plate. What about all the work opportunities I [7]_____ with you last month? Have you gone to those places of business to investigate whether any [8]_____ positions might be available for someone with your background? Well, look, Alan. If your heart is set on working in the art industry, you need to be more [9]_____ and start talking with people. Networking is key if you want to become a celebrity in the world of museums and galleries, time is a very precious [10]_____ right now. My social life does not exist. I can barely keep up with my studies, and [11]_____ is due by the end of this year. When can I find time to research jobs when I have so much to do as it is. What you do now will [12]_____ your future options. Now is the [13]_____ time to put forth your best effort. I will take what you said into consideration. The advice is much appreciated.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Have you decided yet what your end of [1]_____ business project will be on? Yes. How about you? Yes. Go on. You go first. I'm going to do it about beef. Beef? Yeah, beef. I'm going to design a business case study for a cow farm that supplies beef for the [2]_____ market. Well, that sounds very interesting and original. Wherever did you get that idea? I don't know. It just came to me, I guess. But think about it. Beef

[3] _____ has been rising strongly over the past 20 years. As the economy continues to grow, consumer demand is expected to continue to increase for the [4] _____ future. And currently, most of the beef is [5] _____, which brings with it added fees. So why not raise cattle here? Of course, makes perfect sense. There's plenty of land out west, so if done right, it should be very [6] _____ to raise our own cattle. Exactly. Seriously, that sounds like a great idea. You should [7] _____ look into it once we get our degrees. Thanks. So your turn now. What are you doing your case study on? I was thinking about a car wash, but it now seems like such a boring [8] _____ after hearing your brilliant idea. That's cool. I could see that working. After all, there's plenty of cars about, and those aren't going away any time soon. While many people don't care how their car looks, many other people do. You got yourself a vast and [9] _____ market. Right. So the idea is a large self-cleaning car wash, but I mean, really big and well outfitted, like they have in America. I was thinking of having it cater to high-end [10] _____ in large cities. It could charge a profitable [11] _____ by offering just a bit more technical equipment and professional service than competitors.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Increased television time for young children has long been linked with poorer [1] _____ in some areas of development. One possible way to [2] _____ those negative effects is talking while watching the screen. As a new study suggests, the more parents engaged in conversation with [3] _____ during TV time, the more likely those children were to have higher curiosity levels when they reached kindergarten. This was particularly true for children with socio-economic [4] _____. Our findings [5] _____ the importance of parent conversation to promote early childhood development and curiosity," said lead author Prachi Shah at University of Michigan Health C.S. Mott Children's Hospital. Researchers assessed hours of daily television exposure and frequency of parent screen time conversation among 1,500 [6] _____, and then measured early childhood curiosity in kindergarten. The study specifically focused on curiosity levels, which are associated with enhanced learning and higher academic achievement in reading and math at kindergarten, and behavioral [7] _____ benefits, especially for children from families with lower socio-economic status. While many young children are now growing up with digital media exposure through mobile devices like tablets and phones, television remains a dominant screen activity, accounting for 72 percent

of all screen time, TVs are in 98 percent of all homes, keeping television exposure a relevant [8] _____ context in young children. Excessive media exposure, including television, can [9] _____ exploratory activities such as play and parent-child interactions, which are believed to be key to cultivating curiosity in kids, our findings suggest the importance of parents finding opportunities to foster conversational exchanges in daily routines with their young children, including while watching television, Shah said.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Humans are aspirational, goal-seeking beings. Each of us, according to research, has an [1] _____ drive to acquire. The dark side of this drive to acquire is being [2] _____ driven to possess more and more things, and to socially compare our stuff with all the stuff other people have in their lives. So the question is, how do we ensure we tap into our drive to [3] _____ in positive ways that will benefit our well-being? One way is to become more intentionally [4] _____. To be intentionally [5] _____ includes consciously aspiring to be the person you need to be to succeed in your professional and personal life. It also includes consciously [6] _____ to acquire things in your life that will positively impact your sense of well-being. If you're not consciously, [7] _____, and intentionally harnessing this inborn drive to acquire, you might be mindlessly pursuing all the wrong things. While your intentional [8] _____ goals will include the pursuit of acquiring things that will increase your sense of well-being, they ought to also include goals to help other people in your various life roles. Your intentional [9] _____ goals will also include striving to be your personal best, a person of good character, integrity, and trustworthiness. Think about this from a practical rather than theoretical [10] _____. If you're not pursuing intentional [11] _____ goals, you have nothing to strive for. If you have nothing to strive for, you're putting yourself in the [12] _____ position of simply drifting through life, and you'll not be able to experience, live, and enjoy all that life has to offer.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

It's revision time for exams and dissertations. The pressure is on, so you'll want all the help you can get to aid your memory and [1] _____ your grades. As a nutrition expert, I want to say that eating well can make a real

difference to your [2]_____ regime. So, what brain-boosting food and drink would I [3]_____? Coffee can have numerous benefits. However, while coffee may make you more alert, individuals can build up a [4]_____, meaning this is short-lived. Coffee can also increase blood sugar and eventually cause lack of focus and energy. It's also worth noting that people [5]_____ differently to coffee. Some people can drink it at [6]_____ and go straight to sleep, whereas others get feelings of anxiety after a small amount. Also remember that coffee from a coffee shop may be stronger than coffee made at home, so stop drinking coffee by 2 p.m. and have a [7]_____ of two cups of coffee a day. But be aware of your own [8]_____ to it. Whole grain foods will ward off hunger. Examples include porridge and whole wheat bread. [9]_____ whole grain foods with protein will help keep your blood sugar levels balanced, which is essential for mood and concentration. Berries and nuts are a convenient and [10]_____ snack. [11]_____, like many dark-colored fruits and vegetables, can slow down brain damage and age-related decline. Frozen berries are also a good choice; they are usually cheap, last longer, and don't lose their [12]_____ when frozen. But [13]_____ and coated nuts are less healthy, as they contain added oil, salt, and sugar. Doctors often recommend taking vitamin supplements to top up on the [14]_____ you need, but I would say food should always come before supplements. And the key to getting as many [15]_____ as possible is to eat a varied diet, with lots of different colors such as frozen berries and dark green vegetables. It's better to get everything you need from food and drink. For example, oranges contain not only [16]_____ C, which boosts the immune system, but also fiber and other components that you can't get packaged together in a tablet. Don't forget to drink a proper amount of water, which can boost attention by almost 25 percent, and can [17]_____ your mood as well. Finally, don't skip meals. Eating regularly will help keep blood sugar [18]_____ and feed the brain with the fuel it needs.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

The late Swedish academic Hans Rosling has identified a [1]_____ trend. Not only do many people across advanced economies have no idea that the world is becoming a much better place, but they actually even think the [2]_____. This is no wonder, when the news focuses on reporting [3]_____, terrorist attacks, wars, and famines. Who wants to hear about the fact that every day some 200,000 people around the

world are [4]_____ above the two-dollar-a-day poverty line. Or that more than 300,000 people get access to [5]_____ and clean water for the first time every day. These stories of people in low-income countries simply don't make for [6]_____ news coverage, but as Rosling pointed out in his book Factfulness, it's important to put all the bad news in perspective. While it is true that [7]_____ has put some downward pressure on middle-class wages in advanced economies in recent decades, it has also helped lift hundreds of millions of people above the global poverty line. If we really care about global welfare, [8]_____ is the only way forward to ensure that economic prosperity is shared among all countries and not only a select few advanced economies. While some people [9]_____ the past, one of the big facts of economic history is that until quite recently, a significant part of the world population has lived under quite miserable conditions, and this has been true throughout most of human history. While there were many long-lasting ups and downs, like the Great Depression or the recent Great Recession, the [10]_____ of the long-run growth rate is actually quite miraculous. Low-income countries, including China and India, have been growing at a significantly faster [11]_____ in recent decades, and are quickly catching up to the West. A 10% growth rate over a [12]_____ period means that income levels double roughly every seven years. It is obviously good news if prosperity is more shared across the globe, while inequality within countries has gone up as a result of [13]_____, global inequality has been on a steady downward trend for several decades. This is mostly a result of the [14]_____ of hundreds of millions of people's living standards. In fact, for the first time ever since the Industrial Revolution, about half of the global population can be considered middle class.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

We all know that the sense of smell is powerful. The delicious [1]_____ of bread, for example, can act like a time machine. One [2]_____ can bring back a memory from many years ago. Indeed, scent particles in general can [3]_____ memories that have been long forgotten. But why do smells sometimes [4]_____ powerful memories, especially emotional ones? The short answer is that the brain regions that handle smells, memories, and [5]_____ are linked. A [6]_____ is a chemical particle that floats in through the nose and into the region of the brain responsible for smell, where the sensation is first processed into a form that the brain can

read. Brain cells then carry that information to the area of the brain where emotions are processed, and then to an [7]_____ area of the brain where learning and memory formation take place. [8]_____ are the only sensations that travel such a direct path to the emotional and memory centers of the brain, that results in an intimate connection between emotions, memories, and scents, which is why memories triggered by scents are experienced as more emotional than those triggered by sight or sound. Let's take a closer look at how those memories are [9]_____. Usually, when a person smells something that's connected to a meaningful event in their past, they'll first have an emotional response to the [10]_____, and then a memory might follow. But sometimes the memory doesn't come to the surface. The person might feel the [11]_____ of something that happened in the past but won't remember what they experienced. What causes this baffling phenomenon? The explanation is context. Imagine this scenario: a person is walking down the street, smelling a scent that they first encountered decades ago, which [12]_____ an emotional response. If the person had first come across that smell in a very different context, it will be much more difficult to [13]_____ the associated memory because the brain uses the context to give meaning to the information and find that memory. The special nature of memories brought back by scents, notwithstanding, they have the same [14]_____ as other memories, they aren't always accurate, and they can change over time. In fact, each time we remember something, that memory can become [15]_____. But because of the strong emotional associations these memories [16]_____, people who remember something due to a scent are often convinced that the memories are accurate, even when they aren't.

2024年12月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Okay then, this here is your [1]_____ performance review? You've been with the company for three years and under my direct [2]_____ for the past 12 months. Your report is mostly good, but there are a couple of issues we must [3]_____. The report is yours to take with you. We'll go through the main points together now, and you can comb through it in greater detail later. Do you have any questions before we start? No, sir. I'll get straight to it then. It is [4]_____ that you are a hard worker. You are punctual and industrious. Furthermore, you have strong [5]_____ skills and attention to detail. The company, myself included, are happy with your [6]_____ and overall performance. Thank you. I appreciate the recognition. Do you agree then with this [7]_____ so far? Yeah, it's a little [8]_____, perhaps, but that's to be expected from this kind of evaluation. Sure. Would you want to add anything? Your comments can be added to the report if you wish. Oh, there's no need. It's a flattering portrayal, really. Thank you, though. Okay, this leads me to the not so good part. This mostly centers around one [9]_____ aspect, your ability to work with others. I see. Yes, as you already know, over the last several months there have been some [10]_____ raised about your communication style. Of course, we already had like three meetings about this. Look, all I'm going to say is that it was never my intention to [11]_____ anyone. Simply put, I don't like to write long emails because, [12]_____, I think they're a waste of time. Conciseness is efficiency. I feel that writing long emails hurts that same productivity you praised me for just a minute ago, and I already apologized if anyone was [13]_____, but to be perfectly honest, I think anyone who was offended was being a little too sensitive.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

So tell me, why do you wish to study [1]_____? I've always wanted to be a doctor. I come from a small town where healthcare was never the best, and I think that had a [2]_____ effect on me. As a child, I remember thinking how great it would be to serve the community and [3]_____ people. What other people or events in your life have [4]_____ your interest in becoming a doctor? Well, that's hard to say. I would certainly

say my parents have been a key factor. They always pushed me to study hard, and I certainly wouldn't be here without their support. I guess I was also [5]_____ fortunate to have good teachers and friends around me. At the end of the day, I've always been surrounded by a positive environment, [6]_____ to my working hard and pursuing my dreams. Is there any medical [7]_____ that you would like to specialize in? I haven't decided yet. It's still early days. However, if I had to say, internal medicine. Why internal medicine? I know it's no picnic, but I find it the most [8]_____ because it covers so much and ties together so many other specialties. Thank you. Now I'd like to address your academic history and [9]_____ grades. We like to think of ourselves as a [10]_____ institution with a highly competitive and promising student body. As you know, to get into our programs, you need at least an 85% score in the entrance exam. Do you think you can attain this? I think so. Yes. I'm looking at your school grades now, and I'll be honest, it's a bit of a mixed bag. You do get top grades here and there, but you are not very, shall we say, [11]_____. I see no problem in making you a conditional offer, but consider yourself [12]_____. Our entrance exam is to use your own words, no picnic.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Logging into your email account can sometimes feel like trying to hack into the [1]_____. If you follow all of the guidelines, you need to use a different password for every one of your accounts, use an [2]_____ variety of letters, numbers, and symbols, sign up for two-step verification, and change every password every time one of them is compromised. More often than not, you then have to choose photos that include a street sign, as this apparently provides [3]_____ evidence to your computer that you are, in fact, a human being. It's no small wonder most of us forget our [4]_____ more often than our keys. Now, a new peer-reviewed study by [5]_____ at Aalto University in Finland is attempting to figure out why we forget our passwords in order to help put an end to this frustrating phenomenon. Their findings suggest that how likely you are to remember your password has less to do with the [6]_____ of the password itself, and more to do with how often you anticipate using it. Which is to say, you are far more likely to remember a complicated password if you know you'll frequently be using it to log into an account than you are to remember a simple password for an account that you don't expect to log into very often, the [7]_____ advise

websites to include more of an incentive for users to log in more often in order to help them remember their secret codes.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Four years ago, Jenny Weiner was in a fitness [1]_____. She wanted to [2]_____ her physical and mental health. However, her [3]_____ lacked intensity without a proper training program to follow. When she went to the gym, her daily ritual predominantly involved easy exercise options like [4]_____. She avoided more [5]_____ exercises like lifting weights. A personal trainer who might push her was out of the question. The extravagant cost was just unaffordable. She then [6]_____ the fitness phone app Slimmeretics. To use the app, you first input your profile about your previous training experiences and [7]_____, as well as your desired goals. A virtual coach then uses that information to suggest a [8]_____ training regime. After the [9]_____, the app's artificial intelligence software system uses feedback from Miss Weiner and its other 53 million users around the world to adjust future training sessions. Now, Miss Weiner finds the workouts exciting. This is because no two are ever the same. As a result, the app has helped her to lose more than 25 [10]_____. The app's mathematical approach can arrange a more [11]_____ workout schedule. This has led to optimal results. However, some [12]_____ think that apps cannot replace human personal trainers. An app cannot understand human behavior. It will not [13]_____ that there are competing interests outside of health and fitness. Additionally, a human trainer can add [14]_____ to the workout. He can also make exercise fun and [15]_____. [16]_____ can monitor whether a person is doing exercises correctly, this can safeguard against injuries. An app cannot perceive such subtleties.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

All societies are held together by seven universal moral rules, which include deferring to superiors and respecting the property of others, Oxford University has [1]_____. Although many cultures are moving towards more liberal, less [2]_____ organizations, the new research suggests that traditional power structures and basic values of charity and brotherhood are the cornerstones of successful societies. The huge study of 60

different cultures around the world found that all communities [3]_____ under seven basic moral codes. Those universal rules are: help your family, help your group, return favors, be [4]_____, defer to superiors, divide resources fairly, and respect the property of others. The character traits held for every kind of community, be they traditional hunter-gatherers or advanced civilizations, helping to [5]_____ civilized society and foster social cooperation, researchers found. Everyone, everywhere, shares a common moral code," said Dr. Oliver Scott Curry, lead author and senior [6]_____ at Oxford. These seven [7]_____ rules appear to be universal across cultures because people face the same social problems. Even if some of these traits look right-wing or conservative, for example, deferring to authority, left-wing people will still have a group loyalty and [8]_____ to someone or something. This shows there really is more that [9]_____ us than divides us. The study published in Current [10]_____ is the largest and most comprehensive and widespread survey of morals ever conducted, and aimed to find out whether different societies had different versions of morality. The team accessed the world's best archives to [11]_____ accounts from more than 600 sources of 60 societies around the world. They found that the seven rules were considered [12]_____ good in all societies and were observed across all continents, religions, and politics. However, some communities valued certain rules more highly than others. Dr. Curry hopes that this research helps to promote mutual understanding between people of different cultures, and appreciation of what we have in common, and how and why we [13]_____. Co-author Professor Harvey Whitehouse said social scientists should now set about testing the theory in the field rather than relying on old data. This study was based on [14]_____ descriptions of cultures around the world. He said, these [15]_____ were made independent of and prior to the theory we're testing. In future, if social scientists are serious about testing theories of morality, they will need to gather new data more [16]_____ out in the field.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

When it comes to food, color is money. Food companies know that better color gives better prices, so they ensure that their products are attractive in color to [1]_____ earnings. Oranges, for example, have to meet specific color standards, and oranges are just the beginning. There are color standards for foods including French fries, tomatoes, [2]_____, olives, honey, and cherries. The attention to color is for good reason. For all the

talk of the [3]_____, our eyes really might be the most important part of the eating experience. A great number of our brain functions are dedicated to processing vision, while only a percent or two is given over to taste [4]_____, and the result is that color actually changes how we taste food. Scientists have [5]_____ many times the importance of color to taste. In a 1980s study, for example, test participants were asked to name the flavor of the [6]_____ they were drinking, without being able to see that beverage. Only one in five was able to identify it as orange, but when they were allowed to see what they were drinking, which was orange in color, each of them identified the orange [7]_____. And when a drink that was lime flavor was colored orange, nearly half of [8]_____ identified the flavor of the beverage as orange. None made that mistake when the [9]_____ was green in color. What's happening when someone fails to identify the flavor of a [10]_____ they can't see or that has an abnormal color? Is it that participants can't [11]_____ what the flavor is and so rely on visual cues, or does color actually change the experience of taste? The key to these questions is the effect of color on [12]_____. The brain makes predictions using color. These predictions rely on [13]_____ that come from experience. Research shows that we're all born liking sweet things and desire to eat them, but we aren't born knowing what the sweet things we [14]_____ look like. So we need to learn this over time. The brain gets information from the environment, and we learn, for example, that fruits go from green and sour to red and [15]_____ and sweet. Thus, if we see a green berry, we equate its color with a sour taste, and just looking at a red fruit will [16]_____ our expectations that it will taste sweet and delicious.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Searching for meaning is something many of us experience throughout our lives. For some, this meaning is religious, some political, and some [1]_____. And having a sense of meaning can bring us [2]_____. A new study looks at the relationship between meaning and happiness in the context of financial [3]_____. Rhia Catapano from the University of Toronto and colleagues find meaning is a far weaker [4]_____ of happiness for rich people than poorer people, suggesting economic resources can impact how we experience meaning. The team [5]_____ data from over 500,000 people across 123 countries. The first study used data from a daily [6]_____ of U.S. residents collected between 2013 and 2015,

well-being was tracked using measures of positive affect. Whether during the day, before they were surveyed, [7]_____ had smiled or laughed a lot, or experienced a lot of happiness. Meaning was measured through a daily purpose index, which explored the extent to which [8]_____ felt that they like what they do every day and are motivated to achieve their goals. Finally, income levels were assessed. The results showed that the [9]_____ between meaning and happiness was strongest among those in lower income brackets, but as income levels increased, the correlation became weaker. The second study looked at worldwide data. [10]_____ was measured using the same questions as in the first study, while meaning was measured using the single question, "Do you feel your life has an important purpose or meaning?" Again, the strength of the relationship between meaning and happiness depended on [11]_____' income. Meaning had a greater influence on happiness for those on lower incomes compared to those in higher [12]_____. In the final study, French participants indicated the extent to which they felt they led a [13]_____ and meaningful life, and how much they considered themselves a happy person. Finally, rather than using specific income brackets, they placed themselves on a social [14]_____, representing where they stand in society with regard to wealth, education, and career. The results from the study [15]_____ those of the first two. So, overall, meaning and happiness had a stronger relationship in those with fewer [16]_____ than those with more. This might be the case because richer individuals have more access to other sources of [17]_____, many of which will be external, like lack of stress or community. Thus, a focus on an internal sense of [18]_____, purpose, or meaning is less important.

2024年6月 第2套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Thank you for meeting with me, Stephen, at such short notice. Not a problem, Margaret. Now, please give me some good news. Have you agreed to my last proposal? I have indeed, and I wish to sign the agreement [1]_____ one small change to be made to the contract. Margaret, we have been through this for almost a year now, back and forth making [2]_____. Are you sure you want to make a [3]_____ deal for your clients or not? I ask this because, [4]_____, some people at my end are running out of patience. I understand your concerns, but as I'm sure you understand, we hold our clients' best interests to be of the [5]_____ concern. We therefore comb through the fine details of all contracts, rest assured, we all appreciate your firm's [6]_____. Okay, fine. So, what changes do you wish to make? Essentially, we would like the new deal to [7]_____ the Middle East. That's all. The Middle East. Why? My client has a couple of other prospective marketing deals from companies in the Middle East; those offers, should they [8]_____, would exclusively employ my client's image in the Middle East only. Therefore, in order to avoid any conflict, we would need to ensure that both marketing campaigns do not overlap [9]_____. What business [10]_____ in the Middle East are we talking about here? Real estate. Well, that should be okay then, so long as the product is very different from our food and [11]_____ market, there should be no conflict of interest. [12]_____, I will have to run this through my people. I don't foresee any problem, though. The Middle East is a [13]_____ market for us, but I still need to check this with a couple of departments.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Next, we have a special science-related news story. Paula Hancock is at the Denver Observatory. Paula, what is the big story over there? Hi, John. Yes, all the [1]_____ on site here are very excited. In fact, space enthusiasts all across North America and the rest of the northern hemisphere will be [2]_____ on mountain tops tonight to watch the night sky. Why? What's the big event? Is there an eclipse happening soon? Tonight, the Earth will come into close proximity with the Oppenheimer [3]_____. It is the closest our planet

has been to such a [4]_____ in over 100 years. For this reason, it is expected that 1000s of people will gaze up at the sky tonight in order to see this [5]_____ object. How far away is this comet? Will people be able to see it with the naked eye? The Oppenheimer [6]_____ will still be millions of miles away, on the edge of our galaxy. But nevertheless, this is a relatively close distance, close enough for people to observe in good detail through a [7]_____. People will only see a [8]_____ without one. However, that does not mean one needs professional equipment. Even the most ordinary of telescopes should be [9]_____ for people to observe and wonder at this flying object. Many of our [10]_____ will be wondering how they too can take part in this once-in-a-lifetime event. Where will this [11]_____ be in the sky. How can people find it? The comet will be almost exactly due north, at 60 degrees above the [12]_____. However, finding the [13]_____ is indeed very tricky, and scientists here have told me there are plenty of phone apps that will facilitate this. How fantastic! Thank you, Paula, for the information.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Dietary [1]_____ form the basis for nutrition advice and regulations around the world. While there is strong scientific consensus around most existing [2]_____, one question has recently stirred debate: Should consumers be warned to avoid ultra-processed foods? Two papers published today in the American Journal of Clinical Nutrition outline the case for and against using the concept of ultra-processed foods to help inform dietary [3]_____ beyond conventional food classification systems. The authors, Carlos Monteiro of the University of Sao Paulo, and Arne Astrup of Novo Nordisk Foundation will discuss the issue in a live virtual debate, august 14, during [4]_____ 2024 live online. The debate centers around a system developed by Monteiro and colleagues that classifies foods by their degree of industrial processing, ranging from [5]_____ to ultra-processed. The system defines ultra-processed foods as those made using sequences of processes that extract substances from foods and alter them with chemicals in order to [6]_____ the final product. Ultra-processed foods are [7]_____ designed to be cheap, tasty, and convenient. Examples include soft drinks and candy, packaged snacks and pastries, ready-to-heat products, and [8]_____ meat products. Studies have linked consumption of ultra-processed foods, which are often high in salt, sugar, and fat, with weight gain and an increased risk of [9]_____ diseases, even

after adjusting for the amount of salt, sugar, and fat in the diet. While the mechanisms behind these associations are not fully understood, Monteiro argues that the existing evidence is sufficient to justify [10]_____ consumption of ultra-processed foods in dietary recommendations and government policies.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Believe it or not, human creativity benefits from [1]_____. According to [2]_____, when you have less to work with, you actually begin to see the world differently. With [3]_____, you dedicate your mental energy to acting more resourcefully. When challenged, you figure out new ways to be better. The most successful creative people know that constraints give their minds the [4]_____ to leap higher. People who [5]_____ new products are not limited by what they don't have or can't do; they leverage their limitations to push themselves even further. Many products and services are created because the founders saw a [6]_____ in what they use, they created innovation based on what was not working for them at the moment. Innovation is a creative person's response to [7]_____. In a 2015 study, which examined how thinking about scarcity or abundance influences how [8]_____ people use their resources, Ravi Mehta at the University of Illinois and Meng Zhu at Johns Hopkins University found that people simply have no incentive to use what's available to them in novel ways. When people face [9]_____, they give themselves the freedom to use resources in less conventional ways because they have to. Obstacles can [10]_____ your perception and open up your thinking processes. Consistent [11]_____ help you improve at connecting unrelated ideas and concepts. Marissa Mayer, former vice president for search products and user experience at Google once wrote in a publication on Bloomberg: [12]_____ shape and focus problems and provide clear challenges to overcome. Creativity thrives best when constrained.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Different people use different strategies for [1]_____ conflicts. These strategies are learned in childhood. Usually, we are not aware of how we act in [2]_____ situations. We just do whatever seems to come naturally. But we do have a personal strategy, and because it is learned, we can always change it by learning new and more effective ways of [3]_____ conflicts. When you get involved in a conflict, there are two major

concerns you have to take into account: [4]_____ your personal goals and keeping a good relationship with the other person. How important your personal goals are and how important the relationship is to you [5]_____ how you act in a conflict. Given these two concerns, five styles of [6]_____ conflicts can be identified. One, the turtle. [7]_____ withdraw into their shells to avoid conflicts. They give up their personal goals and relationships. They believe it is easier to withdraw from a [8]_____ than to face it. Two, the shark. Sharks try to [9]_____ opponents by forcing them to accept their solution to the conflict. They seek to [10]_____ their goals at all costs. [11]_____ assume that conflicts are settled by one person winning and one person losing. Winning gives [12]_____ a sense of pride and achievement. Losing gives them a sense of weakness, [13]_____, and failure. Three, the teddy bear. Teddy bears want to be accepted and liked by other people, they think that conflict should be avoided in favor of [14]_____, and believe that conflicts cannot be discussed without damaging relationships. They give up their goals to [15]_____ the relationship. Four, the fox, foxes are [16]_____ concerned with their own goals and about their relationships with other people, they give up part of their goals and persuade the other person in a conflict to give up part of his goals. They [17]_____ a solution to conflicts where both sides gain something. Five. The owl. [18]_____ view conflicts as problems to be solved. They see conflicts as improving relationships by reducing [19]_____ between two people. They try to begin a discussion that identifies the conflict as a problem by seeking solutions that [20]_____ both themselves and the other person. Owls maintain the relationship. [21]_____ are not satisfied until a solution is found that achieves their own goals and the other person's goals, and they are not satisfied until the tensions and negative feelings have been fully resolved.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Recording two, the genetic code of all 1.5 million known species of animals and plants living on Earth will be mapped to help save species from [1]_____ and boost human health. Scientists hope that cracking the genetic code of plants and animals could help [2]_____ new treatments for infectious diseases, slow aging, improve crops and agriculture, and create new biomaterials. In Britain, organizations including the Natural History Museum, the Royal Botanic Gardens at Kew, and the Wellcome Sanger Institute have joined forces to sequence Britain's 66,000 species of animals and plants, [3]_____ the Darwin Tree of Life Project, it is

expected to take 10 years and cost 100 million pounds. Once completed, all the information will be publicly available to [4]_____. Many scientists believe that Earth has now entered the sixth mass extinction, with humans creating a toxic mix of habitat loss, pollution, and climate change, which has already led to the loss of at least 77 species of [5]_____ and 140 types of birds since 1500. It is the biggest loss of species since the [6]_____ were wiped out 66 million years ago. Scientists say that sequencing every species will [7]_____ the understanding of biology and evolution, bolster efforts to conserve as well as protect and restore biodiversity. Dr. Tim Littlewood, head of life sciences department at the Natural History Museum, said, "Whether you are interested in food or disease, the history of how every [8]_____ on the planet has adapted to its environment is recorded in its genetic makeup. How you then [9]_____ that is dependent on your ability to understand it. We will be using modern methods to get a really good window on the present and the past, and of course, a window on the past gives you a [10]_____ model on the future. Sir Jim Smith, director of science at Wellcome, said, "Try as I might, I can't think of a more exciting, more relevant, more timely, or more internationally [11]_____ project." Since 1970, [12]_____ has wiped out 60% of animal populations. About 23,000 of 80,000 species surveyed are approaching [13]_____. We are in the midst of the sixth great extinction event of life on our planet, which not only threatens wildlife species but also [14]_____ the global food supply. As scientists, we all realize we desperately need to catalog life on our [15]_____ planet now. I think we're making history.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

John Donne, the English [1]_____, wrote in the 17th century, "No man is an island entire of itself. Every man is a piece of the [2]_____, a part of the main." Now, a British academic has claimed that human [3]_____ is indeed just an illusion, because societies are far more interconnected at a mental, physical, and cultural level than people realize. In his new book, *The Self [4]_____*, Professor Tom Oliver, a researcher in the Ecology and Evolution Group at the University of Reading, argues there is no such thing as self, and not even our bodies are truly us. Just as Copernicus realized the Earth is not the center of the universe, Professor Oliver said society [5]_____ needs a Copernican-like revolution to understand people are not detached beings, but rather part of one connected identity. A significant milestone in the cultural

evolution of human minds was the acceptance that the Earth is not the center of the universe, the so-called [6] _____ revolution. He writes, however, we have one more big myth to dispose of, that we exist as independent selves at the center of a [7] _____ universe. You may feel as if you are an independent individual acting [8] _____ in the world, that you have unchanging inner self that persists throughout your lifetime, acting as a central anchor point with the world changing around you. This is the [9] _____ I seek to tackle. We are [10] _____ connected to the world around us, Professor Oliver argues there are around 37 trillion cells in the body, but most have a lifespan of just a few days or weeks. So the material us is constantly changing. In fact, there is no part of your body that has [11] _____ for more than 10 years. Since our bodies are essentially made anew every few weeks, the material in them alone is clearly [12] _____ to explain the persistent thread of an identity. Professor Oliver claims that [13] _____ is actually bad for society, and only by realizing we are part of a bigger entity, can we solve pressing environmental and societal problems? Through selfish [14] _____, we are destroying the natural world and using non-renewable resources at an accelerating rate. We are at a critical [15] _____ as a species, where we must rapidly reform our mindsets and behavior to act in less selfish ways," he said. So let's open our eyes to the [16] _____ connections all around us.

2024年6月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

I've just bought a new blender. What's that? A [1]_____, you know, a machine that blends food. Ah, yes, of course, the electric kitchen [2]_____. Exactly, this one is state of the art. I've been meaning to buy one for a while, and I did [3]_____ research on which specific model to get. I read through maybe hundreds of online user reviews. Anyway, it's amazing. Really, what could be so special about it? I mean, it's just a blender. Well, [4]_____, it's just a very good one. It feels heavy and [5]_____ and well made. It also has lots of power and can easily cut and [6]_____ practically anything. This way, the soups and juices I make come out really fine and smooth, with no [7]_____ bits. Hmm. I see. I've never thought of getting one myself. It sounds like the kind of thing that, for me personally, I would [8]_____ use. I've never had one before, and now that I do, I use it all the time. I make a fresh fruit [9]_____ in the morning. Maybe not every morning, but three or four times a week, and it feels [10]_____. It's a really healthy habit. I can imagine that must feel quite [11]_____. I can picture you getting all creative in the kitchen and trying out a multitude of different ingredients, and it's obviously going to be healthier than buying [12]_____ juice from a supermarket. It's so much healthier. It's not even close. Did you know that store-bought [13]_____ is like 10% sugar? Right. So then you bought it for the health benefits? Mostly, yes. Basically, it allows me to have a more varied diet with a far wider [14]_____ of nutrients, because it's not only fruit in my morning juices, you see, I can also throw in vegetables, nuts, yogurts, cereals, anything that tickles my fancy.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Today we have a very interesting guest, Mr. Thomas Benjamin Grimm, the mayor of Berkton, is here to talk about his job and responsibilities [1]_____ this charming village. Mr. Grimm, thank you for being here. Thank you for having me. I'd like to start by stating the obvious. Berkton has become one of the most popular [2]_____ destinations in the country, and this has happened under your watch. Just how did you achieve this? The [3]_____ belongs to all the residents of Berkton. It was a shared effort where everybody

pitched in for the [4]_____ good. But how did this change happen? In about 10 years, Berkton has gone from a relatively unheard-of, [5]_____ village to a must-see destination. Yes, the change has truly been remarkable. Berkton was always fortunate to be endowed with such a beautiful natural [6]_____. The Enbury Hills above the village remain [7]_____ by human development, and the Sonora Valley just below it is equally stunning. The transformation [8]_____ in a town hall meeting in spring 2008, over 10 years ago now, when an overwhelming majority of neighbors voted in favor of Motion 836. This legislative proposal essentially set out to harmonize the [9]_____ appearance of all the houses in Berkton. The idea was that if all the properties looked a certain way with shared design features, then a village as a whole would look more beautiful, and it worked. It certainly did. I'm looking now at a before and after photo, and the change is truly [10]_____. It's hard to believe it's the same place. And how do the neighbors feel now? Great pride, I would say. But what about the [11]_____ of visitors now crowding the streets? Is everyone happy about that? The tourists we receive are a blessing as they have completely [12]_____ our local economy. Every visitor is warmly welcome.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

[1]_____ in the U.S. have created a remote-controlled robot that is so small it can walk on the top of a U.S. penny. In research published in the journal Science Robotics, a team at Northwestern University said the crab-like robot is 0.5 [2]_____ wide. [3]_____ described it as the smallest ever remote-controlled walking robot. The tiny robot can bend, twist, [4]_____, walk, turn, and even jump without the use of complex hardware or special power. The engineers said this is because the robot is powered by the [5]_____ property of its body. To construct the robot, the [6]_____ used a shape memory alloy material that transforms to its remembered shape when heated. Using a [7]_____, the team is able to heat the robot at specific parts of its body, causing it to change shape. As the robot [8]_____ and goes back to its original shape, it creates movement from one place to another. Because these structures are so tiny, the rate of [9]_____ is very fast. Project Lead Professor John A. Rogers said. In fact, reducing the sizes of these [10]_____ allows them to run faster. While the research is still in the [11]_____ phase, the team believes that technology could lead to micro-sized robots that can perform practical tasks in tightly confined

spaces. You might imagine micro robots as agents to repair or assemble small structures or machines in industry, or as surgical assistance to clear [12]_____ arteries, to stop internal bleeding or to eliminate cancerous tumors, all in minimally invasive procedures. Rogers said.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

I don't want to [1]_____ or anything, but I have always considered myself something of an elite sleeper. Given the opportunity, I will sleep for marathon stretches and can [2]_____ through the most extreme situations. On one very rough ferry crossing on the route to the Isles of Scilly, for example, my traveling companion spent the entire three-hour ride throwing up in the bathroom, while I [3]_____ happily on a plastic chair. Unfortunately, it has come to my attention that I am not an [4]_____ sleeper after all. It seems I am just lazy, because elite sleepers are defined as the approximately 3% of the population who are [5]_____ programmed to need less sleep than the rest of us. According to a study that came out in March, elite [6]_____ have rare genetic changes, which means they can sleep fewer hours than mere mortals without any risk of cognitive decline. It may not be possible to change your own [7]_____, but can you train yourself to need less sleep? Is there a non-biological way to reach [8]_____ sleeper status. I have spent the past year trying to answer that question, not for fun, I should add, but because having a baby has severely [9]_____ my sleep, for which I still have a great passion. For a while, I assumed I'd be forced to become one of those people who jump out of bed at the crack of dawn, after a year of tough scientific study, however, I have [10]_____ being forced to get up early in the morning is very different from being an early bird.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

If you read an article about a [1]_____ issue, do you think you'd realize if it had changed your beliefs? No one knows your own mind like you do. It seems obvious that you would know if your beliefs had shifted, and yet a new paper in the Quarterly Journal of Experimental Psychology suggests that we actually have very poor awareness of our own belief change, meaning that we will tend to underestimate how much we've been [2]_____ by a convincing article. The researchers recruited over 200 [3]_____ across two studies and focused on their beliefs about whether physical punishment of kids is an effective form of discipline.

The students reported their initial beliefs about whether physical punishment is an effective way to discipline a child, on a scale from one completely [4]_____ to nine completely believe. Several weeks later, they were given one of two research-based texts to read, each with several pages long, and either presented the [5]_____ and data in favor of physical punishment or against it. After this, the students answered some questions to test their [6]_____ and memory of the text. Then, the students again scored their [7]_____ in whether physical punishment is effective or not. Finally, the [8]_____ asked them to recall what their belief had been at the start of the study. The students' [9]_____ about physical punishment changed when they read a text that argued against their own initial position. [10]_____, the memory of their initial belief was shifted in the direction of their new belief. In fact, their memory was closer to their current [11]_____ than their original belief. The more their belief had changed, the larger this memory bias tended to be, suggesting the students were relying on their current belief to [12]_____ their initial belief. The memory bias was [13]_____ to the measures of how well they'd understood or recalled the text, suggesting these factors didn't play a role in memory of initial belief or awareness of belief change. The researchers [14]_____ that this research was about changes to mostly moderate beliefs. It's likely the findings would be different in the context of changes to extreme or deeply held [15]_____. However, our beliefs on most topics are in the moderate range, and as we go about our daily lives reading [16]_____ material, these intriguing findings suggest we are mostly ignorant of how what we just read has updated and altered our own position.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

As the American population grows, so does the number of American moms. But more than a century after Mother's Day became an official [1]_____, even as that number increases, the share of the American population who are mothers is at the lowest point in a quarter century. It's frequently noted that fertility rates are falling sharply in richer countries, but the less observed consequence of this trend is that a decline in births can also mean a decline in [2]_____ in general. According to my analysis of data from the Census Bureau: the decline of American [3]_____ is real, occurring very quickly and may continue for some time yet. Not only are moms making up less of the population, but their characteristics are changing too, and in

a way that might be linked to their [4]_____ decline. Moms today tend to be older than in the past. Just looking at recent years, the change in age-specific birth rates has been [5]_____. In just the past few years, the peak [6]_____ age range for American women has advanced from that of 25 to 29 to that of 30 to 34. Meanwhile, [7]_____ among women under 20 has fallen by half or more, while childbearing among women 35 and older is rising. One positive consequence of this age shift is that a larger proportion of new mothers are [8]_____ prepared to raise children. Less [9]_____, however, many women find that as they age, they can't have as many kids as they would like. Plus, having children later in life can increase the risk of health [10]_____. These finer points aside, one major [11]_____ of the older mom's trend is that fewer years of a woman's life are spent as a mother. This means that at any given time, a larger share of women, and thus of the whole population, will report not having children in government [12]_____. In other words, later [13]_____ means less motherhood. Even as [14]_____ rates decline, Mother's Day, of course, endure. In fact, despite the [15]_____ shift, retail spending on the holiday appears to be rising. It is hard to say if Mother's Day [16]_____ is rising more than one would expect, given that the American population keeps growing. But one factor might be that the proportion of women who are the mothers of adult children is rising, and those adult children may spend more [17]_____ when it comes to celebrating the moms they no longer live with.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Since NASA published a paper in 1989 claiming that house plants can soak up pollution and toxic chemicals, businesses and homeowners have increasingly invested in [1]_____ to help clean their air, but a new analysis suggests it could actually take more than 1,000 plants per square meter to gain a benefit any greater than simply opening a couple of windows. The problem lies in the fact that NASA conducted their tests in sealed containers that do not [2]_____ the conditions in most people's homes or offices. The space agency was primarily concerned about keeping the air fresh for astronauts cut off in biospheres or space stations, and helping to combat sick building syndrome, which had become a problem due to the super-insulated and energy-efficient offices of the late 1970s, by the early 1980s, workers regularly complained of skin rashes, [3]_____, headaches, and allergies as they breathed in toxic chemicals from paints and plastics. NASA

found that certain plants could remove [4]_____ from the air, and even today, garden centers recommend the plants for air cleaning properties. However, a new evaluation of dozens of studies [5]_____ 30 years found that house plants in a normal environment have little impact. In fact, natural [6]_____ is far better at cleaning the air. The researchers also calculated the clean air delivery rate for plants in the studies they analyzed, and found that the rate at which plants [7]_____ the compounds was well below the usual rate of air exchange in a normal building, caused by the movement of people coming and going, opening doors and windows. Many of the studies did show a reduction in the concentration of [8]_____ organic compounds over time, which is likely why people have seized on them to praise the air-purifying virtues of plants. But the researchers' [9]_____ showed it would take 10 to 1,000 plants per square meter of floor space to compete with the air cleaning capacity of a building's air handling system, or even just a couple of open windows in a house. In contrast, NASA's [10]_____ experiment recommended one pot plant per 100 square feet. This is certainly an example of how scientific findings can be misleading or [11]_____ over time, but it's also a great example of how scientific research should continually re-examine and question findings to get closer to the ground truth of understanding what's actually happening.

2023年12月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

So I've been thinking this summer, instead of our usual holiday [1]_____, I'd like to try renting a camper van and exploring a bit more. A camper van? You mean to spend the summer living out of a car? Yes, a camper van. And no, it's nothing like living out of a car. These are [2]_____ vans with full-sized beds to sleep in. Some even have kitchens. This way, we wouldn't have to be locked into one place during our holiday. We'd be able to visit so many more places and travel at our own pace. The rates of most hotels and holiday homes really [3]_____ in the summer anyway, we'd probably save a lot of money as well. I think my [4]_____ had a van like that. It doesn't sound that appealing to me. Today's camper vans are completely different. These days they're equipped with all the modern [5]_____. I've seen quite a few with solar panels that provide [6]_____ for when you're stopped, this way you can still use your computer or charge your phone, and most even have Wi-Fi. So if the weather's not great, you could [7]_____ videos. I'm warming up to the idea. Keep talking. Loads of people are [8]_____ to this trend full time. Check it out online. Lots of people stream videos of their alternative [9]_____ and actually earn a salary. Imagine having that kind of freedom to go anywhere you want and work from anywhere in the world. Okay, we can consider it as long as the basic needs like [10]_____ and showers are covered. I'm definitely in. Do you think there will be enough room for my mountain bike. What about food delivery? Will we be able to order to the van? Will there be enough space for the dog? We wouldn't want to leave him behind. Slow down. Glad you're excited about it. Let's start by looking at what's available first.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

You wanted to see me. Yes, I'll get straight to the point. Over the past month or so, it has become apparent that your performance has [1]_____. You've been late to work several times these past few weeks, which is very [2]_____ of you. But what really concerns me is your [3]_____ output. [4]_____, you seem to be constantly one step behind. What's going on? I'm sorry. I'm going through some

[5] _____ family issues at the moment. It's a personal matter, so if you don't mind, I much [6] _____ we don't get into it. [7] _____, I expect it to have all blown over in another month or so. Do you need some time off? Actually, yes. Would it be possible to take the next two Mondays off? I was [8] _____ whether I should ask for this, but now that we're here, sure thing. But if you needed some leave, why didn't you ask for it earlier? I'm not sure why. I guess I kind of felt bad asking for it. You shouldn't feel bad asking for leave, especially if you need it. I know you're right. I'm sorry. Look, you've been with us almost five years, and I personally really value your [9] _____ at your job. It makes my job far easier. In addition, I can [10] _____ you that management as a whole also holds you in high regard. Thank you. What I need is for you to be back at your 100%. Are you sure taking two Mondays off will [11] _____? It'll be enough. I'm sure of it. Okay, good. So this is what we're going to do. You will take those days off, and I expect that you will [12] _____ come back to your usual self. Then, in two months' time, we will catch up again to see how you are [13] _____. Sounds good. Thank you for your understanding.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

There are many [1] _____ that impact our health. These include our finances, our [2] _____, and the way we work. Education is one such factor. Research suggests that higher levels of education can lead to better health and even greater [3] _____, but what about the education of your partner? New research seeks to answer this question. Researchers use data from a longitudinal study. The data came from surveys first [4] _____ to high school seniors in 1957. The surveys ended in 2011. The team found that a person whose [5] _____ had a higher level of education tended to report better health. This remained the case when adjusting for other factors such as [6] _____' own education, social background, and health status before and after marriage. The authors suggest that high levels of education provide shared social, [7] _____, emotional, and financial resources. These include things like higher levels of emotional intelligence, particular skills or knowledge, or more money. The researchers [8] _____ that an individual's own level of education is clearly important for their health, but they assert that individuals also can reap the benefits of their partner's education. It is [9] _____ that the effects varied by gender. For women, health was more closely correlated to their spouse's education than for men, the team suggests this may be related to the

time period of the study. Women in this sample had lower levels of education and lower [10]_____ achievements than the men. The researchers' [11]_____ is that this made the husband's resources more likely to have a shared impact.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Climate scientists [1]_____ that many parts of the world will be increasingly prone to floods. This is a serious risk to human lives and property. So, understanding and [2]_____ forecasting flood risks is a key challenge for vulnerable cities around the globe. In 2017, Derek Loftis of the Virginia Institute of [3]_____ Science started a project called Catch the King. It uses a [4]_____ app to collect the data of ordinary citizens during high tides. He'll use those data to [5]_____ and improve his mathematical flooding model called TideWatch. Loftis's mission is to know where the water goes before it goes there, but collecting necessary data and then processing that information quickly enough to make [6]_____ forecasts is anything but easy. Accurate flood [7]_____ require an understanding of the situation on the ground. By the early 2000s, [8]_____ had advanced enough that scientists could integrate weather forecasting models with such measurements, but they still didn't have the critically important ability to forecast fast-moving floods in real time. So, in 2017, Loftis and colleagues set up a group of 28 internet-connected water-level [9]_____ throughout the flood risk community of Norfolk, Virginia. The new sensors [10]_____ rough measurements about water height and movement to a computer at the Virginia Institute. Along with those sensors, hundreds of local citizens take photos of rising tides and [11]_____ them real time to the institute. Scientists hope that the data collected by these citizens can help [12]_____ the ability to forecast exactly when and where damaging floods will occur.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Now it's become something of a [1]_____ to debate the value of a college degree, but as current population survey data show, there has been a sharp decline in employment among men without college degrees compared with those who have them. This [2]_____ began in the 1960s and has become more serious over time. What has actually caused this decline? Well, economists have been working to [3]_____ the roots of the decline

for decades and have come up with several theories. One popular theory is that it's a case of too low [4]_____ for jobs that don't require a degree. An [5]_____ theory is that there were more jobs not requiring a college degree in the past than now. A recent working paper from the National Bureau of Economic Research reviewed those theories and put forward additional [6]_____ about the causes of the problem. Let's look at that paper now. First, the [7]_____ considered the issue of wages, as the wage gap has grown between those with college degrees and those without. Economists have suggested that men aren't as interested in taking some of the less [8]_____ jobs. While the authors of the paper found truth in this explanation, they [9]_____ that low wages can't be the only factor, as wages for men without college degrees, adjusting for inflation, haven't changed much since the 1960s, making it hard to see why fewer men seem willing to accept those wages. This leads to the second theory, that more jobs [10]_____ a college degree today than in the past. Indeed, that theory seems [11]_____ because in America today, two thirds of jobs are filled by workers with at least some college education. However, the authors of the paper argue that there are other factors [12]_____ the problem, they identified two new potential explanations. The first being the tremendous decline in marriage among men without college degrees since the 1960s, and the second being the increase in women participating in the workforce that was [13]_____ with the decline in marriage, these two changes mean that men might not have families to support, or if they do, their wives might be doing more of the providing. Both of which might remove the financial [14]_____ to work. The authors of the paper [15]_____ that research on the subject isn't complete, but they argue that their work supports the value of a college education.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

While an increasing number of people are trying to eat less meat, a market research team has found in its latest fashion and [1]_____ report that the trend is now spreading from kitchen to closet. It found animal [2]_____ came top of a list of issues that people considered before buying clothes, with 42% saying it was important to them. The researchers of the team predicted that the next year would see a boom in animal-free shoe collections, since they heard [3]_____ of all ages say they would buy footwear designated as vegan, meaning the goods were produced without using any animal or animal part. As well as being on trend

and with a much better ring to it than synthetic leather, the vegan label does [4]_____ an important extra distinction. If you label something as [5]_____, then the whole product needs to be animal-free. That means checking things like the [6]_____ that holds the shoe together, for example, and the chemicals used for finishing them. At the top end, some of the world-renowned fashion designers have avoided [7]_____ and fur for some time. In fact, some of the companies are now exploring a leather substitute and a silk replacement made from [8]_____. The Animal Free Product Society says they've seen a boom in products registered with the vegan [9]_____. In 2018, there were 119. So far this year, it says an [10]_____ 1,956 have been registered. New products are being added daily. There are fur coats that are vegan, plastic vegan belts, and shoes made from tree [11]_____ or natural rubber labelled vegan. These new products aren't coming at an extra cost to [12]_____, though. [13]_____ boots cost the same as the leather originals. New Look, one of the first [14]_____ store chains to use the vegan trademark, prices ballet shoes at £7.99 and a vegan laptop handbag at £29.99, comparable with its other products. This signifies a change. In the past, [15]_____ products, whether they were fair trade or organic, came at a premium. However, it is [16]_____ whether these new products can be considered ethical. The debate over [17]_____, crop-growing impacts, pollution, and recyclability is a complicated one. Not to mention the [18]_____ around the working conditions for people making the products, whatever the component materials. Environmental [19]_____ advise that the best approach is to buy less, never mind what the item is made of.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

By the end of 2016, anyone who had been paying even passing attention to the news headlines was highly likely to [1]_____ that everything was terrible, and that the world was going to hell. It was easy to feel [2]_____ by the wars in different parts of the world, the spread of deadly viruses or terror attacks. Yet, 2016 was the best year in the history of [3]_____. Child [4]_____ was roughly half what it was as recently as 1990, and 300,000 more people gained access to electricity each day. Every single measure of material and environmental welfare in America, Europe, Asia, Africa, and the world as a whole has improved rather than [5]_____. We are living in history's most peaceful era, with violence of all kinds in [6]_____ decline. Those are the facts. So why aren't we all optimists? In a 2015 [7]_____ for YouGov, 65% of British people and

81% of the French said they thought the world was getting worse. However, according to numerous sensible [8]_____, these people are simply wrong. Nobody in their right mind should wish to have lived in a previous century. Yet people do. Why? Our prevailing mood of despair is irrational. It says more about us than it does about how things really are. It is best explained as the result of various psychological biases that served a purpose for our evolutionary ancestors, but now, in a media-saturated era, constantly [9]_____ us. Once upon a time, it was of great [10]_____ value to be worried about everything that could go wrong. This is what makes bad news especially [11]_____. In our evolutionary past, it was a very good thing that our attention could be easily [12]_____ by negative information, since it might well indicate a dangerous risk to our own survival. The [13]_____ who always assumed there was a lion behind the next rock would usually be wrong, but he'd be much more likely to survive and reproduce than one who always assumed the opposite. But that was all before newspapers, television, and the internet. In today's hyper-connected times, our addiction to bad news just leads us to vacuum up depressing or [14]_____ stories from across the globe, whether these news stories threaten us or not, we conclude that things are much worse than they actually are. Really good news, on the other hand, can be a lot harder to spot in a newspaper because [15]_____ daily events, by definition, aren't news.

2023年12月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hello, doctor. Hello, please take a seat. I have your test results here, and it's good news. The blood test came back clear. There is no indication of any [1]_____ issues. So then, why do I feel so [2]_____ all the time? It's probably due to overwork and stress. No, it can't be. I've always been working hard, but I've never felt [3]_____. Other people suffer and [4]_____ about that, but I don't. It must be something else. What you have just described is a common [5]_____. Many people who suffer from stress fail to [6]_____ it. You told me you often work long into the night, right? Yes, most days, in fact. But I've been doing that for about 20 years now. That doesn't matter. You could have been suffering from [7]_____ for 20 years without knowing it, and now it's catching up to you. But what about my feeling [8]_____ all the time and not being able to sleep well at night? Those are common consequences of stress. And if you don't sleep well, then of course you will feel [9]_____. I'm going to [10]_____ some special sleeping pills for you. They have a soft, gentle effect and are made from natural [11]_____, so your stomach should tolerate them fine, and there shouldn't be any negative side effects. Take one with your dinner and come see me after a month. If there is no [12]_____, I'll give you something stronger. Thank you, Doctor. That's not all. You should try and work less. Is there any way you can decrease your [13]_____? Um, I'd have to think about it. I'm a restaurant manager, and this industry is very [14]_____. There are many things to keep track of and stay on top of. I recommend you think about [15]_____ some responsibilities to someone else. I'm not asking you to [16]_____, just to slow down a bit. It's for your own health.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Today on People in the News, our [1]_____ is John Williams. The name may not sound familiar to you, but John was once an [2]_____ basketball player. John, you [3]_____ fans by leaving the sport at just 25. Why did you retire so early? Meg, I loved being an [4]_____, but I didn't love being a celebrity. I was in the limelight when I was still a high school student, and went professional right after high school [5]_____,

which was a mistake. I was a shy kid, and I wasn't ready for all the media attention. But walking away from millions of dollars at the height of your career, most people wouldn't be able to resist the [6]_____ of such a high salary. When you left the sport, there was speculation that you were having issues with your [7]_____ or even an injury. Not at all. It was hard to quit. I was [8]_____ to stay in the game because I loved basketball and I loved my team. As for money, I turned professional at 18, so I'd actually earned a lot and saved most of it because I had great financial [9]_____. I knew basketball wasn't a career with a lot of [10]_____ for most players, so I wanted to change careers while I was still young. Okay, that was 20 years ago, and you're back in the news. You've created a foundation that works to get more kids playing team sports. Why? I went to university and I studied public health and learned about the [11]_____ of the obesity epidemic, particularly among kids and adolescents in poor communities. I've spent the last two decades trying to [12]_____ the problem. The foundation is just the latest attempt. The foundation uses private [13]_____ to support basketball teams for girls and boys in primary school, right? Actually, we support teams for secondary school students too, and also have some public [14]_____.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Kate Atkinson was born in York, England, in 1951, she worked hard to gain her [1]_____ as an author. She studied English [2]_____ at university in Scotland. After graduating in 1974, she researched a [3]_____ on American literature. Later, she taught at the university she [4]_____ from and began writing short stories in 1981. She began writing for women's [5]_____ after winning the 1986 Woman's Own Short Story Competition. Her first [6]_____, Behind the Scenes at the Museum, won the 1995 UK Book of the Year Award. The book is set in Yorkshire, and has been [7]_____ for radio, theatre, and TV. She has written two plays for a [8]_____ in Edinburgh. The first was called Nice, and the second, [9]_____, performed as part of the Edinburgh Festival in August 2000. Whatever [10]_____ Atkinson writes in, her books touch on the themes of love and loss and how to carry on. They are always presented with [11]_____ and a wicked sense of humor. Her books tend to be [12]_____ by odd, sometimes sinful, and generally flawed eccentrics who become credible by virtue of being so fully realized. Her books have frequently been described as comedies of manners, that is to say, comedies that represent the complex and

sophisticated code of behavior current in [13]_____ circles of society, where appearances count more than true moral character. A comedy of manners tends to reward its clever and [14]_____ characters, rather than punish their bad deeds. The humor of a comedy of manners relies on verbal wit and [15]_____ teasing.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Why is [1]_____ an important skill to exercise in the workplace? Simply put, [2]_____ is a skill employers are increasingly looking for. When you spend time learning a new task rather than resisting it, your [3]_____ goes up. You can also serve as an example to your co-workers who may be having trouble [4]_____, and can help lead your team forward. Strategy consultant Dorie Clark explains it to us this way: I'd say that [5]_____ is an important skill in the workplace because, frankly, circumstances change. Competitors introduce new products. The economy might enter a recession. Customer preferences differ over time, and more. If you shake your fist at the sky and say, "Why can't it stay the same?" That's not going to do very much good. Instead, you need to recognize when [6]_____ have changed, so you can take appropriate action based on what is rather than how you wish the world would be. That [7]_____ you to make more accurate, informed, and effective choices. Also, the workplace itself has been evolving. Today's work culture and management style is often based on [8]_____ rather than a rigid hierarchy. [9]_____, which requires creativity, flexibility, and emotional intelligence, is a typical problem-solving technique. Employees who are unable or [10]_____ to participate will not easily move forward in the company. Employees who are [11]_____ demonstrate other skills too. They can reprioritize quickly when changes occur and suggest additional [12]_____ when something's not working. They can also regroup quickly when a setback occurs, adapting to the new situation confidently and without [13]_____.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

What makes humans different from other species? Some philosophers argue it's morals or [1]_____, while some scientists assert it's our greater cognitive development. But I argue that the main difference is our desire to

combat [2]_____. This makes being creative a biological mandate, as what we seek in art and technology is surprise, not simply a [3]_____ of expectations. As a result, a wild imagination has [4]_____ the history of our species. We build intricate habitats, [5]_____ complex recipes for our food, wear clothes that reflect constant changes in fashion, communicate with elaborate signs, symbols and sounds, and travel between habitats on wings and wheels of our own design. To satisfy our appetite for [6]_____, innovation is key. But who innovates? Now, many people, both [7]_____ and experts, believe that only geniuses innovate. But I believe that [8]_____ is not something that only a few people do. The innovative drive lives in every human brain, and the resulting war against the [9]_____ is what powers the massive changes that distinguish one generation from the next. The drive to create the new is a [10]_____ of being human. We build cultures by the hundreds and tell new stories by the millions. We create and surround ourselves with things that have never [11]_____ before, while animals do not. But where do our new ideas come from? According to many, new ideas come from [12]_____ nowhere to great minds, from this perspective, new ideas are almost like magic; they come in a flash of inspiration to a select few. However, the reality is that across the spectrum of human activities, prior work [13]_____ the creative process. We may think of [14]_____ as being the result of inspiration or genius, but it's really the result of developing the ideas of others further. This happens in technology, where one invention enables or inspires further inventions, and it happens in the arts, as writers, [15]_____, and painters use the work of previous artists in their own work. The human brain works from precedent. We take the ideas we've [16]_____ and put them together into some new shape. What is a true creator? Is a [17]_____ a genius who makes something out of nothing? No, creators are simply humans who use what they [18]_____, who absorb the past and manipulate it to create possible futures. Thus, humans are [19]_____ as a rule rather than as an exception.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Many dog owners will tell you that their dog somehow knows when they're ill or upset, and according to researchers who study dog [1]_____, those pet owners are right. Dogs do know when their human [2]_____ are having a rough time. Not only can your dog sense when you have a cold, but domestic dogs have shown an aptitude for detecting both much smaller mood [3]_____ and far more serious

physical conditions. This is because dogs are extremely sensitive to changes in the people they're familiar with, and [4]_____ causes change. If a person is infected with a virus or bacteria, for example, their [5]_____ will be abnormal, and dogs are able to smell that change even if the human can't, because dogs have a much more powerful sense of smell than humans, researchers have also found that a person's mood, which can be an indicator of a larger illness, triggers a dog's sense of smell. Human emotions manifest physically in chemical signals that are [6]_____ by the body, and dogs are able to smell those as well. Beyond smell, dogs [7]_____ information from a person's voice in order to sense changes. In 2014, researchers discovered that dogs have an area of the brain similar to one in humans that allows them to understand emotional [8]_____ in the tone of a speaker's voice beyond what they'd be able to pick up from familiar words alone, a person's voice can also carry indicators of illness. What's not understood quite so well is what dogs understand about these changes. Humans send out lots of [9]_____, but whether dogs know some of these cues mean illness Isn't clear. What we [10]_____ as concern on a dog's part might be more like increased curiosity or suspicion that something is wrong with us. And sticking close by is a great way to [11]_____ more information about the situation. Some researchers assert dogs will one day help doctors diagnose diseases, as some dogs have already demonstrated the ability to detect an assortment of [12]_____, including diabetes and certain types of cancer. But those researchers [13]_____ that's probably in the distant future. For now, research suggests dog [14]_____ can have an array of benefits in and of itself. Keeping a pet dog has been shown to [15]_____ health and boost mood. Dogs also help people relax, and they can be a particular comfort to those with [16]_____ diseases.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Earlier this month, the think tank called Onward [1]_____ a report, a question of degree, which argues that degrees in the creative arts are not good value for money. Ministers, according to Onward, should crack down on courses that offer extremely limited value for money to students 10 years after graduation, [2]_____ the ability of such courses to recruit new students if the average graduate earns below the student loans payment threshold, courses like science, technology, engineering, and math, and economics, where the average graduate earns a lot, should be favored. The report provides [3]_____ into a government review

which looks at how to reform technical education and how to ensure students get good value for money. At first glance, it might even seem like Onward have a point. According to their data, the majority of creative arts students earn less than 25,000 pounds a year, 10 years after [4]_____, the average male creative arts students indeed apparently earn much less than they would had they simply never gone to university. This isn't really good for anyone, and it's certainly no good for graduates who are forced to [5]_____ a lifestyle where they can never save up, never buy a house, never hope to retire. Onward have identified a real problem: creative arts graduates from top universities like Oxford, with a high proportion of privately educated students, have fairly good work prospects, while 40% of all graduates, regardless of their degree, are on less than 25,000 pounds a year, five years after [6]_____. This [7]_____ that the problem isn't really to do with specific students studying specific degrees, but really with the economy as a whole. Regardless of what they've studied, young people find it hard to get ahead unless they're lucky enough to be born with successful parents, if ministers want to make education pay for young people, they need to look beyond the higher education [8]_____ towards the wider world. The rewards that education gives us are not [9]_____; they are not always instantly obvious, and certainly not always direct. An education makes you a different person from the one you would have been if you hadn't received it. We need to look at the value of education not in the [10]_____ of a bank balance, but of a life. If we continue to allow ourselves to be [11]_____ with talk of value for money, we will all be made poorer as a result.

2023年6月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Have you [1]_____ what you wish to study? Yes, Professor. I wish to study architecture. Ah, that's a wonderful profession. Why did you choose it? I gave a lot of thought to things you said during our last discussion, and I decided [2]_____ made the most sense for me. In particular, I'm [3]_____ to the marriage of design and engineering. That's great, but I seem to remember you were preoccupied with all the [4]_____ mathematics. You no longer think this [5]_____ will be too hard for you. No, I was doing some online research, and I think I should be able to [6]_____. Math might be the toughest subject I encounter in the [7]_____, but I'll simply put in the work required. I'm certain the fruits of my labor will pay off. I'm sure that's true. Due to its material nature, architecture is one field where you'll be able to clearly witness the contribution you make to a city, and the legacies you build will last much longer than any of us [8]_____. Yeah, I guess that's true too. So, what subjects do you think I should start brushing up on in preparation? I have the whole summer. These days, architecture is a very [9]_____ and dynamic degree. Most universities will encourage you to learn different things from fields as wide ranging as philosophy and [10]_____. Nevertheless, I would suggest you start with computer science because there will be many [11]_____ visuals you will have to produce as part of your projects. Any [12]_____ in particular you think I should start with? Photoshop is a good place. If you aren't yet, try to become as [13]_____ as you can with it, and another thing that I would recommend you learn as much as you can is fine arts, in particular the history of Western art.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

So, as I mentioned over the phone, we are looking for someone who is very [1]_____. I can't stress this enough. I fully understand. As we all know, being such a famous football player at Real Madrid, Mr. [2]_____ has a very high public profile. This means he cannot leave the house without being recognized and [3]_____. Yes, I completely understand how [4]_____ it would be to respect Mr. Sanchez's private

life. Good. As his personal assistant, you would be required to run common everyday chores for Mr. [5]_____. Things he cannot do himself due to his [6]_____, like going to the supermarket or post office. So, while at first sight it may appear that working for a celebrity is very [7]_____, nothing could be further from the truth. I'm telling you this so that you don't get any false [8]_____ of what the job has to offer you. Thanks, I understand this too. This is my first job after graduating from university, so [9]_____, I don't have much prior working experience. I'm, however, very excited about the [10]_____ of joining this company and very keen to start from the bottom, in whatever capacity I may be of use. That's good to hear. You sound very energetic. Tell me, why do you think you're well suited for this job? Well, firstly, I love football. I'm a [11]_____ Real Madrid supporter and go to their games every weekend I can. I would simply love to have a job where I'm involved in some capacity with Real Madrid, regardless of the position and [12]_____. And secondly, I think what this company does in sports [13]_____ is very cool, and I think my language skills could prove very useful down the road. Please tell me more about your language [14]_____. I am fully [15]_____ in English and Spanish, and have a working proficiency in French.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Adventure sports are [1]_____ attractive to many energetic and thrill-seeking kids. Sports like rock climbing, [2]_____, skiing, and mountain biking thus have lots of appeal. They don't have many of the rules and pressures of traditional team sports, but they still have all the benefits of [3]_____ physical activity. When properly [4]_____, extreme sports can be a part of a healthy, balanced life. Some [5]_____ sports may be associated with high risks of injury, so it's important for kids to figure out when to take risks and when not to. Risk-free activities deprive kids of the opportunity to test themselves and [6]_____ their fears. But to some, these very risks are what makes these sports a bad choice. They say that extreme sports can often lead to [7]_____ injuries, especially as young thrill seekers may attempt feats that are too advanced for them. But let's be real: most kids do all kinds of dangerous stuff, whether you want them to or not. Adventure sports have many of the same risks and dangers, but they have an additional sense of adventure, courage, and [8]_____ that is important to foster in young children. As always, it's up to parents to [9]_____ what's best for their kids. But if you do decide that adventure sports are a bit too much,

do try to introduce other forms of [10]_____ adventures into their lives. Camping under the stars, fishing, [11]_____, or even just playing in the woods can help a lot in building the same sense of self-confidence and risk-taking as in adventure sports.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Passage two: The shiny [1]_____ of today will be waste tomorrow. [2]_____ don't talk much about this when they announce the big new thing that will replace your mostly just as good old thing. In fact, technology firms often [3]_____ design devices that will not last long and cannot be repaired, so that consumers will have to spend their money on a new one. This year, the French government began requiring tech [4]_____ to list a repairability score. If a device can be repaired, then its life can be extended, saving consumers money and the planet the burden of so many trashed [5]_____. Equipped with this knowledge, [6]_____ can make better choices about which products to buy. Some 59 million tons of old TVs, computers, screens, smartphones, [7]_____, and other electronics are discarded every year. This waste is dangerous. Batteries explode in recycling facilities. Toxic substances like mercury leak into soil and groundwater and [8]_____ in the air. [9]_____ flat screens adds greenhouse gases to the atmosphere. We need tech companies to take the lead to [10]_____ this problem. If they won't, governments must make them do so. Although tech companies will often speak of environmental sustainability, many lobby against repair legislation, [11]_____ it will eat into their profits. Sustainability matters, but [12]_____ design appears to matter more to these companies. Consumers should support right-to-repair legislation. In this world, damage is a [13]_____, but we cannot leave things broken. A problem of our [14]_____ is a problem that can be fixed.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

On average, U.S. workers spend about 10% of their [1]_____ surfing the internet, emailing friends, or shopping online. This behavior, called cyberloafing, is believed to cost employers up to 85 billion a year in lost [2]_____. The majority of cyber loafing research focuses on ways to prevent employees from engaging in this behavior through [3]_____ such as internet monitoring and computer use policies.

But it turns out such behavior may not be a sign that a worker is [4]_____ or just wasting time. Social media use at work has been linked to higher levels of employee engagement and job [5]_____. New research suggests cyber loafing could help workers cope with an [6]_____ stressful work environment, but is cyber loafing actually effective at reducing employee stress levels? That's the question my research team wanted to answer in our new study. Our [7]_____ was that cyber loafing may serve as a mini break, giving employees an opportunity to recover from stress or work situations. To test this, we asked workers to complete an online survey and [8]_____ how much time they spent cyber loafing, checking non-work emails and shopping. We also asked them to rank job satisfaction, their desire to quit, and how often they've experienced [9]_____ at work, such as being bullied, threatened, or yelled at. As you might expect, we found that overall, more [10]_____ at work was correlated with lower levels of job satisfaction and a greater desire to quit. More [11]_____, we found that cyber loafing effectively buffered this connection. That is, [12]_____ workers who spent more time surfing the web and checking emails reported higher job satisfaction and were less likely to want to quit than similar participants who didn't cyber loaf as much. This suggests that cyber loafing acts as a sort of relief valve for workers, helping them recover from [13]_____ experiences. While we did not directly assess how cyber loafing affects worker performance, we believe by relieving stress, it may not only reduce worker turnover but also ultimately [14]_____ productivity. This fits with other recent research that [15]_____ taking short breaks is associated with higher levels of daily job performance. That isn't to say cyber loafing is always good. Too much time spent on non-work activities likely causes performance to [16]_____. All in all, managers should be more [17]_____ with employees. We believe a bit of online shopping or [18]_____ the internet at work could make workers more productive in the long run.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

When Julius Morton moved to Nebraska City in 1854, he faced a problem shared by many [1]_____ in the territory. It was a [2]_____ plain, that meant no trees for building materials or for fuel. But Morton was one of the world's first [3]_____, stating, "For prosperity, we ought to plant as many forests as we have exhausted and consumed." So he started planting trees, beginning with his own land. By 1860, Morton

[4] _____ a forest of more than 300 trees. A few years later, he had more than 1,000. As the [5] _____ grew, so did Morton's influence in Nebraska. This was largely because Morton founded the Nebraska City News, the state's first newspaper, in which he frequently wrote editorials about the practical and [6] _____ benefits of tree planting. He also organized the Nebraska State [7] _____ Society and served on the Nebraska State Board of Agriculture. While serving on the board, Morton came up with an idea to spread his belief in tree planting [8] _____. On January 4, 1872, Morton drafted a resolution that April 10 be [9] _____ Day for the Planting of Trees in the state of Nebraska, and urged people to go out and plant trees themselves. Morton called the special event Arbor Day, as Arbor is [10] _____ for tree. The state government agreed, and on April 10, 1872, the first [11] _____ Arbor Day was celebrated throughout Nebraska. [12] _____ were awarded to counties, cities, and individuals who planted the largest number of trees. That day, an [13] _____ 1 million trees were planted in Nebraska, an average of more than six for every man, woman, and child in the state. Since 1885, Nebraska has planted more than 700,000 acres of trees, earning it the [14] _____ the Tree Planters State. Arbor Day became a legal [15] _____ holiday in the state in 1885. It was held on April 22, Julius Morton's birthday. In addition to a [16] _____ in Nebraska City, Morton introduced what has since become a long-standing Arbor Day tradition. School children went outside and planted trees together. In 1970, nearly a century after Arbor Day was first celebrated, President Richard Nixon [17] _____ the last Friday of every April to be observed as National Arbor Day. All 50 states recognize the April [18] _____, although many hold an additional State Arbor Day in the month more suited to local tree planting.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Modern humans [1] _____ in Africa about 200,000 years ago. They then spread across Europe and Asia [2] _____ after 60,000 years ago. This is the out of Africa model, as it's [3] _____ known. In the 1990s, the hypothesis found widespread acceptance, but this popular idea is in need of [4] _____, particularly given the number of important findings across Asia over the past few decades. For instance, many new human [5] _____ found, particularly in China, are now dated as older than 60,000 years. This calls into question the idea that modern humans [6] _____ out of Africa only 60,000 years ago. Take the recent

discovery of two modern human teeth found in the Luna Cave in China's Guangxi Zhuang [7]_____ region. When my research team and I dated these teeth, we found they were more than 70,000 years old, a situation clearly [8]_____ if modern humans moved out of Africa only 60,000 years ago. So, with such findings, what happened exactly? Where does the most current data [9]_____ we came from? The first question we should ask is, why did modern humans leave Africa to begin with? If a population is perfectly adapted to a particular environment and has access to an abundance of [10]_____, then there really is no reason to move or change. For instance, some monkeys in Africa have a set of teeth that has hardly changed over the course of millions of years, [11]_____ that they found a place that has worked for them. So, what happened with humans? Some [12]_____ have suggested that population density increased to the point where smaller human groups were forced to explore new lands. Other researchers have suggested that due to major environmental events in East Africa, humans were [13]_____ to find greener pastures. Yet another explanation could simply be that early modern human hunters were following the large animals that they relied on, and so they moved out of Africa without realizing that they were actually moving from one [14]_____ to another. Humans need daily access to reliable fresh water, which appears to be [15]_____ from many coastal areas. This brings us to another question: By which [16]_____ did modern humans move out of Africa? No clear [17]_____ across the Mediterranean from North Africa appear to be present. So the earlier [18]_____ out of Africa and into Europe and Asia might have been across the Arabian Peninsula.

2023年6月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hi, Lily. How's the new apartment? It's okay. What? How can it be just okay when last week you were [1]_____ about the place and kept posting photos of it online? Well, last week when I moved in, the apartment seemed cozy, just the right size for one person, but now it just seems tiny, [2]_____, and solitary. Ah, that's the problem. You miss your [3]_____ from university, don't you? I'm going to sound like an idiot because I used to complain to you all the time about how crowded our dormitory room was and about all the things they did to [4]_____ me, like watching movies late at night without headphones or talking loudly early in the morning, but now I miss them terribly. Of course you do. That's perfectly normal. When I got my first place, I remember thinking I couldn't wait to live by myself and get away from my juvenile [5]_____ and all their annoying habits. But then I began missing them and feeling lonely and thinking that our [6]_____ was like paradise, even though there were six of us guys in one small room. I thought it was just me who felt like that. Look, you lived at home with us, and then you had three [7]_____, and this is your first time living alone, so it's hard. But your first apartment is a [8]_____ in your life, and you should celebrate it. Tell me about the apartment. Actually, it's not bad. In fact, it's pretty adorable now that I have [9]_____ it and it has everything I need. I have a kitchen to cook in and a bathroom all to myself, and then another room with my bed at one end and a [10]_____, a small table, and chairs at the other end. That does sound [11]_____, and I can't wait to see it. And neither can mom and dad.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Welcome to our program Book Talk. Our guest today is Frank Jones, a [1]_____ of our education system, and the author of a new book, *How to Reform Our Universities*. Hello, Susan. Frank, you support [2]_____ changing universities in America. Yes, I believe that the purpose of higher education is to prepare young people to enter the [3]_____, and that our current system fails to do this. We're [4]_____ too many resources to disciplines that don't match the needs of employers. I think your

attitude to education is a bit [5]_____, Frank. Surely the purpose of university is to prepare young people to participate fully in [6]_____ life, rather than just to find well-paid jobs. Susan, many young [7]_____ struggle to find any job, let alone a good one. The job market is [8]_____, particularly for students who study the arts. I agree that it isn't easy for young people to find work, but you [9]_____ closing down all departments that aren't directly related to science and technology. Is that really the solution? You're overstating my point. My [10]_____ is that we need to use more of our budget on areas like science and engineering. To do that, we need to take money from subjects like [11]_____ and music, but the arts have value. They're an important part of our culture. Studying literature or music or [12]_____ might not result in a job in that area, but it helps young people to think about the world in a deeper way, which makes them better citizens and makes for a better society. I agree that the arts are valuable to society, but it's [13]_____ to think that not only the most talented but all students should study them at university level. The arts are very competitive, and most graduates will end up with a great deal of debt, [14]_____ a degree that has little value on the job market.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Do you ever have the [1]_____ feeling that you don't have time to really think anymore? You are not alone. A variety of factors have [2]_____ to rob us of time for reflection about ourselves and our lives. Today, our preoccupied minds are rarely silent. The average person receives hundreds of texts and voice messages a day, and holidays for many of us are action-packed weeks, more likely full of family activities than opportunities for [3]_____ and contemplation. Regular reflection, however, underlies all great professionals. It's a [4]_____ for you to recharge your mental batteries, see things in a new light and tap into your creativity. Almost all of the great advisors that I have studied have found ways to get away from it all and [5]_____ their life and work. Some researchers in the field of creativity, in fact, believe that insight occurs during the reflection and [6]_____ that follows a period of intense activity. Schedule time for [7]_____ about your work or a particular project you're engaged in. I usually block out half an hour. Don't answer the phone. Push your papers to the side. Sketch. Make lists. Draw mind maps of ideas that come to you. At the end, write down any [8]_____ ideas. When you're alone, stop worrying and think. A lot of our downtime is spent worrying about troublesome things in our lives, or [9]_____ about how we'd

like our lives to be. [10]_____ things during moments of relaxation, after a period of intense work. This is when we are the most [11]_____.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Even before Colorado was a state, it had post offices. The first opened in 1859 in a settlement founded by [1]_____ searching for gold. Life could be unpredictable out west. Gold failed to appear. Drought ruined farmers, and [2]_____ clashed with Native Americans. On the settlement's location now stands a [3]_____ university campus. Amid all the changes, one feature remained constant: the [4]_____ service. The maps tracing America's [5]_____ expansion are telling. In 1864, there were few [6]_____ branches on land controlled by Native Americans, which still accounted for most of the West, over the next 25 years, post offices grew quickly. Colonization of the West could be regarded as a result of big government rather than pioneers, as federal subsidies and land grants [7]_____ people into the deserts and plains, the post kept them connected. In the mid 19th century, the post office department was far from a [8]_____ bureaucracy. To keep up with migration patterns, [9]_____ services were added to existing businesses. The federal government commissioned private [10]_____ to carry the mail. Short-term contracts were granted to local businessmen to act as [11]_____. These partnerships enabled the mail to quickly follow [12]_____, helping knit together remote parts of the country. Mr. [13]_____, a digital historian, wrote a book on the history of the U.S. Postal Service. He used data science to [14]_____ historical trends. Most [15]_____, he built an accompanying website complete with interactive maps. They show readers how, within a generation, the postal service helped [16]_____ a continent. These online interactive maps illustrate the [17]_____ power of snail mail.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

In last week's [1]_____, we discussed reasons why people forget things. This week, we will discuss a [2]_____ reason why we might remember some things: anxiety. Think about something as simple as buying a coffee. That may not seem like an experience that would make a deep impression on your memory, but [3]_____ could change that. In fact, a new study suggests that people with higher [4]_____ levels might

remember certain information better than people with lower anxiety levels. That's because higher levels of anxiety may make people more [5]_____ to negative feelings, putting them in a more negative state of mind. That in turn may make them able to better remember some events. Let's take a closer look at that new study now. In the study, the researchers started by giving 80 [6]_____ students an anxiety test. The test measured the participants' anxiety levels over the [7]_____ two weeks. Then, to test memory, the [8]_____ were shown a series of neutral words, one at a time. Some of the words were printed onto photos of negative scenes, meaning images that could affect their emotions [9]_____, such as a photo of a car accident or a cemetery. The rest of the words were printed onto photos of [10]_____ scenes, such as a photo of a lake or trees. Neutral words included words like table or desk that don't [11]_____ emotion. Later, the [12]_____ were asked to think back to the words they were shown earlier, which caused them to re-enter either a negative or neutral mindset. The [13]_____ were then presented with another set of neutral words, and their memory of these new words was tested. The researchers found that the new words presented to people in a negative [14]_____ were better remembered by people with higher levels of anxiety than those with lower levels of anxiety. In other words, when highly anxious individuals took in otherwise emotionally neutral information that was presented to them, it became colored by their negative [15]_____, making them remember the information better. But these same effects were not seen in people with low levels of [16]_____. Previous studies have found that extreme levels of anxiety, such as those experienced by people [17]_____ with an anxiety disorder, can be quite detrimental to memory and cognitive performance. But the highly [18]_____ people in this study represent individuals who are managing their anxiety, and for whom anxiety is not a serious problem.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Over the past 20 years, the internet has [1]_____ become a dominant feature of our lives. It has changed how we communicate with each other, and it has definitely [2]_____ the way we do business with each other. [3]_____ has also changed in a number of ways. For instance, in the past, consumers had to call a phone number and [4]_____ wait on hold in order to get the information they wanted. Today, they want the information immediately. They'll go to the company's social media page and post comments and

questions, expecting to receive an [5]_____ response. If they don't get their questions answered soon, they'll move on to another company that will answer them quickly. Marketing departments today need to follow [6]_____ development. For example, this year's [7]_____ is smarter than last year's. Self-driving cars are now on the road. [8]_____ have to do research on which technologies are coming into being; otherwise, they risk being left behind in the virtual dust. Marketing has also changed due to the [9]_____ of video. People don't just want to read text; they want to watch things happening. Companies now have to [10]_____ how they can use video on a consistent basis to share information about their businesses. [11]_____, it's extremely easy to shoot something these days. All you need is a smartphone. But what's the result of all this? Shorter attention spans. We aren't the same people that we were 20 years ago. Not only have we grown accustomed to getting the information we want [12]_____, our attention spans are much shorter. If something doesn't [13]_____ our attention within a few seconds, we're on to the next piece of content. [14]_____ need to figure out ways to speak directly to the customer's emotions, and they need to figure out how to do that as quickly as possible. Once people are [15]_____ engaged, they'll stick with you. If [16]_____ has changed this much in the past 20 years, imagine what the next 20 years will bring. In a recent survey, only 9% of [17]_____ could say with confidence that their marketing efforts were actually working. Their confidence is being [18]_____ because the rules of the game change every year. That's why it's important for [19]_____ to pay attention to the latest technological developments and consider collaborating with technological innovators. That way, they'll be moving at the same [20]_____ as the tech industry.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

You might be surprised to learn that the benefits of friendships extend beyond people's social life and into their work, which is interesting when considering the extent to which people sacrifice friendships, or at least the time they spend with friends, because of the extended hours they're [1]_____ to work. Just last week, I was remarking to a colleague that I'm content with only one social engagement per week, but according to recent research, that's [2]_____ not enough. In an initial study of more than 700 [3]_____, scholars from an American university analyzed the impact that friends, as opposed to family, have on self-esteem and

well-being. Friends came out substantially on top. That's because to be someone's mate is a [4]_____ act, unlike family, who people rarely get to choose. The researchers found that when people choose to [5]_____ and maintain supportive friendships with an individual, it means that the person is valued and worthy of their limited time. Such sentiments of value and [6]_____ boost our self-esteem. The second study [7]_____ more than 300 participants. It proved that the better we feel about ourselves, the more likely we'll perform our job confidently and [8]_____. This follow-up study found that non-work friends even improve people's job [9]_____. They have as much of an impact on how much they love their jobs as do the friends they have at work, despite not actually being at our place of work. These types of friends tend to be our preferred outlet for [10]_____ about work-related matters. This is an [11]_____ that may not be available at the office. So even though friendships can be easy to neglect when confronted by pressures at work, or even pressures at home, neglecting our friends can turn out to be harmful and [12]_____. That's why, when determining how to create a better work-life balance, we need to consider not only how to balance work and family demands, but also how to [13]_____ and sustain supportive friendships. It's for this reason that managers should never [14]_____ when it comes to requests from employees for flexible work arrangements, it's irrelevant whether their need for a desired schedule is due to, say, parenting responsibilities or a craving to hang out with a best mate. What matters is the opportunity to engage in a [15]_____ activity outside of work, that will definitely have a follow-on effect at work.

2022年12月 第2套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Welcome to the book club. Today's [1]_____ is Susan Lane, the author of a new book on personal finances that has already sold half a million copies. Hi, Susan, your book is extremely successful. Why do you think that is? I think that's because of my message, which is making happiness a [2]_____ over money. So many of us in my generation have spent decades trying to earn more money just to [3]_____ more, but it made us more miserable. You yourself were once caught in that cycle, working for two decades as an executive and earning a high salary, but still [4]_____ debt. I most certainly was. I earned millions, but by the time I quit my job four years ago to become a writer, I [5]_____ over $30,000. So, how did you escape that pattern, and what would you [6]_____ other people to do? The first change is in what we value. We need to [7]_____ things that actually make us happy, like relationships, the environment, or even our hobbies. Once we make the right things our [8]_____, our goals will change, and so will our financial behavior. How does that translate into practical action? Can you give our audience examples of what you're talking about on an everyday basis, the major areas for action are usually housing, food, and [9]_____. So people might share a home with friends instead of living on their own, bring lunch from home instead of going to restaurants, and use public transport instead of owning a car. Those sound like major sacrifices. I could never share my home. I need my own space. But they aren't sacrifices. When people change their values, their [10]_____ change. So, in the example of [11]_____, if we value relationships, sharing a home isn't depriving ourselves of space, but giving us an opportunity to spend more time with our loved ones. Indeed, it is.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Thank you for [1]_____ me to the gallery, Christopher. I haven't visited here since your predecessor's [2]_____ function. Would you like to see the newest additions to our collection first, Catherine? Are those the landscapes by Danielle Gregory? I absolutely adore her work. This first piece was a gift to the gallery from the artist herself, and it's quite [3]_____. I love how she depicts the [4]_____ landscape. The

colors complement each other perfectly. You can sense the [5]_____ in the picture. This piece was inspired by Gregory's recent [6]_____ in the Gobi Desert, and how did you obtain her other piece over here? It was purchased at auction by an anonymous collector, who [7]_____ it to the gallery for display. This composition is one of her most [8]_____ paintings. It must have cost that [9]_____ a small fortune to purchase this. Obviously, I can't [10]_____ the exact amount he paid, but it was substantial. There's so much detail in this painting. I feel like I can really immerse myself in the scene. I particularly like the [11]_____ created by the reflection of the mountain in the lake. This particular piece was the one that was [12]_____ for a gateway award, I was lucky enough to attend the award ceremony as Gregory's guest. So you know her personally. I assume she's an eccentric artist. Quite the opposite, in fact. She's not at all eccentric. I would say she's one of the most [13]_____ and intelligent people I know. I'd love to be able to meet her. There are so many questions I'd like to ask. What a coincidence! I'm meeting her for dinner tonight. Would you like to come along? I'd love to. Thank you.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Forgiveness is the release of [1]_____ or anger. Forgiveness doesn't mean reconciliation. We don't have to return to the same relationship, nor do we have to accept the same harmful behaviors from an [2]_____. Forgiveness is [3]_____ important for the mental health of certain victims, it propels people forward rather than keeping them emotionally engaged in an injustice or trauma. Carrying the hurt or anger of an [4]_____ leads the body to release stress chemicals. Eliminating the [5]_____ flow of those chemicals may also explain why forgiveness provides physical health benefits. There are scenarios in which [6]_____ is not the best course. Sometimes a victim becomes more [7]_____ when they give themselves permission not to forgive. Forgiveness can be challenging. This is especially true when the offending party offers an [8]_____ apology, or maybe they haven't offered anything at all. However, it's often the healthiest path forward. It's important to [9]_____ forgiveness by developing compassion for the offender. Reflect on whether the act was due to malicious intent, or whether it was caused by challenging [10]_____ in the offender's life. What about forgiving ourselves? We sometimes need to take responsibility for mistakes, but intense guilt and shame aren't a [11]_____ outcome in the long run. Forgiving yourself may seem like an

[12] _____ process. You can begin by [13] _____ that you are at fault. Take responsibility for the hurt you caused. Then reflect on why the event occurred. Draw the lessons you learned and try to avoid committing a similar [14] _____ in the future.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

The Glasgow [1] _____ first opened in 1896 as a cable-hauled system, it is generally recognized as the world's third underground railway after London and Budapest. In its long history, it has never been expanded, remaining as a single loop line with a [2] _____ 15 stations. At its peak, it served the [3] _____ workers on the south side of the city. In the 1960s, there was a decline in the [4] _____ industry, and the popularity of private transport grew. As a result, the subway saw a rapid decline in [5] _____. It ran with little further change until 1977, when its new operators closed it for major [6] _____ investment. Carriages were replaced, ventilation was improved, and the main depot was also [7] _____ and fitted with connecting tracks to replace the outdated crane transfer mechanism. The subway, in its present form, [8] _____ for operation in April 1980. Since its [9] _____, the subway has seen a revival in its fortunes. It serves as a viable alternative to other forms of transport, and has gone a long way to [10] _____ traffic jams in the city center. In 1996, the system reached an important [11] _____: 100 years. To [12] _____ this special event, the color scheme of the train carriages was updated. Recently, high-tech systems such as smart card [13] _____ machines and smart gates are used across all subway stations. The smart card provides more [14] _____ travel, and passengers simply top up their cards and tap them to get in and out the subway. Since its launch, the technology has been [15] _____ by more than 100,000 subway customers.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

If you visit the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, chances are you will remember the roadside or [1] _____ bears above all else. Bears are the most popular animals in a number of our national parks, in these mountains where the population of bears runs into the hundreds, opportunities to observe these large wild animals are [2] _____ during the summer. Since national parks are wildlife sanctuaries where no

[3]_____ of the native animals is allowed, years of protection have served to break down the wild bears' fear of humans. Now, instead of depending on their own resources for a living, many bears patrol park roads and [4]_____. They give the garbage cans a frequent going over, an occasional offer of food from a park visitor, an illegal and dangerous practice, makes [5]_____ of them. Bears are very often hungry, and since they will feed on almost any kind of plant or animal, [6]_____ is quite acceptable. Feeding them, however, represents [7]_____ kindness because the bears come to expect such generosity from everyone, and consequently, trouble could lie ahead. Park rules prohibit the feeding of bears; [8]_____ are arrested. Every year, doctors who have offices near the park treat a number of cases of bear bites and bear [9]_____. Some of the accidents have come about in [10]_____ ways. One man was in the process of feeding two small [11]_____ when the mother bear appeared and insisted upon having some of the food. Shoving the big bear aside with one hand, the man continued feeding the [12]_____ when suddenly he was struck a fierce blow in the face. A bear, [13]_____ by the food that a lady kept offering to him, entered the car where the generous person was sitting. Her efforts to push the bear out of the car resulted in [14]_____. A man required medical attention after he applied a [15]_____ cigarette to a bear's nose, another man tried to boost a bear into the front seat of his car so that he might take a picture of a bear sitting beside his wife, who was behind the wheel. Because bears prefer roads and campgrounds, the possibility of a [16]_____ meeting up with a bear along park trails is small, but there's always that chance. For a bear seems to know if you are carrying a lunch or a candy bar, he may even insist on taking it.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Why do we form opinions or [1]_____ about someone or something without really knowing much about them? Just hearing something good or bad about a person, a place, or thing can influence our opinions positively or [2]_____. But letting the opinions of another person [3]_____ what our opinions will be is dangerous. Forming opinions about someone or something before really knowing them well is called [4]_____. Pre means before, and judice refers to [5]_____. Hence, [6]_____ means to judge before having adequate knowledge. We can be [7]_____ toward or against someone or something. In either case, we are only allowing ourselves to see half of the picture. Very few people or things in this world are all

good or all bad. [8]_____ attitudes are usually based on myths, half truths, or incorrect information, and they are dangerous because they can keep us from learning the truth about someone or something. People form [9]_____ against others for many reasons: differences in their race, religion, gender, or occupation. [10]_____ keep people apart; they keep us from really knowing and understanding each other. We should feel proud of who we are and the group of people we [11]_____. If feelings of pride begin to turn to feelings of [12]_____ when we think that our group or our beliefs are better than those around us. However, then we begin to develop [13]_____ attitudes that can be harmful. For example, the [14]_____ attitudes of one group may keep another group from attending certain schools, from living in any neighborhood they want, or from getting a job or a promotion. Extreme feelings of [15]_____ have caused the deaths of innocent people. We are responsible for our own thoughts and opinions. When we let someone else tell us what to think about someone or something, we are giving up some control of our own lives. Before you form an [16]_____ or opinion, find out for yourself about the person or the thing in question. Sometimes we don't realize that we hold [17]_____ attitudes toward or against someone or something. We need to carefully examine our lives and our fears, and to ask ourselves whether our attitudes come from our personal knowledge and experience, or from [18]_____ and fear of the unknown. The good news about [19]_____ is that we are not born with it. [20]_____ attitudes and opinions develop over time, but with education and knowledge, we can replace our prejudices with cooperation and understanding.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

When I started high school, it was a [1]_____. I had spent eight years fighting my way to be the most popular kid in the [2]_____ school student body. I had been a big, tough eighth grader, and suddenly I was a [3]_____ ninth grader bullied by the big, tough 12th-grade seniors who ran the high school. I realized then that it's nice to strive for something, but that you also have to enjoy the moment you're in and be happy where you are. Rock and roll had always been an important part of my life. I remember my friends and I used to drive around until the late hours of the nights, listening to the music of rock and roll [4]_____. During those [5]_____ years, I built friendships that I thought would last a lifetime. Most people that age think the same thing, but people drift apart. Jobs, families, and tragedies separate people from those [6]_____ friendships.

The [7]_____ that separated me from my friends forever was the Vietnam War. A year after I [8]_____ from high school, I left for Vietnam. I came back burned out and tired, as though I had lived 10 lifetimes in the short [9]_____ of 14 months. The 14 months I was in the war, I couldn't relate to the friends I had had in high school. They still seemed [10]_____, concerned with childish things that weren't important to me. I was still trying to cope with the death, [11]_____, and evil I had seen in Vietnam. I felt like we had done terrible things to [12]_____ people there, and in turn, I had seen terrible things done to my friends. I withdrew from my friends and started college. Then I [13]_____ college and took many different jobs. I spent a lot of my time and money on [14]_____ and other drugs. Finally, in an effort to get my life going in the right direction again, I sold everything and took what little money I had and bought myself an airplane ticket to Israel. I went there to study history. While studying at Haifa University, I met my wife, who was also an American student. I now [15]_____ in a high school back in America. I look at my students and see them struggling with many of the very things I struggled with many years ago. As a teacher, I try to help them over the rough spots as best I can.

2022年12月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

How's your dissertation going? I'm [1]_____ my first draft, and will submit it to my professor tomorrow. Oh, I haven't even started writing mine yet, so I'm really worried about finishing by the end of next [2]_____. You mean you haven't even begun yours yet? The final draft is due in five months. Of course, I've started it, but I can't get to the writing yet as I haven't found enough [3]_____ to use, so I'm still researching the topic. Maybe the problem is the way you're doing your research. I started by talking to my professor about where to look for information, and based on that, I found books in the library and a lot of [4]_____ journal articles on the internet. I've tried all that, but don't have enough to write the [5]_____, as my department's minimum length is 70 pages. I think the problem is that my topic isn't viable, and honestly, my professor did warn me at the beginning that I might not be able to find enough material, but I was so interested in the topic that I didn't let his advice [6]_____ me. Well, I suggest you find a new [7]_____. After all, our professors are here to [8]_____ us, so it's best to listen to them. In retrospect, I wish I had listened to him, but I didn't, and now I don't want to give up my topic as I've already [9]_____ so much time and energy. If you're committed to your current topic, maybe you could make some [10]_____ rather than abandoning it completely. What is your topic? It's depictions of [11]_____ and folklore from the south of the country. That's pretty narrow. You could find more material if you made the topic broader, maybe by including other kinds of [12]_____. Broadening the topic is a great idea. I'll start by including [13]_____ from other regions of the country.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Today on Book Talk, we are lucky enough to host John Robbins and [1]_____ his new book, Why Americans Are Fat and How We Can Lose Weight. John isn't just a [2]_____ writer; he's also one of the rare celebrity authors writing about science today. Thanks for having me, Rebecca. But I'm hardly a celebrity. That's very modest of you to say, considering that your four books have sold a total of 7 million copies

worldwide, and they've been [3] _____ into 12 different languages. What makes people so fascinated with your work? Well, people read my books because more than 60% of Americans are overweight or [4] _____, and other countries are facing similar problems. [5] _____, we all want to know how to fix things. We certainly do. I've read your new book, and it's fabulous, especially when it comes to the way you make difficult science easy for [6] _____ to understand. That's no small achievement. I'm glad to hear you find my work [7] _____, because I was worried, when I wrote it, that discussing the science might make the book more suited for a specialist audience. My last book was written primarily for the medical community, but this time, I want to help [8] _____ people take control of their weight. And how do you [9] _____ they do that? Can you give us the basics of your advice for people who want to lose weight, briefly, I argue that every person needs to consider their [10] _____ and eat what suits their body's needs. I don't advocate one single diet. Some people should eat more [11] _____ than others, and different people need different amounts of protein and fat. But you do have some [12] _____ for everyone, including eating 10 servings of vegetables and three of fruit a day. We'll talk about those recommendations next. But now we need to take a short break for a message from our [13] _____.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Stress is often [1] _____ as negative, but research shows that moderate amounts of it can be beneficial for your brain and your body. First, the benefits for the brain. Studies have shown that short periods of stress can actually [2] _____ cognitive functioning. Researchers discovered that placing rats in a [3] _____ situation for just a few hours doubled the growth of new brain cells. The rats also did better on a memory test later on. [4] _____ think the same thing happens in humans. But how does stress improve memory? It's simple. When your brain cells [5] _____, your memory can improve. Viewed from a [6] _____ perspective, this makes sense because animals that are better at remembering dangerous situations can avoid them in the future. If an animal encounters a [7] _____ and escapes, for example, it's important to remember where and when that encounter happened. Experts [8] _____ that the same principle applies to humans. Now let's turn to how stress benefits the body. This may come as a surprise to [9] _____, but experts say that stress can keep you from getting sick. Scientists [10] _____ that chronic stress can make you more

prone to illness, but research shows that short periods of stress can actually provide some protection against getting sick, because it increases your immune functioning. One study shows that rats that experienced brief stress had a [11]_____ of immune cell response, which makes the immune system better prepared to fight illness. For humans, there is even evidence that experiencing stress before getting [12]_____ could help make vaccines more effective.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

For many managers and people who work in leadership positions, dealing with emails is a [1]_____. It's likely the unpredictable, [2]_____, and ongoing nature of day-to-day email, in terms of volume, importance, and urgency, contributes to their levels of anxiety, and to diminished leadership skills. That's because it's not unusual for many leaders to [3]_____ email management over people management. An obsession with managing their [4]_____ prevents them from dealing with their employees. As a result, they ignore the issues that might only be mild problems at first, until, unfortunately, they inevitably transform into a major problem or crisis by virtue of [5]_____. As leaders, they are expected to motivate and inspire their team in pursuit of longer-term strategic goals, and also, less [6]_____ but more practically, to monitor their daily output, to set clear expectations, and to give regular feedback. When presented with a choice between the appeal of their [7]_____ and other more important activities, many sacrifice the latter. Daily [8]_____ demands have a negative impact on their goal progress. This is because leaders must [9]_____ resources from other tasks to check, filter, and respond to emails. The solution is [10]_____ self-control, which is like a muscle. It can be [11]_____ or improved over time through exercise. Some suggestions include making space in your diary for the only periods during which you'll be checking emails, setting a timer for yourself so you don't become distracted by your [12]_____ for too long, turning off email alerts so you're not interrupted by them.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

In last week's [1]_____, we talked about the problems caused by poor eating habits, focusing on how medical professionals are trying to solve these problems. Today, we'll continue with the topic, but focus on

research from a different field: [2]_____. Now, what can marketing tell us about improving [3]_____? Well, a team of marketing professors has studied the importance of the visual [4]_____ of food, and how that influences food choices. Those marketing experts [5]_____ that the impact of the appearance of food is greater than we might presume, and might hold the key to encouraging better eating. So, how important is the [6]_____ of food? Research shows that just seeing an appealing photograph of a hamburger in an [7]_____, for example, can cause individuals to imagine the taste or smell of that hamburger. This can make them more likely to purchase and [8]_____ it. Of course, that's the point of advertisements. So, isn't that a good thing? Well, the marketing professors argue that this is actually a problem, because the combination of pleasing [9]_____ of and easy access to unhealthy foods such as hamburgers and pizza may be contributing to a worldwide health crisis. In fact, statistics show that 39 percent of all adults in the world weigh too much, and another 13 percent are [10]_____. Now, as we discussed last time, medical professionals have tried to fight the obesity epidemic by focusing on the nutrients found in different foods, emphasizing things like [11]_____, fat, sugar, and calorie content, but they've had limited success. The marketing professors believe that the real solution to [12]_____ is making food look appealing and focusing on the pleasure of both looking at and eating that food. That pleasure can be used as a [13]_____ to promote healthy food choices. In fact, the research done by the team showed that associating healthy food with pleasant images, experiences, and [14]_____ led to greater interest in purchasing or eating it. This is a better strategy, they claim, than [15]_____ consumers that a certain food is good for them. But are they right? Well, the researchers cited a marketing campaign designed to reverse the sales decline of [16]_____. The campaign didn't [17]_____ the carrots' healthy qualities, but embraced their beauty and the pleasure derived from eating them. For example, the ads focused on the bright, beautiful orange color and [18]_____ texture of the carrots. The campaign led to an [19]_____ increase in product sales of more than 10%. The researchers believe that other companies could [20]_____ sales of healthy foods with similar ads, depicting their products as attractive and a source of pleasure.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

The [1]_____ cleaning products industry really began to take off in the 1950s. Prior to that, [2]_____ housewives who had grown up in a less prosperous era relied on substances that they used in their kitchens, such as vinegar used to clean windows. Today, the household cleaning products industry is worth billions of dollars a year, and is [3]_____ by large global companies. In recent years, however, many countries have witnessed a [4]_____ in the number of small businesses and companies offering more environment-friendly cleaning products, and they're doing good business too. One reason for this is that consumers are becoming more aware of environment and [5]_____ issues. They also want to make their home a safe place, free from [6]_____ chemicals. The third reason is people's [7]_____ of and knowledge about technology has never been greater. In the past, people might have been [8]_____ of a new product claimed to be able to achieve amazing cleaning results, but they now have faith in technology's ability to do what was once thought impossible. There is perhaps no better example of this than a [9]_____ cloth sold by one company, which remarkably uses only water rather than traditional cleaning products. The company claims its [10]_____ lifts, traps, and removes dirt and bacteria. And considering that people don't see these products in shops or [11]_____ on TV or in the press, it has been a pretty steep rise. Many of the people behind these companies began testing the [12]_____ of their products by selling them at local markets. Then, in many cases, customers are doing the marketing for these products by leaving threads of comments on social media, praising their [13]_____. There are also TV shows and books dedicated to maintaining home tidiness and [14]_____, and the benefits of having a clean home. Having a safe and clean home might be one thing people feel they can control in an [15]_____ out of control world. And there are social media celebrities. One woman in Britain has become a social media sensation with more than 2 million [16]_____ for her cleaning tips page.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Throwing spare change into a [1]_____ is a time-honored ritual. Throw a [2]_____ into the water, and your wish might come true. But all that money has to go somewhere; otherwise, the growing piles of pennies,

quarters, and [3]_____ could clog up the fountain's works. Today, I'm going to talk about where all the [4]_____ go. Well, the coins collected can go to all sorts of different places, from [5]_____ maintenance to charity or public service. In New York City, for example, coins collected from [6]_____ in public parks often go towards the fountain's maintenance itself, though entrepreneurs who don't mind getting their hands wet often get to it first. There are over 50 beautiful [7]_____ display fountains in New York City parks. They are cleaned by the park's staff every few weeks, but most of the coins have already been removed by [8]_____ New Yorkers, and there is not a significant amount left to be collected. Other cities, though, can pull in a much more serious [9]_____. Take, for example, Rome's famous Trevi Fountain. For hundreds of years, visitors have thrown coins over their shoulder into the [10]_____ to ensure that they will return. So many tourists [11]_____ in coins that Roman officials have the fountain cleaned every night, reportedly getting as much as $4,000 in loose change from around the world each day. Most of the money collected each night goes towards running a supermarket for the needy, and collecting that cash is serious business. Roman officials have been known to be tough on anyone caught [12]_____ coins from the fountain. In one case in 2005, police arrested four fountain [13]_____ after they were spotted slipping coins into their own pockets after collecting them. Authorities finally caught one [14]_____ thief named Thomas Morgan and banned him from the fountain after he fished out thousands of dollars in change over 34 years using a magnetic stick. For the most part, money collected from privately owned [15]_____ in the United States also goes to charity. The fountain in New York City's Bryant Park is owned and operated by a not-for-profit corporation, which puts the cash collected by [16]_____ towards the fountain's own maintenance. Tens of thousands of dollars in coins removed from wishing wells, [17]_____, and ponds in Florida's Walt Disney World are donated each year to support foster children living in the state. Whether or not your wish comes true after [18]_____ a coin into a fountain, you can rest assured knowing that the change is likely going to someone who needs it.

2022年6月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Mr. David Jackson, a staff writer at the New Yorker, is known for his [1]_____ books of adventure. Today we go on a different kind of adventure: Jackson's life of parenting his [2]_____. David, as a [3]_____ of an 11 and a 14-year-old, what is the most interesting issue you are dealing with right now? It's easy to focus on the challenges, but so far I find these ages to be kind of wonderful. They are independent, and they have their own curiosities and [4]_____. You can talk to them about fairly [5]_____ subject matter such as politics. Yes, that does sound [6]_____ compared with talking to younger children. Do they ask you to [7]_____ their essays? Certainly, with writing they do. I really just try to be encouraging. I think at this age, editorial guidance is less important than [8]_____. Are there books that you think are important that your children read and that all children read? My general thought is to read widely and to [9]_____ a love for reading. Learning to love to read, I think, is the [10]_____ thing, because it gives you a skill you can take anywhere. So you're not too concerned, like some parents, with the content they're reading. I know I have some worries about that. Yeah, read what you like. If a child loves graphic novels or comic books, whatever it is that is turning them on to read and turning on their [11]_____. I feel that children's tastes in books change as they reach [12]_____. I know that mine certainly did when I was a [13]_____. What do you think? I think it's especially important as they get older to read subject matter that will open their eyes to the world and people. So I think both fiction and non-fiction are really important because they give you the power to begin to [14]_____ the world through the lives of others.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

In this episode of Money Talks, our guest is Molly Sanders, a university student and a successful young [1]_____. Molly, tell us about your business. Well, I sell [2]_____ clothes through a website, mainly for women who have trouble finding suitable clothes in main street shops because of their height or weight. But I do some men's clothes too. How did you get started in this business at such a young age? Are you

studying fashion design? Actually, I'm majoring in [3]_____, but I've always loved clothes, and I started making my own at 14. Did you have any sort of training in design or [4]_____, or was it a natural ability? I'd have to say no to both. No one taught me to make clothes, and most of the things I made at first were [5]_____. Why did you persevere? I think most people would give up if they kept failing, especially at that age. I kept on out of necessity, as you can see. I'm very tall, and I couldn't find clothes that fit me in [6]_____ shops, so I kept trying and developed my skills over time. Well, my notes say you earned $50,000 in profits last year, an [7]_____ amount for a 20-year-old student. How did that happen? Did you see a gap in the market and decide to fill it. No, when I started university, some classmates [8]_____ my clothes, and when I said I made them myself, other tall women started asking if I would make theirs, and I did. And before I knew it, I was an [9]_____. So, what are your plans for the future? Do you [10]_____ to open a physical store? No, I'll keep things online to keep costs down. But I will add more clothes for children, both girls and boys, and possibly even for [11]_____. And I hope to add to my range of designs for men.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Researchers have identified a potent new [1]_____ compound using artificial intelligence, the antibiotic can kill very dangerous bacteria. According to a study published in the journal Cell, the compound successfully removed deadly strains of bacteria in mice, which are resistant to all known [2]_____. The researchers say this is the first time that artificial intelligence has been used to find a powerful new [3]_____ molecule. Why does this matter? The answer is antibiotic resistance. This happens when bacteria develop the ability to survive the medications designed to kill them, [4]_____ resistance is a serious threat to health, and the problem is growing. This makes finding new antibiotics very important. However, in recent [5]_____, very few have been developed, and those that have tend to be very similar to drugs already available. These searches also tend to only focus on a narrow spectrum of chemical [6]_____. But this is where artificial intelligence comes in. Why? To find new drugs, scientists screen [7]_____ to predict how effective they might be. Typically such screening is done by humans in the lab, which is both [8]_____ and slow. Artificial intelligence is different; it's fast, and it can process a high [9]_____. It can screen hundreds of

millions of [10]_____ to identify a few interesting candidates that require experimental testing, artificial intelligence is also able to predict if compounds are likely to be toxic. Some experts assert that this work [11]_____ a paradigm shift in antibiotic discovery. It could change drug discovery more generally.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

A recent study [1]_____ what we think we know about lying. Most of us have a theory about how to tell if someone is telling a lie, we may develop that theory from observations of those people we know well and see regularly, but we tend to generalize what we gather from that [2]_____ daily research and make it a universal theory. So we might imagine that liars have [3]_____ eyes, or the opposite; they simply stare at you. Or perhaps it is more generally [4]_____ behavior we associate with lies. Whatever the particular theory, it's usually based on close [5]_____ of people we know, and we get lots of practice. On average, we're lied to some 200 times per day. These are mostly [6]_____ lies, but lies none the less. But there's a problem with our theories, even though they're based on all this [7]_____. The average person, you and me, tested [8]_____ on how well we detect lies, fails to do better than chance. That's well established over many studies and lots of attempts by [9]_____ to work out reliable ways to detect lies. It's even relatively easy to [10]_____ lie detectors. The gold standard of lie detection by training yourself in breathing techniques and [11]_____ suppression. Is there any way to get better at [12]_____ lies? The new research offers some surprising advice. Stop looking and listen instead. It turns out that if we're unable to see the face but rather focus on the voice of the person in question, our accuracy rate improves [13]_____.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Appear to be submissive, humble, grateful, and [1]_____. Show great pleasure when a doctor comes into your room, even if the visit is brief and [2]_____, don't challenge anyone with authority unless you're famous or very rich. Those are a few strategies for dealing with today's American medical [3]_____. What patients want is to be treated with respect and [4]_____, but in my experience, too few hospitals and doctors are ready to do that. In his book *A Whole New Life*, [5]_____ Reynolds Price

recalls that his doctors chose a crowded hallway as the place to tell him he might have a tumor on his spinal cord. It did not occur to the two physicians that a [6]_____ was not the most appropriate place for that particular piece of news. My [7]_____, who is in his mid-thirties, looks tired. He has been overwhelmed with [8]_____ who have fallen on the winter ice? He is a witty man, but sometimes his wit is [9]_____. The health insurance company Blue Cross wants me to put you out in the snow tomorrow afternoon. He tells me after I have been in the hospital for more than a week. I'm [10]_____, because I have no idea where to go. I cannot walk or even lift my leg a few [11]_____. The hospital social worker strikes me as an idiot, but my complaints about her only [12]_____ my surgeon. I have to work with these people. He tells my friend, Dr Karen Brudney, when she [13]_____ intervenes on my behalf and arranges for me to be transferred to another hospital. If you say one negative thing, they get [14]_____. She tells me later, they have this kind of [15]_____ loyalty. Always bring an [16]_____, that is, any other person with you to the hospital, and write down every single question and the answer, the name of every doctor and nurse. When people know you have their names, they [17]_____ better. And Brudney adds, if you, as a patient, suggest that you might like to control even part of the situation, or be [18]_____ or informed, then you are considered difficult. They want you to be totally passive. The entire [19]_____ system, particularly hospitals and nursing homes, exists for reasons that have nothing to do with taking care of patients. Patients are incidental.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

There are probably Teams you've worked with that you never want to work with again. But there must have also been other teams that you would prize [1]_____ with professionally. In other words, your team had vitality. [2]_____ comes about when the ties people form with their fellow team members are such that they stay connected even after the team breaks up. What [3]_____ of a team make its members more likely to stay in contact despite no longer working together? This question has been answered recently in a study [4]_____ in a business journal. One of the two key factors the research team discovered is [5]_____, specifically sharing the same gender or ethnic origin. The more members of a team share similar [6]_____, the more inclined they'll be to remain associates long after the team has served its purpose. After ties are established, similarity strengthens them. As a result, they regard these individuals with greater trust

and mutual understanding, which [7]_____ them to seek further opportunities for collaboration. In effect, people tend to create stronger and longer-lasting [8]_____ with similar others. Someone who looks and sounds different from us may have the resources we need to be more successful, yet we find them to be significantly less [9]_____ simply because they are different. If you are a fierce advocate of workplace diversity, you'll no doubt be [10]_____ by such a revelation. The second factor identified by the [11]_____ is the quality of the relationships among the team members. The more they trust one another, share the same goals, and depend on each other for the [12]_____ of those goals, the stronger their chances of maintaining their connections despite no longer working as one team. Teams with quality relationships have a shared belief that it's safe to take risks with each other, and that members are obliged to share the [13]_____ and help out. From personal experience, I can see both the truth and the [14]_____ of such studies. The truth is, some of my closest friendships were formed as a result of having worked together on teams, and I [15]_____ seek opportunities to work with them again. The inconsistency, though, is that I've never worked for a team more successful and cohesive than the one of which I'm a member right now, and yet the four of us have very little in common and are completely different [16]_____. So I'm unlikely to question the value of a diverse [17]_____.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

An American researcher who studied 600 [1]_____ found how rich you can get comes down to six wealth factors. She found that six [2]_____ are related to net worth potential, regardless of age or income. These were thriftiness, confidence, responsibility, planning, focus, and social [3]_____. Being thrifty comes as no great surprise. Spending above your means, spending instead of saving for retirement, spending in anticipation of becoming wealthy, makes you a slave to the paycheck, even with an [4]_____ level of income. She wrote, to properly build [5]_____, experts recommend saving 20% of your income and living off the remaining 80%. Having confidence is another key characteristic, as it helps people to be [6]_____. It takes [7]_____ to live within your means. It also takes confidence to invest properly. Instead of making investing decisions with your emotions, financial [8]_____ advise that you should leave your investments alone and focus on a long-term investment plan. But people can't [9]_____ or manage their own money

without accepting responsibility for the outcomes. Many [10]_____ take on personal responsibility, and most also happen to be self-made, meaning they didn't acquire their wealth through luck. [11]_____ don't count on anyone else to make them rich, and they don't blame anyone else if they fall short. They focus on things they can control and [12]_____ their daily habits to the goals they have set for themselves. They tend to be goal-oriented and hard workers, which enables them to plan [13]_____ and focus on seeing those plans through. 92% of [14]_____ surveyed developed a long-term plan for their money, and 97 percent almost always achieved the goals they set for themselves. And it is these behaviors that make it easy for them to be socially [15]_____. They resist lifestyle creep, the [16]_____ to spend more whenever one earns more. Essentially, they don't yield to pressure to buy the latest thing or to keep up with others or what they have [17]_____. Instead of being focused on what might make them happy today, they're focused on their long-term wealth-building plan.

2021年12月 第2套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Good morning and welcome to People in the News. With me today is Meghan Brown, an environmental activist whose controversial new book, Beyond [1]_____, is making headlines. Hi, Brian. Thanks for having me today. I'm excited to explain to the [2]_____ what my book is really about. Critics of your book [3]_____ that you're trying to force radical changes on the entire country. Some claim that you want to force everyone to eat a [4]_____ diet and make private transport illegal. I'm aware of those claims, but they simply aren't true. People who haven't read the book are making assumptions about my [5]_____. They know I'm a [6]_____, that I don't wear leather or fur, and that I always use public transportation. So they're depicting me as a radical animal rights activist and [7]_____, determined to force my beliefs on others. But don't you want others to [8]_____ your practices? You've campaigned for animal rights and the environment for [9]_____. I'd love it if people chose to live as I do, but my life choices are based on my personal [10]_____. They aren't my [11]_____ for others who don't share those convictions. Well, in this excerpt from your book, you argue that meat consumption and private transport are [12]_____ the environment, and that the best choices for the planet are vegetarian diets and public transport. I did write that, but those are examples of what I call best practices, not what I'm actually [13]_____. In my [14]_____ for saving the environment, I suggest modest changes, like eating vegetarian meals two days a week. You also [15]_____ high taxes on meat and other animal products, and increased taxes on gasoline. Those taxes could force poor people to [16]_____ your life choices. But the taxes I suggest aren't that high, less than 3% only, plus the money generated, would be [17]_____ to environmental protection, which benefits everyone.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

With me in the studio today is Ms. [1]_____ Logan, author of a new book, Secrets to Success. She claims to have [2]_____ how people achieve success. So, Ms. Logan, in your book, you claim that successful people have

many things in common. For instance, they know their strengths when [3]_____ a goal. That's right. They also tend to be [4]_____ by a negative or positive life event. They credit their success to having someone in their life who believes in them? You also write that there are a number of different factors related to success, and while successful people are driven to achieve their goals, the ultra-successful have even greater [5]_____ . Yes, greater [6]_____, as well as a burning desire to be the best of the best. Is also a common characteristic, right? So those who are determined don't see obstacles as something that prevents success, but mere [7]_____ that need to be overcome. Absolutely, successful people are also optimistic, as it is important to stay positive while being aware of obstacles that can [8]_____ us from achieving our goals, that's a good point. All too often, people give up at the first [9]_____. Would you say then that most successful people make it all by themselves? Not exactly. They are usually good at [10]_____ with people and understanding the needs of others, so people will be willing to help them. I guess that's correct, and this often leads to a great deal of mutual respect, whether it's with a colleague, an assistant, or even a [11]_____. Most successful people I know are very passionate about their work. Would you say that [12]_____ is the single biggest key to success? Not entirely. There's a prerequisite. That is, you have to work in an environment that [13]_____ passion. If that exists, success will follow.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

[1]_____ one: The saying "blind as a bat" simply isn't correct. The truth is that all 1,100 bat species can see, and often their [2]_____ is pretty good, although not as excellent as other night-hunting animals. There are two main groups of bats which are believed to have evolved independently of each other, but both from a common [3]_____, the first group, known as mega bats, are mostly medium-sized or large bats who eat fruits, flowers, and sometimes small animals or fish. These species have [4]_____ visual centers and big eyes. They use senses of vision and smell to capture their [5]_____. For example, flying foxes not only see well during [6]_____ but can also distinguish colors. They actually rely on their daylight vision and cannot fly during the night with no [7]_____. The second group, called micro bats, are smaller in size and mostly eat [8]_____. These species use [9]_____ to find their way and identify food. Scientists have proven that despite their poorly developed small eyes, these [10]_____ still can see during the day. When we

consider the [11]_____ lifestyle of these bats, we will see they have to be sensitive to the changing light levels, because this is how they sense when to start hunting. Moreover, vision is used by micro bats to travel over long distances beyond the range of [12]_____. So the truth is, there are no [13]_____ which are naturally blind. Some species use their sense of hearing more than their eyes as a matter of [14]_____ to a particular lifestyle, but their eyes are still functional.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

[1]_____ two: A study has found that educational TV shows come with an added lesson that influences the child's behavior. Children spending more time watching educational programs increase their emotional [2]_____ toward other children. This shows that children can learn the educational lesson that was [3]_____. However, they're also learning other things along the way, this [4]_____ impact has to do with the portrayal of conflict in media and how pre-school-age children comprehend that conflict. TV and movie producers often [5]_____ an element of bad behavior. This is to teach children a lesson at the end of the program, [6]_____ shows have pro-education and pro-social goals. However, conflict between characters is often depicted with characters being [7]_____ to each other, or they may use emotionally aggressive tactics with each other. [8]_____ children really don't get the moral of the story. That's because it [9]_____ that they understand how all the parts of the show fit together. You need pretty complicated [10]_____ skills and memory skills to be able to do that. These are still developing in young children. However, parents shouldn't completely constrain children's viewing. Parents should instead watch with their kids and help them to understand the [11]_____. Parents can comment along the way and then explain the message at the end. They should explain how certain types of behavior were not [12]_____. This will help children [13]_____ and get the message, and help them learn to watch the show for those messages.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

While it has long been a practice in Asian countries, many people in Western countries have yet to [1]_____ the "no shoes in the house" rule. For many in those countries, [2]_____ their shoes before going inside is

regarded as sufficient. After all, they may think a little [3]_____ doesn't hurt anyone, but I can give you several good reasons why people should remove their shoes before going inside their homes. Bacteria are everywhere. They collect on your shoes when you walk along [4]_____, public toilet floors, and even office carpets. In one study conducted at an American university, researchers collected microscopic [5]_____ from footwear. They found that up to 421,000 units of bacteria can collect on the outside of a single shoe, and it only takes a little bit of dirt to damage your [6]_____ floors. The more dirt you track in, the more it scratches, and the more often you have to clean, the extra [7]_____ will harm your floors over time. Shoes can also leave marks and scratches on floors, especially high heels or shoes with [8]_____ or hard parts. These can [9]_____ and scratch your floor, and if you live in an apartment building, removing your noisy shoes is the polite thing to do out of consideration for your downstairs neighbors. Walking around with bare feet is actually better for your feet. It strengthens the muscles in your feet. Though many people are accustomed to wearing shoes during all their waking hours, the more time you spend wearing shoes, the more likely you are to [10]_____ foot injuries as a result. And if people aren't yet convinced by my arguments, I can give one final reason: The dust and toxic chemicals you bring into your house via your shoes can [11]_____ the air quality in your home. Toxic chemicals are everywhere in our lives. Insect-killing [12]_____ used on public grass areas, cleaning chemicals on the floors of public areas. By kicking off your shoes before you enter the home, you are denying entry to these [13]_____ chemicals. Given the amount of time we spend in classrooms and the number of shoes that pass through them every day, you may well understand me if I were to [14]_____ a no shoes in the classroom rule.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Emotions are an essential and [1]_____ part of our consciousness. They are part of a built-in mechanism which allows us to cope with the ups and downs of our lives, both physically and [2]_____. When we hide our emotions and our true feelings, we stop being genuine, [3]_____, and authentic in our relationships. When we put on [4]_____ and polished faces in the company of others, we stop being true to ourselves. Socially, it may be a good tactic to hide our true emotions, but [5]_____, it is also a breach of faith and trust. Although humans are more advanced and intelligent, animals are more genuine and

[6] _____ in their behavior and responses than human beings. The more educated we are, the less [7] _____ and reliable we become. We are drawn to our [8] _____ because pets do not lie. One of the first steps in dealing with emotions such as anger or fear is to [9] _____ them as normal and human. There is nothing sinful or immoral about being emotional unless your emotions make you [10] _____, insensitive, and cruel to others. Feelings of guilt associated with emotions are more [11] _____ and damaging than the experience of emotion itself. So, when you deal with the problem of emotions, you should learn not only how to control them, but also how to accept them and manage the guilt and [12] _____ arising from them. Our brains are made up of a [13] _____ inner core and a more evolved and rational outer core. Most of the time, the rational part of the mind controls the information coming from the [14] _____ core and makes its own decisions as to what to do and how to respond. However, during critical situations, especially when a threat is perceived, the outer core loses control and fails to regulate the impulses and [15] _____ responses coming from the primitive brain. As a result, we let disturbing thoughts and emotions arise in our consciousness and surrender to our [16] _____ behavior. In times of emotional [17] _____, remember that emotions arise because your senses are wired to the primitive part of your mind, which is self-regulated, autonomous, and spontaneous. Your rational mind does not always deal with the messages coming from it effectively, these messages are part of your survival mechanism and should not be [18] _____ simply because emotions are unhealthy and betray your weaknesses. When emotions arise, instead of [19] _____ them, pay attention to them and try to understand the messages they are trying to deliver. This way, you make use of your [20] _____ without losing your balance and inner stability.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Good morning, class. My topic today is how to feed a [1] _____ world. The world's population is expected to grow from 6.8 [2] _____ today to 9.1 billion by 2050. [3] _____, the world's population more than doubled from 3 billion between 1961 and 2007. Simultaneously, food production has been [4] _____ by a lack of scientific research. Still, the [5] _____ of feeding the world's population in 2050 seems easily possible. What is needed is a second green revolution. This is an approach that is described as the [6] _____ growth of global agriculture. Such a revolution will require a [7] _____ shift of priorities in agricultural

research. There is an [8]_____ need for new crop varieties. They must offer higher yields but use less water, nitrogen-rich [9]_____, or other inputs. These new crops must also be more resistant to drought, heat, and [10]_____. Equally crucial is lower-tech research into [11]_____ such as crop rotation and mixed farming of animals and plants on small farms. Developing nations could score substantial gains in [12]_____ by making better use of modern technologies and practices, but that requires money. It is [13]_____ that to meet the 2050 challenge, investment must double to 83 billion U.S. dollars a year. Most of that money needs to go towards improving [14]_____ infrastructure. Everything from production to storage and [15]_____ must improve. However, research [16]_____ need to be focused on the needs of the poorest and most resource-limited countries. It is there that most of the world's population lives, and it is there that population growth over the next [17]_____ will be the greatest. To their credit, the world's agricultural scientists are [18]_____ such a broad view. In March, for example, they came together at the first global conference on agricultural research to begin working out how to change research [19]_____ to help meet the needs of farmers in poorer nations. But these plans will not bear fruit unless they get [20]_____ more support from policymakers. The growth in public agricultural research spending peaked in the 1970s and has been [21]_____ ever since. The big exception is China, where spending has far [22]_____ other countries over the past decade. China seems set to transition to become the key [23]_____ of relevant science and technology to poorer countries. But developed countries have a [24]_____ responsibility too. Calls by scientists for large increases in the [25]_____ of funds for public spending on agricultural research are more than justified.

2021年12月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hi, David. I haven't seen you in class for almost two weeks. We thought you had [1]_____ on holiday early or something. Hi, Sarah. Well, it's a bit of a long story, I'm [2]_____. I got a throat infection last week and had to go to the hospital to get some [3]_____, as I really wasn't getting any better. Oh yeah, there have been so many [4]_____ going around this winter. The weather's been so awful for the last few weeks, and on the way back from the hospital, I slipped on some ice and fell, and then had to go to the hospital to get an X-ray because I basically thought I'd broken my [5]_____. Although [6]_____ it's not broken, but I need to be careful with it for the next few weeks. Oh, that's too bad. How unfortunate! To make things worse, I managed to fall right in front of four girls from the ninth grade, so I was utterly [7]_____. Plus, the [8]_____ in my bag was broken too. Now, what a complete catastrophe! Is the laptop still under warranty? If it is, then you can easily send it back to the [9]_____, and they'll send you a brand new one for free. Surely. The [10]_____ ran out three days before I broke it, and all my essays are in there, and I need to hand them in before we break for the Christmas holidays. Listen, I have the number of a really good, [11]_____ computer repair shop at home. My dad has used this guy before, and he can work miracles. Let's go back to my house, and we can call the repair shop, and you can have some tea and [12]_____ too. Wow! Thanks, Sarah. That would be great. Let me just call my mom and let her know I'll be home a little bit later.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Welcome to this week's episode of Book Talk. With me today is Heidi Brown, a [1]_____ who has written five critically acclaimed books about military history. Thanks for having me, John. I'm so excited to talk about my latest book, which was [2]_____ last month. So this book is a novel. Your first attempt at that [3]_____, and thus a bit of a departure for you. I'd say it's a major [4]_____, as it's not just a work of fiction. It's set 200 years in the future. Right. So how did that happen? You spent three decades writing about

the past and focusing on the 18th and 19th centuries, and now you're [5]_____ about the future. Well, after years of researching soldiers and chronicling their lives during battle, I just started wondering about other [6]_____ of their lives, especially their personal lives. I can see that your novel is about [7]_____, but it focuses on their relationships, especially the bonds between sons and mothers, and men and their wives. Yes, that focus came about when I still [8]_____ to write another book of history. I started by researching [9]_____' actual personal lives, studying their letters home. So, how did that history book become a [10]_____? Well, I realized that the historical record was [11]_____, so I'd either have to leave a lot of gaps or make a lot more assumptions than a historian should. But why write a novel set in the future when your [12]_____ are perfect for a historical novel? As a historian, any historical novel you write would have a lot of [13]_____. I felt too [14]_____ working with the past, like what I wrote needed to be fact as opposed to fiction. But writing about the future gave me more freedom to imagine, to [15]_____. Well, having read your book, I am glad you made that choice to move into [16]_____.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Whether it's in the hands of animated polar bears or Santa Claus, there's one thing you'll find in nearly all ads for Coca-Cola: the [1]_____ glass bottle. Most Americans don't drink [2]_____ out of the glass bottles seen in Coke's ads anymore. But this week, the company is [3]_____ a century of the bottle that's been sold in more than 200 countries. [4]_____ to 1915 when a bottle of Coca-Cola cost just a nickel. As the soft drink gained in popularity, it faced a growing number of competitors, [5]_____ even trying to copy Coke's logo. So, according to Coca-Cola historian Ted Ryan, the company decided to come up with packaging that couldn't be [6]_____. A product [7]_____ was sent to eight different glassmakers. Workers at the Root Glass Company got the request and began flipping through the [8]_____ at the local library, landing on cocoa seed. Though [9]_____ seed is not an ingredient of the soda, they designed their bottle based on the seed's shape and large middle. It won over Coke executives in Atlanta and would go on to receive its own trademark, [10]_____ collections, and earn Coca-Cola an iconic image that made it part of American culture for a century, it was 100 years ago this week that the bottle earned a patent. By World War II, Coke bottle sales had [11]_____ into billions. Americans mostly [12]_____ Coke out

of aluminum or plastic today, but the glass bottle remains a symbol of America that's readily recognized around the world.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Research shows that a few moments of conversation with a stranger creates a [1]_____ improvement in mood, but most of us are reluctant to start these conversations because we presume the opposite. In an experiment, [2]_____ who talked to nearby strangers found their commute more enjoyable than those who didn't. They were asked to predict whether they'd enjoy the commute more if they [3]_____ with other people. [4]_____, most expected the more solitary experience to be more pleasurable. Why is this? Social anxiety appears to be the problem. People's [5]_____ to start conversations with nearby strangers comes partly from underestimating others' interest in connecting. The sad thing is that people presume that a nearby stranger doesn't want to [6]_____ and don't start a conversation. Only those who forced themselves to chat because it was required by the experiment found out what a [7]_____ experience it could be. Human beings are social animals. Those who [8]_____ the impact of social interactions may not, in some contexts, be social enough for their own well-being. You should be chatting with the strangers you [9]_____. You may occasionally have a negative [10]_____ that might stick in your memory. This is because the human brain is [11]_____ to dwell on negative events. But starting conversations with strangers is still well worth the risk of [12]_____. It may surprise you that [13]_____ with strangers will make them happier too. The pleasure of connection seems contagious. People who are talked to have equally positive experiences as those who [14]_____ a conversation.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

[1]_____ one, the Caribbean islands are divided into two worlds: a rich one and a poor one. This [2]_____ region's economy is based mainly on farming. Farmers are of two types. One is the [3]_____ owner, who may have hundreds of thousands of acres. In contrast, the small [4]_____ is working only a few acres of land. Most visitors to the Caribbean are rich, like the [5]_____ owner. They do not realize, or do not want to realize, that many farm families [6]_____ manage to get by on what

they grow, the Caribbean produces many things. Sugar is the main product. Other export crops are tobacco, coffee, bananas, spices, and citrus fruits such as orange, lemon, or [7]_____. From the West Indies also come oil, [8]_____ pitch, and many forest products. Jamaica's [9]_____ ore supplies are the world's largest. Oil comes from Trinidad, Aruba, and Curacao, but for many of the smaller islands, sugar is the only [10]_____. Rum, a strong alcoholic drink which is [11]_____ from sugar cane, is also an export. The world's best rum comes from this area. Local kinds vary from the light [12]_____ of Puerto Rico to the heavier, darker rums of Barbados and Jamaica. American tourists enjoy stocking up on [13]_____, high-quality Caribbean rum while they are on vacation. In Curacao, the well-known [14]_____ of that name is made from the thick outer skin of a native orange. Ever since America's [15]_____ days, the Caribbean islands have been favorite places to visit. Since World War II, [16]_____ has increased rapidly, because great numbers of people go there. The [17]_____ have built elaborate resorts, developed harbors and airfields, improved beaches, and have expanded sea and air routes. Everything is at the resort: hotel, beach, shopping, and [18]_____. The vacationer never has any reason to [19]_____ the island, as in most places, those who have money live well indeed. Those who don't have money live at various levels of poverty, but here the poor greatly [20]_____ the wealthy. A visitor will find rich people living in apartments or Spanish houses at the [21]_____ or in the countryside, their servants might include a cook, a maid, and a nurse for the children. Most of the people live well below the poverty level. In towns, they live [22]_____ together in tiny houses. [23]_____ make the best they can of what they have. Their homes are quite shabby. [24]_____, most tourists never see this side of the Caribbean.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Talk to anyone who is a generation or two older, and they would most likely comment that children are more [1]_____ these days. No one wants to have or be around demanding, selfish, and spoiled children; those who get bad-tempered or silently [2]_____ when they're not given everything they want immediately. [3]_____, the parents of such children encourage this demanding behavior in the mistaken belief that by giving their children everything they can, their children will be happy. In the short term, perhaps they are right, but in the longer term, such children end up lonely, dependent, chronically dissatisfied, and

[4] _____ of the parents who tried so hard to please them. Undoubtedly, parents want to raise happy children who are confident, capable, and [5] _____, rather than spoiled and miserable. One factor [6] _____ this is that parents can't or don't spend enough quality time with their kids, and substitute this deficit with toys, games, gadgets, and the like. Rather than getting material things, children need parents' [7] _____ attention. The [8] _____ of time spent together is less important than the content of that time. Instead of instantly [9] _____ their wishes, parents should help them work out a plan to earn things they'd like to have. This teaches them to value their effort as well as what it [10] _____. Allow them to enjoy anticipation. Numerous psychological studies have [11] _____ that children who learn to wait for things they desire are more likely to succeed in a number of ways later in life. One famous experiment in the 1960s [12] _____ three to 6-year-old children. They were given a choice between receiving a small reward such as a [13] _____ immediately, or if they waited 15 minutes, they could have two. Follow-up studies have found that those who chose to delay satisfaction are now more [14] _____ successful, have greater self-worth, and even tend to be healthier. If they fail, children should be encouraged to keep trying rather than to give up if they really want the [15] _____ result. This teaches them how to handle and recover from disappointment, which is associated with greater success and satisfaction [16] _____, financially, and in personal relationships. And [17] _____, parents should encourage their children to look at life from other points of view as well as their own. This teaches them to be understanding of and [18] _____ towards others, qualities sure to take them a long way in life.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

It's not hard to mess up an interview. Most people feel nervous sitting across from a hiring manager, answering questions that effectively open themselves up for [1] _____. And your chances of being more carefully considered for the job can quickly go downhill just by saying the wrong thing at the wrong time. The most obvious thing not to do is [2] _____. Employers want to hire positive people. Talking about a previous job [3] _____ raises concerns that you might be difficult to manage, or you might be someone that blames management for your own poor performance. Don't say that you've moved around in jobs because you haven't found the right fit or feel that you were not challenged enough. Statements like these will make you sound

[4]_____ and lost. An [5]_____ may well think, "Why would this role be any different for you? You will probably leave here in six months. It also begs the question of what type of relationship you had with your manager. It doesn't sound like you had open [6]_____ with him or her. Managers usually love people who can self-sustain and [7]_____ growth through taking initiative, who are strong at following through their work, and who bring ideas and solutions to the table. If you were in a management or leadership position, when discussing your current role, never take all the credit for [8]_____ or achievements. [9]_____ your team and how, through their talents, your vision was realized. Most successful leaders know that they are only as good as their team, and [10]_____ this in an interview will go a long way towards suggesting that you might be the right person for the position you are applying for. [11]_____, have a good idea of what your role will be, and try and convey the idea that you're flexible, asking what your role will be, suggests you will limit yourself purely to what is expected of you. In reality, your role is whatever you make of it. This is especially true in small companies, where the ability to [12]_____ and take on new responsibilities is highly valued, and this is equally important if you are just starting out. Entry-level [13]_____ would do well to demonstrate a broad set of skills in most interviews. It's important to have a wide skill set, as many [14]_____ and small companies are moving really fast. Employers are looking for candidates that are intelligent and can quickly adapt and [15]_____ in a growing company.

2021年6月 第2套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

How are you enjoying your new job? So far, so good. I don't miss having managers who deliver [1]_____, harsh feedback in the name of efficiency. From the way you described your last company, no wonder they had a problem with high staff [2]_____. Yeah, I couldn't wait to get out of there once my contract [3]_____. The problem with a company culture that prizes [4]_____ above all else is that it creates a toxic culture of brilliant jerks that drives people out and erodes itself from within. My company's managers tend to be [5]_____ and kind, overlooking mistakes or issues so as not to hurt feelings. Issues often get [6]_____ there until they build up and reach a crisis point. That's not surprising. My new company seems to employ a feedback policy that combines compassion and [7]_____. Employees have the power to speak up, give feedback, [8]_____, and discuss problems in real time. It seems to help us to course correct, improve, and meet challenges, while also building teams that [9]_____ and care for one another. But that would be based on an atmosphere of [10]_____ trust, wouldn't it? Otherwise, people might [11]_____ feedback as some kind of personal attack. True, without an atmosphere of trust, [12]_____ can create stress and self-doubt. But I think, when we get [13]_____ from someone we trust, we understand that the feedback isn't some kind of personal attack. It's actually a kind of support, because it's offered in the spirit of helping us improve. think sometimes people need to shift their [14]_____ around how they receive feedback. Yes, [15]_____ feedback, after all, is how we learn and grow. It's the basis for healthy [16]_____, lasting friendships, career development, and so much more. If we shelter our children, friends, and colleagues from information that might [17]_____ and enhance their lives, we're not being caring; we're actually doing harm to them. That's exactly right.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

How was your holiday? Not too many other [1]_____ around were there? No, very few relatively. But I found myself moving from one [2]_____ to another, trying to find the perfect place. It made me

realize that [3]_____ is a big problem for me. Instead of [4]_____, I was looking for the best spot. It seems you suffer from fear of better options. I've read about it. It describes this loop of [5]_____ as part of our programming. Essentially, we have this tendency to keep stretching out the decision-making process, because as human beings, we are hardwired to [6]_____. We have always looked to get the best things we can as a sort of survival of the fittest. [7]_____ isn't the problem, but rather the process that we go through. Well, that makes me feel better. But I think, thanks to technology, we can make comparisons more easily and have more access to choice and [8]_____. We can now see what we could have, how we might get it, and what others have that we might want. We keep looking over and returning to the same options again and again. Yes, fear of better options offers little benefit. It's an ailment of abundance. You must have choices to have that fear of missing out on better options. Yes, I need to note when I'm worrying about [9]_____ things. I guess if I'm spending too much time worrying over what to have for lunch, I'm robbing myself of the energy to focus on the things that matter. Exactly, but for more important matters, I think gut instinct might be overrated. When you have 30 odd options, trusting your gut is not [10]_____. What you need to do is research, have a process, invest time exploring your options, and [11]_____ as many things as you can. The most [12]_____ part of decision making is going over the same options time and time again.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

[1]_____ one: The role of homework in classrooms is not a new debate. Many parents and teachers are [2]_____ supporters of homework, but do all students benefit from homework? A 2006 research paper suggested some [3]_____ between the amount of homework done by a student and future academic achievement for middle and high school students, but not so much for younger kids. A Stanford study in 2014 suggested that the same was true for students in California's [4]_____ communities. The findings challenged the idea that homework was [5]_____ good. The researchers concluded that there was an upper limit to the correlation between homework and achievement, suggesting that high school students shouldn't be doing more than two hours of homework a night, and the most valuable kind of homework for elementary-level children was simply [6]_____ free reading. The topic gets more complicated when we talk

about the [7]_____ between rural and urban communities. Studies found that in remote areas, the poor quality or lack of internet access can put students at a disadvantage because 70% of teachers in these areas [8]_____ homework that requires internet access, but one in three households doesn't have internet. Experts [9]_____ homework requiring the internet isn't fair. While the debate continues about the effect of homework on academic [10]_____, there are studies focusing on other benefits of homework. A study in Germany found that homework could have an effect on students' personalities, suggesting that doing homework might help kids to become more [11]_____ and independent learners.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

[1]_____ two, Robert Goddard, an American born in 1882, is widely regarded as the world's first rocket scientist. At age 27, Goddard published his first book, in which he [2]_____ that a rocket launched from Earth could reach the Moon. Like many visionaries, the young scientist encountered numerous [3]_____. In January 1920, the New York Times [4]_____ Goddard's theory that rockets could be utilized for space exploration. 49 years later, Apollo 11 reached the moon, and the [5]_____ newspaper published an apology to Goddard. Goddard [6]_____ his first rocket from an aunt's farm in his native Massachusetts in March 1926. His [7]_____ rocket voyage lasted a mere three seconds, it scaled an altitude of only 12 meters. Nonetheless, it was a [8]_____ in rocket science. Goddard later consulted with a weather expert, and determined that the climate of New Mexico was [9]_____ for year-round rocket launches. In 1930, Goddard and his family [10]_____ there, to a remote valley in the southwest of the country. There, he established a [11]_____ and test range. However, the ambitious scientist received [12]_____ support from the government. For four years, wealthy businessman Daniel Guggenheim provided Goddard with an annual $25,000 grant to pursue his dreams, other rocket [13]_____ also raised funds for him. Over time, Goddard's rockets grew more [14]_____, and included the installation of instruments. In spite of his many successes, Goddard was never able to interest the U.S. military in rocket-propelled [15]_____. He was granted over 200 patents and continued to [16]_____ rocket technology until his death in 1945.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Working for a new [1]_____ comes with a lot of risks. There's [2]_____, unclear responsibilities, and the need to be a master of all trades. But the primary benefit is usually the passion and excitement associated with playing a role in a promising new company, the person to thank for that passion and excitement is almost always the [3]_____. There's something about the founder's energy and enthusiasm that [4]_____ the rest of the team. The willingness to take risks may inspire others to be more [5]_____. The optimism and [6]_____ may motivate people to focus less on trivial and unimportant matters. The celebration of milestones may prompt staff to be more grateful about their own [7]_____ and privileges. What becomes set in the firm's culture is a contagious collection of [8]_____ and positive emotions, which are usually shared among the team. Science has already done a good job of [9]_____ the results that follow. These include better processes, greater team cohesion, reduced conflict, and sharper [10]_____. But what is yet to be [11]_____ is whether the founders' passion leads to increased team performance. This was recently tested in research, which [12]_____ the teams of 73 new companies across a range of industries, such as IT, medicine, and energy. The CEOs were consulted once again years after the initial analysis, and most shared their firm's performance reports so that their success could be more [13]_____ Measured entrepreneurial teams generally progress through three phases. The first is [14]_____ a product or service. The second is founding the [15]_____ to sell that product or service, and the third is developing the firm so it continues to grow. The [16]_____ discovered that when the team is passionate about the third phase, developing the firm, there's a clear link to performance. But the first phase, a passion for invention, is not a reliable [17]_____ that the firm will still be open for business a few years later. [18]_____, the second—a passion for founding the venture doesn't necessarily translate into greater success. The solution to great team performance stems from a [19]_____ to recruit others who could direct their passion towards the third phase of entrepreneurialism: developing the business, employing more staff can in itself be a risk for an entrepreneur, as is paying them big dollars to attract them. On many occasions, the [20]_____ reported not paying themselves a wage at all initially in order to cover salaries and expenses.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Aging is a [1]_____ thing, and people's desire to beat it, and death, has become an industry worth hundreds of billions of dollars. Despite the huge investment into research, aging remains somewhat [2]_____, although there are certain things researchers do understand. They know that women tend to have longer [3]_____, living on average six years longer than men. No one is really certain of the reason for this, although the [4]_____ centers around the idea that women are more capable of surviving or handling disease than men. For [5]_____ every disease, the effects are greater on men than they are on women. Some suggest that women's immune systems benefit from their tendency to [6]_____ and nurture social connections, but for me, this explanation is hardly convincing. [7]_____ also know, to an extent, what causes aging. For 60 years, it was believed that cells would continue to [8]_____ forever. It was only [9]_____ in relatively recent times that older people's cells divide a smaller number of times than younger people's. Only cancer cells, in fact, are capable of dividing [10]_____. Human cells have a limited reproductive ability. To an extent, we can [11]_____ the eventual stop of cells dividing through nutrition, exercise, good sleep, and even relaxation techniques, but we cannot stop the aging process. And [12]_____ are yet to answer the ultimate question of aging: Why does the body ultimately fall to pieces? In the opinion of some of the world's best scientific minds on the subject, part of the reason we don't yet have an answer is because many [13]_____ are looking in the wrong direction. Many public health policymakers believe that the resolution of age-associated disease will tell us something fundamental about the aging process, but say some top scientists, that's completely [14]_____. They point to when the diseases of childhood were [15]_____, but this did not provide any insight into childhood development. In the same way, the idea that the resolution of age-associated disease like heart disease and stroke will [16]_____ us about aging is not based on sound science or logic. At best, if the major causes of death in developed countries were [17]_____, this would only add a decade to average life expectancy. But while there is money available to be spent on it, the search to understand the secrets of aging will be [18]_____.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Good afternoon. In today's talk, we'll [1]_____ how managers can get their staff to do what they are asked. Much to their frustration, managers often struggle to get their staff to comply with even simple [2]_____. Often, they blame their employees. They don't read emails. They don't listen. They don't care. That kind of thing. But according to recent research conducted in Australia, it looks like it's not the [3]_____' fault but the managers. It's easy to understand why people sometimes [4]_____ procedures intentionally. [5]_____, it's because they're pressured to finish in a short time. At other times, they may disagree with the spirit of the procedure, the effort demanded, the time [6]_____, the lack of potential effectiveness, and every now and then they just don't want to. Maybe deliberately or out of stubbornness. So apart from that, what else gets in the way of [7]_____ compliance? The research [8]_____ surveyed 152 blue-collar workers from two separate sites in the mining industry. They asked the workers a range of procedure-related questions, such as whether they found the procedures useful, how confident they felt in their job, how comfortable they were to speak up in the [9]_____, and how closely they followed any new procedures set by their managers. They were also asked to rate the extent to which they [10]_____ their supervisors to be helpful. That last statement was the most [11]_____, because, as the researchers found, there is a remarkably strong correlation between how helpful supervisors were perceived to be, and how likely their employees were to follow their directives, supervisors' helping behavior was found to be motivational in nature. It increased employees' perception of the likelihood of success in the [12]_____ of job goals, and therefore fostered a willingness to dedicate their effort and ability to their work. In short, managers should be [13]_____ role models for the change. As the saying goes, "Do as I do, not as I say." To affect [14]_____ change, what's most required is interaction and involvement, the human touch, and naturally processes that add value. Although [15]_____ are designed to guide and support employees' work, employees, it seems, can't always be expected to comply with procedures that are not seen as useful. And of course, managers shouldn't keep [16]_____ emails. They're an effective tool for the sharing of data and reports, but they're a [17]_____ tool if what a manager is desiring is a change in behavior.

2021年6月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

It's my last day at work tomorrow. I start my new job in two weeks. My human resources manager wants to [1]_____ an interview with me before I leave. Ah, an exit interview. Are you looking forward to it? I'm not sure how I feel about it. I [2]_____ because I've been unhappy at that company for a long time, but I'm not sure if I should tell them how I really feel. To my way of thinking, there are two main potential benefits that come from unleashing an [3]_____ stream of truth during an exit interview. The first is release, unburdening yourself of frustration and perhaps even anger to someone who isn't a friend or close colleague can be wonderfully [4]_____. And let me guess, the second is that the criticism will [5]_____ help the organization I'm leaving to improve, making sure employees of the future are less likely to encounter what I did, that's right. But the problem with the company [6]_____ part is that very often it doesn't happen. An exit interview is supposed to be private, but often isn't. In my company, the information gained from these interviews is often not [7]_____, and the information is used as dirt against another manager, or can be traded among senior managers. Now you've got me [8]_____ what I'll disclose in the interview. There is always the chance that it could affect my [9]_____ and my ability to network in the industry. It is a pretty small industry, after all. Anything you initially gain from the instant satisfaction of telling it like it is, you might lose down the track by [10]_____ your future career prospects. Right. Perhaps I would be better getting things off my chest by going to one of those rate your [11]_____ websites. You could, and don't do the interview at all. Exit interviews are not mandatory.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Today, I'm talking to the renowned [1]_____ Jane Forster. Thank you for [2]_____ me to join you on the show, Henry. Recently, Jane, you've become quite a [3]_____ since the release of your latest documentary. Can you tell us a little about it? Well, it follows my expedition to study the vegetation indigenous to the rainforest in [4]_____ areas of Southeast Asia. You certainly get to travel to some very [5]_____

locations. It was far from [6]_____, to be honest. The area we visited was accessible only by [7]_____, and the living conditions in the hut were primitive, to say the least. There was no [8]_____, and our water supply was a nearby stream. How were the weather conditions while you were there? The weather was not conducive to our work at all, since the humidity was almost [9]_____. At [10]_____, we stayed in the hut and did nothing. It was too [11]_____ to either work or sleep. How long did your team spend in the [12]_____? [13]_____, we planned to be there for a month, but in the end, we stayed for only two weeks. Why did you cut the expedition short? Halfway through the trip, we received news that a hurricane was approaching, and we had to [14]_____ at very short notice. That sounds like a fascinating anecdote. It was frightening. The fastest evacuation route was through river [15]_____. We had to [16]_____ them carrying all of our equipment. So overall, was the journey unsuccessful? Absolutely not. We [17]_____ a massive amount of data about the local plant life. Why do you put up with such [18]_____ conditions? Botany is an obsession for me. Many of the destinations I visit have stunning [19]_____, and I get to meet a variety of people from all over the world. So, where will your next destination be? I haven't decided yet. Then we can leave it for another [20]_____. Thanks.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Scientists often use specialized jargon terms while communicating with [1]_____. Most of them don't realize the [2]_____ effects of this practice. In a new study, people exposed to [3]_____ when reading about subjects like autonomous vehicles and surgical robots later said they were less interested in science than others who read about the same topics, but without the use of specialized terms, they also felt less informed about science and less qualified to discuss science topics. It's noteworthy that it made no difference if the [4]_____ terms were defined in the text. Even when the terms were defined, readers still felt the same lack of engagement as readers who read [5]_____ that wasn't explained. The problem is that the mere presence of jargon sends a [6]_____ message to readers. Hillary Shulman, the author of the study, [7]_____ that specialized words are a signal. [8]_____ tells people that the message isn't for them. There's an even darker side to how people react to [9]_____. In another study, researchers found that reading scientific articles containing [10]_____ led people to doubt the actual science. They found the [11]_____ when a text is easier to read.

Then, people are more persuaded. Thus, it's important to [12]_____ clearly when talking about complex science subjects. This is especially true with issues related to public health, like the safety of new medications and the benefits of vaccines, Shulman concedes that the use of [13]_____ is appropriate with scientific audiences. But scientists who want to communicate with the general public need to [14]_____ their language. They need to eliminate jargon.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

At the beginning of the 20th century, on the Gulf Coast in the U.S. state of Texas, there was a hill where gas leakage was so noticeable that schoolboys would sometimes set the hill on fire, Pattillo Higgins, a disreputable local businessman, became convinced that there was oil below the [1]_____ hill. Oil wells weren't [2]_____ back then; they were essentially dug. The sand under the hill [3]_____ several attempts by Higgins' workers to make a proper hole. Higgins had [4]_____ oil at a thousand feet, a totally made-up figure. Higgins [5]_____ hired a mining engineer, Captain Anthony Lucas. After encountering several [6]_____, Captain Lucas decided to use a drill, and his innovations created the modern oil drilling industry. In January 1901, at 1,020 feet, almost precisely the depth predicted by Higgins' wild guess, the well roared and suddenly ejected mud and six tons of drilling pipe out of the ground, [7]_____ those present. For the next nine days until the well was [8]_____, the well poured out more oil than all the wells in America combined. In those days, Texas was almost entirely rural, with no large cities and [9]_____ no industry, cotton and beef were the foundation of the economy. Higgins' well changed that. The boom made some [10]_____ millionaires, but the sudden surplus of petroleum was not entirely a blessing for Texas. In the 1930s, prices [11]_____ to the point that in some parts of the country, oil was cheaper than water. That would become a familiar [12]_____ of the boom or bust Texas economy.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Most people dislike their jobs. It's an astonishing, but statistical fact. A primary cause of employee [1]_____, according to fresh research, is that many believe they have terrible managers. Few describe their managers as malicious or [2]_____, though. While those types certainly exist, they are

[3]_____. The majority of managers [4]_____ just don't know any better. They're often [5]_____ bad managers they've had in the past. It's likely they've never read a management book or [6]_____ a management course. They might not have even reflected on what good management looks like, and how it would [7]_____ their own management style. The [8]_____ interviewed employees about their managers, beginning with a question about the worst manager they had ever had. From this, the researchers came up with four main causes of why some managers are [9]_____ as being simply awful at their jobs. The first cause was company culture, which was seen by employees as [10]_____ poor management practices. It was specifically [11]_____ work environments, minimal training, and a lack of accountability that were found to be the most blameworthy. Often, a manager's superiors can effectively encourage a manager's [12]_____ behavior when they fail to discipline the person's wrongdoings. Such workplaces are sometimes described as toxic. The second cause was attributed to the manager's [13]_____. Those [14]_____ to be most destructive were odd people, those without drive, those who allow personal problems into the workplace, and those with an unpleasant temperament or personality in general. The third cause of poor management was associated with a [15]_____ of qualifications, not so much the formal variety one obtains from a university, but the informal variety that comes from credible work experience and professional accomplishments. The fourth cause concerned managers who've been [16]_____ for reasons other than potential. One reason in particular why these people had been [17]_____ was that they had been around the longest. It wasn't their skill set or other merits that got them the job; it was their [18]_____. A point worth making is that the study was based only on the perspective of [19]_____. The researchers didn't ask senior leaders what they thought of their [20]_____ managers. It's quite possible they're content with how the individuals they promoted are now performing, [21]_____ ignorant of the damage they're actually causing, which might explain why, as the researchers conclude, those same middle managers are usually unaware that they are a bad manager.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

With the use of [1]_____ vehicles seemingly inevitable, mining companies in the vast Australian desert state of Western Australia are definitely taking the lead. Iron ore is a key [2]_____ in steel making. The

[3]_____ companies here produce almost 300 million tons of iron ore a year. The 240 giant [4]_____ trucks in use in the Western Australian mines can weigh 400 tons fully loaded, and travel at speeds of up to 60 kilometers per hour. They are a technological leap, transporting iron ore along routes which run for hundreds of kilometers from mines to their destinations, here when the truck arrives at its destination, staff in the operations center direct it precisely where to [5]_____. Vast quantities of iron ore are then transported by [6]_____ trains to ocean ports. Advocates argue these [7]_____ vehicles will change mining forever. It may only be five years before the use of automation technology leads to a fully [8]_____ mine. A range of factors has pushed Western Australia's desert region to the lead of this [9]_____ revolution. These include the huge size of the mines, the scale of equipment, and the [10]_____ nature of some of the work. Then there's the area's remoteness. At 502,000 square kilometers, it can sometimes make [11]_____ staff a challenge. Another consideration is the risks when humans interact with large [12]_____. There are also the financial imperatives. The ongoing push by the mining corporations to be more productive and more efficient is another powerful driver in embracing [13]_____ technology. The concept of a fully [14]_____ mine is a bit of a misleading term, however. This is because the more technology is put into the field, the more people are needed to deploy, maintain, and improve it, the automation and [15]_____ of the industry is creating a need for different jobs. These include data scientists and engineers in [16]_____ and artificial intelligence. The mining companies claim automation and [17]_____ present opportunities to make mining more sustainable and safer. Employees will be offered a career that is even more [18]_____ and more rewarding. Workers' unions have accepted the [19]_____ of the introduction of new technology, but they still have reservations about the rise of automation technology. Their main concern is the potential impact on [20]_____ communities. As automation spreads further, the question is how these remote communities will survive when the old jobs are eliminated, and this may well prove to be the most significant impact of [21]_____ technology in many places around the world.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

According to official [1]_____, Thailand's annual road death rate is almost double the global average. [2]_____ people know that their roads are dangerous, but they don't know this could easily be changed. Globally, road accidents kill more people every year than any [3]_____ disease. Researchers at the Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation in America put the death toll in 2017 at 1.24 million, according to the institute, the overall number of deaths has been more or less static since the turn of the century, but that [4]_____ a lot of changes in individual countries. In many poor countries, road accidents are killing more people than ever before, those countries have swelling young populations, a fast-growing fleet of cars and [5]_____, and a limited supply of surgeons. It is impossible to know for sure because official statistics are so [6]_____. But deaths are thought to have risen by 40% since 1990 in many low-income countries. In many rich countries, by contrast, roads are becoming even safer. In Estonia and Ireland, for example, the number of deaths has fallen by about two-thirds since the late 1990s. But the most important and [7]_____ changes are taking place in middle-income countries, which contain most of the world's people and have some of the most dangerous roads. According to [8]_____, in China and South Africa, traffic deaths have been falling since 2000, and in India since 2012, and the Philippines reached its peak four years ago. The question is whether Thailand can soon follow suit. Rob McKinney, head of the International Road [9]_____ Program, says that all countries tend to go through three phases. They begin with poor, slow roads. In the second phase, as they grow wealthier, they [10]_____ the roads, allowing traffic to move faster and pushing up the death rate. [11]_____, in the third phase, countries act to make their roads safer. The trick then is to reach the third stage sooner by focusing earlier and more closely on [12]_____ accidents. How to do that? The solution lies not just in better infrastructure, but in better social [13]_____. Safe driving [14]_____ are practices which people know they should follow but often don't. Dangerous driving is not a fixed cultural [15]_____, as some imagine. People respond to incentives such as traffic laws that are actually [16]_____.

2020年12月 第2套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

This is unbelievable. Unlike any video game I've ever played before, it's so boring yet so [1]_____ at the same time. How did you hear about this driving [2]_____? My brother [3]_____ it to me last year. I was surprised to find how educational and [4]_____ it was. It's called Euro Truck [5]_____, but they have other versions as well for America and so on. I was really drawn to the scenery. The routes go through parts of the country you don't normally see as a [6]_____. Yeah, I can see that. It seems so simple, just transporting [7]_____ from point A to point B, driving from one city to another, but I really appreciate all the details that go into the game. It's even given me a new appreciation for the [8]_____ industry and traffic on the road. I completely agree. My brother also [9]_____ me to some videos of someone that streams their game online. It was fascinating to watch. Really, this guy drove very carefully, [10]_____ all the road signs and traffic rules. Such a contrast to most violent games. Honestly, playing has [11]_____ me to look into the industry more. I've read articles about how self-driving trucks may soon be available and could greatly impact cargo [12]_____. [13]_____ all that goes into driving these larger vehicles, it's amazing that we could soon have that kind of technology. Ha? I've gone one step further. I registered to take a safe driving course to improve my real-life driving [14]_____. In a way, I feel like I have a head start compared to other students in the class. Playing this video game has given me some [15]_____ practice already. I'm not sure how accurate the video game is compared to real-life situations, but if it results in more drivers looking both ways before entering an [16]_____, I'd say that's a positive outcome.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

[1]_____ two: How do you like being self-employed? There are obvious benefits, though I don't seem to have the freedom I [2]_____, as I just don't seem able to decline work offers. And working alone, there have been times when I've found that money alone provides [3]_____ motivation. Have you experienced the same since you began working for yourself? Sometimes, yes. Unlike the rest of the workforce

who have managers to [4]_____ motivation whenever they're feeling lazy or bored, we self-employed workers perform our jobs without a manager to lift our spirits. There's no one around to offer praise or [5]_____ collaboration, no one to make greater use of our interests and talents. That's a fact. Not every manager behaves with such awareness and care, of course, and certainly not all managers have a clue how to [6]_____ people. Still, having a manager nearby at least [7]_____ there's an opportunity. They'll be decent enough to look out for you when your energy and focus begin to [8]_____. The motivator I value most is autonomy. I've learned not to sacrifice my [9]_____ autonomy by working all hours of the day and by saying yes to every client request. Yes, I need to remind myself that I selected this [10]_____ for the independence. I don't miss aspects of permanent full-time employment I disliked, such as the office politics, job insecurity, [11]_____ hours, and so on. I wouldn't mind a bit more in the form of [12]_____, though, praise which is on the record. That'll come with time. [13]_____ is inevitably cultivated via human interaction, engaging with clients, getting written testimony and recommendations, staying in contact with clients afterwards. These are things you'll find will come in due course and provide you with [14]_____. You're right. That's an area I do need to put some more effort into, building closer relationships with those who [15]_____ my services and skills.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

[1]_____ one: Weather is a constant force in our lives, but there's little marketing research on how it affects businesses. Now, a new study [2]_____ how sunny and snowy conditions influence consumer behavior. Those weather conditions trigger consumers to mentally [3]_____ using products associated with the respective weather. This leads to [4]_____ placing a higher value on those products. That is, they're [5]_____ to pay more money for them. But the [6]_____ is only found with products related to being outside. How does this work? [7]_____ give the example of a beach towel. On a sunny day, [8]_____ who see that product are not just looking at the towel itself; they are likely imagining themselves lying on the towel in the sun. This mental picture of using the towel increases the value of the product in the consumer's mind. Researchers put forward the following [9]_____ to explain their findings. They think the mental picture works in [10]_____ and snow because these weather conditions have a positive

association with outside activities. The effect is not seen with rainy weather. Researchers [11]_____ this is because there aren't many activities that are enabled by rain. Most products associated with rain, like [12]_____, are only used for protection from the weather and not for any activities, researchers believe that companies that sell a wide array of products online can benefit most from the insights this study provides. Online [13]_____ often use complex mathematical formulas to determine what products to feature and how to price those products. [14]_____ more data about weather would allow them to make better decisions. This could bolster sales.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Setting the office air conditioning at about 22 degrees [1]_____ has become standard practice across the world. Numerous [2]_____ across the world on heating, ventilation, and air conditioning claim office performance peaks at 22 degrees. Many people indeed find relief from [3]_____ summer temperatures in air-conditioned offices, but recent studies have challenged the accepted wisdom that a cool office is more productive. The reality is more complex. [4]_____ conducted a review of all studies relating to air conditioning and productivity. They found that 22 degrees was probably a little [5]_____, even at the height of summer. For a person dressed in typical summer clothing, an optimal range would be between 23 and 26 degrees, and people can even [6]_____ temperatures beyond this comfort zone as long as they can adjust their clothing and expectations. In fact, even on very hot days, it makes sense to turn the air conditioning up. People often chase just one [7]_____ temperature, and this is understandable when people feel hot, but there is a range of at least three to four degrees which does not have any adverse impact. Another issue related to this is that people can become [8]_____ dependent on air conditioning. If they are used to the environment which is air-conditioned, they tend to [9]_____ lower temperatures. But the studies found that almost all humans became accustomed to the new temperature. It was only at the extreme ends of the temperature range where people's [10]_____ suffered. This range was above 26 degrees and below 19 degrees.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Psychology research has tended to portray [1]_____ as a negative experience, studies conducted in the 1970s and 1990s suggested that people felt less happy when alone as compared to being with others. However, a new paper shows an alternative view of [2]_____, one in which solitude can be positive. Let's start by looking at the earlier research. It had a couple of shortcomings. First, it measured emotion on a scale from positive to negative, overlooking the possibility that our positive and negative emotions can [3]_____ independently. Also, it [4]_____ emotions as simply positive or negative. It didn't consider that emotions [5]_____ us to different degrees, and that both positive and negative emotions can arouse us a lot or a little. That is, whether positive or negative, emotions can be either high [6]_____ or low arousal. High [7]_____ emotions include excitement on the positive side, or anger on the negative side, while low arousal ones include feeling calm on the positive side or lonely on the negative. This new research attempted to overcome these [8]_____. Researchers began with a simple study. They asked participants to spend 15 minutes sitting alone without engaging in any activity, and measured how this [9]_____ influenced their emotional state. This experiment specifically aimed to determine the effect of solitude on high [10]_____ emotions. It looked at positive emotions such as being excited or interested, and negative emotions including being scared or [11]_____, the results were clear. After 15 minutes of [12]_____, the participants showed reductions in both types of emotion. A second study measured the effects of solitude on low [13]_____ emotions. These included both positive and negative emotions, such as feeling calm, [14]_____, sad, or lonely. That [15]_____ found that all of these emotions were increased by time alone. Thus, it seems past depictions of [16]_____ were wrong. It doesn't have a simple emotional effect that can be [17]_____ as good or bad. Rather, it changes the intensity of our inner experience, it [18]_____ quieter emotions, but it diminishes the intensity of stronger feelings. It's worth clarifying that these findings relate to relatively brief periods of [19]_____. This is distinct from prolonged loneliness. Research has [20]_____ that the latter is correlated with an assortment of negative physical and psychological effects, how can people benefit from being alone? The findings here suggest that people can use

[21] _____ to regulate their emotions. [22] _____ can help us become quiet after excitement, calm after an angry episode, or simply feel at peace.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Recording two, in 1984, the World Chess Championships was called off abruptly due to the [1] _____ frame of a player who was competing for the title. He wasn't alone in experiencing the [2] _____ physical effects of the game. Elite players can reportedly burn up to an absurd 6000 [3] _____ in one day. Does that mean that thinking harder is a simple [4] _____ to losing weight? Well, when the body is at rest, we know that the brain uses up a [5] _____ 20 to 25% of the body's overall energy. This level of [6] _____ actually makes the brain the most energy-expensive organ in the body, and yet it makes up only 2% of the body's weight overall. So, the more we put this organ to work, the more [7] _____ we'll burn. Technically, the answer is yes, for [8] _____ difficult tasks. What counts as a difficult mental task varies between individuals, but generally it could be described as something that the brain cannot solve easily using previously learned routines or tasks that change the conditions [9] _____. However, deep thinking will not burn off the calories gained from eating a [10] _____ snack, because in relation to the brain's huge overall energy usage, which is devoted to a multitude of tasks, the energy required just to think harder is actually comparatively tiny. We're unconscious of most of what uses up the brain's energy. A lot of that activity is [11] _____ to conscious activities like learning how to sing or play the guitar. The brain is able to [12] _____ blood and thus energy to particular regions that are being active at that point, but the overall energy availability in the brain is thought to be constant, so while there might be significant increases in energy use at localized regions of the brain when we perform difficult cognitive tasks, when it comes to the whole brain's energy budget overall, these activities don't significantly alter it. So why did the chess champion grow too [13] _____ to compete in his chess competition. The general consensus is that it mostly comes down to stress and reduced food consumption, not mental [14] _____. Keeping your body pumped up for action for long periods of time is very energy [15] _____. If you can't eat as often or as much as you can, or would [16] _____, then you might lose weight.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Tell me about yourself may seem like an easy job interview question, but the open-ended nature of this question often leaves job seekers at a loss where to start. This common question is actually a critical test of a job candidate's communication skills, so it's important not to give an [1]_____ response or mess it up. Tell me about yourself is often the first question professional career coaches prepare people for when they give interview [2]_____. It's the opportunity for the candidate to take control of the narrative and tell their story in a way that really matters to their audience, it takes hard work and extensive [3]_____ to answer this question well. When a person goes to a job interview, their [4]_____ has presumably read their resume, so they don't need to repeat the information. But that's what most people will do, as it's their instinct to [5]_____ things that are already on their resume. It's important for job seekers to do their homework on two [6]_____ aspects. First, they are not just telling someone a fact about themselves; they're telling a story, and stories take work to create. Coming up with a good story means getting [7]_____ about what made their career accomplishments something they're proud of and what strengths those accomplishments highlight. Candidates shouldn't pick a [8]_____, general strength to elaborate on, such as "I'm smart," "I work hard, and I get things done." To come up with multiple career accomplishments or examples for different interview questions, job seekers should talk with others, especially people who know them, partners, friends, or [9]_____ who will bring up different stories than the ones they remember. [10]_____, candidates should know what's at stake for the company with this job opening, what they really are asking you is, tell me why you are going to help me. If the person is a prepared [11]_____, they should have already figured out those things. They've read the job description and researched the company on the internet. What job [12]_____ ought to be looking for is what the company is up to, what they are trying to accomplish, and what is preventing them from accomplishing those things. How long should it take to answer? Around a minute. That's about right for most people's attention spans. Under a minute could seem rushed, while over two minutes will start to feel more like a speech, but the length of the answer is not an exact science, and candidates need to keep their career story focused and [13]_____ to their audience.

2020年12月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Good morning, Safe House Insurance. My name is Paul. How can I help you today? Morning. I wouldn't say that is good from where I am standing. This is Miss Wilson, and this is the third time I've called this week since receiving your letter about our insurance claim. I'm getting a little fed up with my calls about my claim being completely [1]_____. Miss Wilson, thank you for calling back. Can I take some [2]_____ to help me look at your claim? It's Miss May Wilson of 15 South Sea Road in Cornwall, and the details are that our village was [3]_____ flooded two months ago. The entire ground floor of our cottage was [4]_____ in water, and five of us have been living in a caravan ever since. You people are still [5]_____ the money we are entitled to over a bizarre technical detail, and it's not acceptable, Paul. Miss Wilson, according to the notes on your account, the [6]_____ technical detail that you mentioned refers to the fact that you hadn't paid house insurance the month before the incident. That money left our account, and now that you should be paying out, you are [7]_____ saying that you didn't receive it on time. I'm really skeptical about this claim. The contract does say that any missed payment in a year will [8]_____ the terms and conditions of the insurance contract and may affect claims. Of course, I can pass you on to my manager to talk to you more about this. I've already spoken to him, and you can tell him I'm [9]_____ now, and that your company has a lawsuit on its hands, you will be hearing from my lawyer. Goodbye.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

How do you feel about the future of artificial intelligence? Personally, I feel quite optimistic about it. AI, I'm not so optimistic actually. In fact, it's something we should be concerned about. Well, it will help us humans understand ourselves better, and when we have a better understanding of ourselves, we can [1]_____ the world. Well, one thing is for sure: technology is [2]_____ faster than our ability to understand it, and in the future, AI will make jobs kind of pointless. I think artificial intelligence will actually help create new kinds of jobs, which would require less of our time and allow us to be centered on [3]_____ tasks. I doubt that very

much. Probably the last job that will remain will be writing AI [4]_____, and then eventually, AI will just write its own software. At that time, we are going to have a lot of jobs which nobody will want to do. So we'll need artificial intelligence for the [5]_____ to take care of the old guys like us. I don't know. There's a risk that human [6]_____ could be replaced by a superior type of digital life. AI will be able to completely [7]_____ a person in every way possible. In fact, some people think we're in a [8]_____ right now. That's impossible. Humans can't even make a mosquito. Computers only have chips. People have brains, and that's where the [9]_____ comes from. Once it's fully developed, AI will become tired of trying to communicate with humans, as we would be much slower [10]_____ in comparison. I'm not so sure. A computer is a computer, and a computer is just a toy. Computers can easily communicate incredibly fast, so the computer will just get [11]_____ talking to humans. It'll be barely getting any information out. Well, I believe there's a [12]_____ future with AI. I also think you watch too many science fiction films.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: To achieve financial security, how much you save is always more important than the amount you earn or how [1]_____ you invest. If you are under 30 years old, your goal should be to save 20% of your monthly income after tax [2]_____. This is irrespective of how much you [3]_____. Approximately 50% should be reserved for essentials like food and [4]_____. The remaining 30% is for [5]_____ and entertainment. But for many young people, it'll be difficult to [6]_____ such a large proportion of their income for savings. If you find it hard to save any money at all, start by cutting all unnecessary spending, [7]_____ a tiny amount of one or 2% for savings, and gradually increase that amount. Always keep that 20% goal in mind to prevent yourself from becoming [8]_____. It can be challenging to stick to such a strict plan, but if you adopt the right [9]_____, you should be able to make it work for you. So, what should you be doing with the money that you are saving? Some must be kept easily [10]_____ in case you need some cash in an emergency. The largest proportion should be invested in retirement plans, either through your employer or privately, and you can keep some money for high-risk, but potentially [11]_____ investments. Dividends can be [12]_____ or used to purchase something you like. By following this plan, you should hopefully be able to enjoy your life now and still be [13]_____ secure in the future.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

I work in advertising, and I like to keep up with current [1]_____, mainly because I'm aware that we live in an image-obsessed world. However, when I first started my job, [2]_____ I'd catch a glimpse of myself in the lifts and find myself thinking that I looked a total mess. Was I being held back by my choice of [3]_____? The short answer is yes, especially when [4]_____ are quick to judge you on your style rather than your work. But no one can be unique with their [5]_____ every day. I mean, that's why uniforms were invented. So here's what I did: I created my own [6]_____. To do this, I chose an appropriate [7]_____. Then I bought multiple items of the same style in different [8]_____. Now I never worry about what I'm wearing in the morning, even if I do get a bit tired of just wearing the same [9]_____ pieces. Overall, when it comes to work, you have to ask yourself: Would looking smarter [10]_____ my ability to do my job? For some, this question may not be an issue at all, especially if you work [11]_____ and rarely see your colleagues or clients face to face. But if your job involves [12]_____ with other people, the answer to this is often yes. So rather than fighting the system, I think we should just do whatever helps us to [13]_____ our goals at work. If that means playing it safe with your image, then let's face it, it's probably worth it.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Did you know that Americans have [1]_____ three times the amount of space we had 50 years ago? Therefore, you'd think we'd have [2]_____ room for all of our possessions. On the contrary, the personal [3]_____ business is now a growing industry. We've got triple the space, but we've become such [4]_____ consumers that we require even more. This phenomenon has resulted in significant credit card debt, enormous environmental footprints, and perhaps not [5]_____, our happiness levels have failed to increase over the same half century. I'm here to suggest an alternative: that having less might actually be a [6]_____ decision. Many of us have experienced at some stage the pleasure of [7]_____ less. I propose that less stuff and less space can not only help you [8]_____ but also simplify your life. I recently started an [9]_____ project to discover some creative solutions that offered

me everything I required. By purchasing an [10]_____ that was 40 square meters instead of 60, I immediately saved $200,000. Smaller space leads to reduced utility bills and also a smaller carbon [11]_____, because it's designed around an edited collection of possessions limited to my favorite stuff. I'm really excited to live there. How can we live more basically? Firstly, we must [12]_____ cut the unnecessary objects out of our lives. To [13]_____ consumption, we should think before we buy and ask ourselves: Will it truly make me happier? Obviously, we should possess some great stuff, but we want [14]_____ that we're going to love for years. Secondly, we require space efficiency. We want [15]_____ that are designed for use most of the time, not for occasional use. Why own a six-burner stove when you rarely use even three [16]_____? Finally, we need multifunctional spaces and housewares. I combined a [17]_____ wall with transforming furniture to get more out of my limited space. Consider my coffee table; it increases in size to [18]_____ 10. My office is tucked away, easily hidden. My bed simply pops out of the wall. For guests, I can relocate the movable wall and utilize the [19]_____ guest beds I installed. I'm not saying we should all live in tiny apartments, but consider the benefits of an [20]_____ life. When you return home and walk through your front door, take a moment to ask yourselves: Could I do with a little life [21]_____? Would that give me more freedom and more time.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Now, believe it or not, people sometimes lie in order to maintain a good, honest [1]_____, even if it hurts them to do so. At least this is what a team of scientists is [2]_____, with evidence to prove it. Picture this scenario: You often drive for work and can be [3]_____ for up to 400 miles per month. Most people at your company drive about 300 [4]_____ each month, but this month you drove 400 miles. How many miles do you think you'd claim in your expense report? The scientists asked this exact question as part of the study we're discussing today, with [5]_____ results. They found that 12 percent of [6]_____ reported the distance they drove as less than the actual figure, giving an average answer of 384 miles. In other words, they lied about the number of miles, even though they would [7]_____ money they were owed. The [8]_____ believe this was to seem honest, with the assumption being that others would be suspicious of a high expense claim. But why would people [9]_____ numbers to their own

detriment? The [10]_____ explain that many people care a great deal about their reputation and how they'll be judged by others. If they care enough, their concern about appearing honest and not losing the respect of others may be greater than their [11]_____ to actually be honest. The researchers [12]_____ that the findings suggest that when people obtain very favorable outcomes, they anticipate other people's suspicious reactions and prefer lying and appearing honest to telling the truth and appearing as selfish liars. So why is this research important? Well, experts generally agree there are two main types of lie: selfish lies and lies that are meant to benefit others, the first, as you may predict, is for selfish gain, such as submitting a fraudulent claim to an insurance company, while the second involves lying to help others or not [13]_____ others. For example, telling a friend whose [14]_____ you don't like that they look great. But the [15]_____ are suggesting a third type of lying, lying to maintain a good reputation. Now, this hypothesis is new, and some [16]_____ argue that this isn't a whole new category of lie. But the findings seem intuitive to me. After all, one of the main [17]_____ for lying is to increase our worth in the eyes of others. So it seems highly likely that people will lie to seem [18]_____.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Why do old people dislike new music? As I've grown older, I often hear people my age say things like they just don't make good music like they used to. Why does this happen? [1]_____, psychology can give us some insights into this puzzle. Musical tastes begin to [2]_____ as early as age 13 or 14, and by the time we're in our early 20s, these tastes get locked into place pretty firmly. In fact, studies have found that by the time we turn 33, most of us have stopped listening to new music. [3]_____, popular songs released when you're in your early teens are likely to remain quite popular among your age group for the rest of your life. There could be a biological explanation for this, as there's evidence that the brain's ability to make subtle distinctions between different chords, rhythms, and melodies [4]_____ with age. So, to older people, newer, less familiar songs might all sound the same, but there may be some simpler reasons for older people's [5]_____ to newer music. One of the most researched laws of social psychology is something called the mere exposure effect, which in essence means that the more we're exposed to something, the more we tend to like it. This happens with people we know, the [6]_____ we see, and the songs we listen to. When you're in

your early teens, you probably spend a fair amount of time listening to music or watching music videos, your favorite songs and artists become familiar, [7]_____ parts of your routine. For many people over 30, job and family [8]_____ increase, so there's less time to spend discovering new music. Instead, many will simply listen to old [9]_____ favorites from that period of their lives when they had more free time. Of course, those teen years weren't necessarily [10]_____; they're famously confusing, which is why so many TV shows and movies revolve around high school turmoil. Psychology research has shown that the emotions that we experience as teens seem more intense than those that come later, and we also know that intense emotions are associated with stronger memories and [11]_____. Both of these might explain why the songs we listen to during this period become so [12]_____ and beloved. So there's nothing wrong with your parents because they don't like your music. Rather, it's all part of the natural order of things.

2020年9月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Conversation one: You are a professor of [1]_____ at the University of Oxford. You're a senior [2]_____ at the European Organization for Nuclear Research. You also seem to tour the globe [3]_____, giving talks, and in addition, you have your own weekly TV show on science. Where do you get the energy? Oh well, I just love what I do. I'm extremely [4]_____ to have this life doing what I love doing, Professor. What exactly is your goal? Why do you do all of this? Well, as you said, I do have different things going on, but these I think can be divided into two groups: the education of science and the further understanding of science. Don't these two things get in the way of each other? What I mean is, doesn't giving [5]_____ take time away from the lab? Not really. No, I love teaching, and I don't mind spending more time doing that now than in the past. Also, what I will say is that teaching a subject helps me [6]_____ it better myself. I find that it furthers my own knowledge when I have to explain something clearly, when I have to aid others in understanding it, and when I have to answer questions about it. Teaching at a high level can be very stimulating for anyone, no matter how much expertise they may already have in the field they are [7]_____. Are there any scientific [8]_____ that you see on the near horizon? A significant discovery or [9]_____ we can expect soon. The world is always conducting science, and there are constantly new things being [10]_____. In fact, right now we have too much data sitting in computers. For example, we have thousands of photos of planet Mars taken by [11]_____ that nobody has ever seen. We have them, yet nobody has had time to look at them with their own eyes, let alone [12]_____ them.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Do you think dreams have special meanings? No, I don't think they do. I don't either, but some people do. I would say people who believe that dreams have special meanings are [1]_____, especially nowadays. In the past, during the times of ancient Egypt, Greece, or China, people used to believe that dreams could [2]_____ the future. But today, with all the [3]_____ knowledge that we have, I think it's much

harder to believe in these sorts of things. My grandmother is [4]_____, and she thinks dreams can predict the future. Once she dreamed that the flight she was due to take the following day [5]_____. Can you guess what she did? She didn't take that flight. She didn't even [6]_____ to go to the airport the following day. Instead, she took the same flight, but a week later, and everything was fine. Of course, no plane ever crashed. How funny! Did you know that flying is actually safer than any other [7]_____ of transport? It's been statistically proven. People can be so irrational sometimes. Yes, absolutely. But even if we think they are ridiculous, emotions can be just as powerful as [8]_____ thinking. Exactly. People do all sorts of crazy things because of their [9]_____ feelings. But in fact, some [10]_____ believe that our dreams are the result of our emotions and memories from that day. I think it was Sigmund Freud who said that children's dreams were usually simple [11]_____ of their wishes, things they wished would happen. But in adults, dreams are much more complicated reflections of their more sophisticated [12]_____. Isn't it interesting how [13]_____ try to understand using the scientific method something as bizarre as dreams? Psychology is like the rational study of [14]_____ feelings.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: While some scientists explore the surface of Antarctica, others are learning more about a giant body of water four [1]_____ beneath the ice pack. Scientists first discovered Lake Vostok in the 1970s by using radio waves that [2]_____ the ice. Since then, they have used sound waves and even [3]_____ to map this massive body of water. How does the water in Lake Vostok remain liquid [4]_____ an ice sheet? The thick glacier above acts like an [5]_____ blanket and keeps the water from freezing, says Martin Siegert, a glaciologist from the University of Wales. In addition, [6]_____ heat from deep within the Earth may warm the hidden lake. The scientists suspect that [7]_____ may be living in Lake Vostok, closed off from the outside world for more than 2 million years. Anything found there will be totally [8]_____ to what's on the surface of the Earth, says Siegert. Scientists are trying to find a way to drill into the ice and draw water samples without causing [9]_____. Again, robots might be the solution. If all goes as planned, a drill-shaped robot will [10]_____ through the surface ice. When it reaches the lake, it will release another [11]_____ that can swim in the lake, take pictures, and look for signs of life. The

scientists hope their discoveries will shed light on life in outer space, which might exist in similar dark and [12] _____ conditions. Recently, close-up pictures of Jupiter's moon Europa showed signs of water [13] _____ its icy surface. Once tested in Antarctica, robots could be sent to Europa to search for life there too.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

The idea to study the American Indian [1] _____ Tarahumaras came to James Copeland in 1984 when he discovered that very little research had been done on their language. He contacted a tribe member through a social worker, who worked with the [2] _____ in Mexico. At first, the tribe member named Gonzalez was very reluctant to [3] _____. He told Copeland that no amount of money could buy his language, but after Copeland explained to him what he [4] _____ to do with his research and how it would benefit the Tarahumaras, Gonzalez agreed to help. He took Copeland to his village and served as an [5] _____. Copeland says, thanks to him, the Tarahumaras understood what our mission was and started trusting us. Entering the world of the Tarahumaras has been a [6] _____ project for Copeland. To reach their [7] _____, he must drive two and a half days from Houston, Texas. He loads up his vehicle with goods that the [8] _____ can't easily get and gives the goods to them as a gesture of friendship. The Tarahumaras, who don't believe in [9] _____ wealth, take the food and share it among themselves. For Copeland, the experience has not only been [10] _____ satisfying, but also has enriched his life in several ways. I see people [11] _____ technology and living a very hard traditional life, which offers me another notion about the meaning of progress in the Western tradition. He says, "I experience the [12] _____ of living in nature that I would otherwise only be able to read about. I see a lot of beauty in their sense of sharing and [13] _____ for each other.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

What is a radical? It seems today that people are terrified of the term, particularly of having the label attached to them, [1] _____ individuals or groups of being radical often serves to silence them into submission, thereby maintaining the existing state of affairs and, more important, preserving the power of a select minority who are

mostly wealthy white males in Western society, feminism is a perfect example of this phenomenon. The women's movement has been plagued by stereotypes, misrepresentations by the media, and accusations of man-hating and [2]_____. When the basic foundation of feminism is simply that women deserve equal rights in all [3]_____ of life. When faced with the threat of being labeled radical, women back down from their worthy cause and consequently participate in their own [4]_____. It has gotten to the point that many women are afraid to call themselves feminists because of the stigma attached to the word, if people refuse to be controlled and [5]_____ by stigmas, the stigmas lose all their power. Without fear on which to feed, such [6]_____ can only die. To me, a radical is simply someone who rebels against the [7]_____ or advocates a change in the existing state of affairs. On closer inspection, it becomes clear that the norm is constantly [8]_____ and therefore is not a constant entity. So why then is [9]_____ from the present situation such a threat when the state of affairs itself is unstable and subject to relentless transformation. It all goes back to [10]_____ the power of those who have it and preventing the rise of those who don't. In fact, when we look at the word [11]_____ in a historical context, nearly every figure we now hold up as a hero was considered a radical in his or her time. Radicals are people who effect change. They are the people about whom history is written. Abolitionists were radicals. Civil rights activists were radicals. Even the founders of our country, in their fight to win independence from England were [12]_____. Their presence in history has changed the way our society functions, mainly by [13]_____ the balance of power that previously existed. Of course, there are some radicals who have made a negative impact on humanity, but [14]_____ there would simply be no progress without radicals. That being said, next time someone calls me a [15]_____, I will accept that label with pride.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

We are very [1]_____ to the influence of the people around us. For instance, you may have known somebody who has gone overseas for a year or so, and has returned with an [2]_____. Perhaps we become part of our [3]_____ environment. None of us are immune to the influences of our own world, and let us not kid ourselves that we are [4]_____ by the things and the people in our life. Fred goes off to his new job at a [5]_____, Fred takes his 10-minute coffee break, but the other workers take a half an hour. Fred says,

"What's the matter with you guys?" Two weeks later, Fred is taking 20-minute breaks. A month later, Fred takes his half hour. Fred is saying, "If you can't beat them, join them." Why should I work any harder than the next guy? The fascinating thing about being human is that generally we are unaware that there are changes taking place in our [6]_____. It is like returning to the city [7]_____ after some weeks in the fresh air. Only then do we realize that we have become accustomed to the nasty smells, mix with critical people and we learn to [8]_____, mix with happy people and we learn about happiness. What this means is that we need to decide what we want from life and then choose our company [9]_____. You may well say that is going to take some effort. It may not be comfortable. I may [10]_____ some of my present company, right? But it is your life. Fred may say, "I'm always broke, frequently [11]_____. I'm going nowhere, and I never do anything [12]_____." Then we discover that Fred's best friends are always broke, frequently [13]_____, going nowhere, and wishing that life was more exciting. This is not [14]_____, nor is it our business to stand in judgment of Fred. However, if Fred ever wants to improve his quality of life, the first thing he'll need to do is recognize what has been going on all these years, it's no surprise that doctors, as a [15]_____, suffer a lot of ill health because they spend their lives around sick people. Psychiatrists have a higher [16]_____ of suicide in their profession for related reasons. [17]_____, nine out of 10 children whose parents smoke smoke themselves. Obesity is in part an environmental problem. Successful people have successful friends, and so the story goes on.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Virtually every American can recognize a dollar bill at a mere [1]_____. Many can identify it by its sound or [2]_____, but few people indeed can accurately describe the world's most powerful, important currency. The American dollar bill is colored with black ink on one side and green on the other. The exact [3]_____ of the paper and ink is a closely guarded government secret. Despite its [4]_____ importance, the dollar bill actually weighs little. It requires nearly 500 bills to tip the scales at a [5]_____. Not only is the dollar bill lightweight, but it also has a brief [6]_____. Few dollar bills [7]_____ longer than 18 months. The word dollar is taken from the German word [8]_____, the name for the world's most important currency in the 16th century. The [9]_____ was a silver coin first minted in 1518 under the reign

of Charles V, Emperor of Germany, the concept of paper money is a relatively recent innovation in the history of American currency. When the Constitution was signed, people had little regard for paper money because of its [10]_____ decreasing value during the colonial era. Because of this lack of faith, the new American government [11]_____ only coins for common currency. Interest-bearing [12]_____ were issued at the same time, but their purpose was limited to providing money for urgent government crises, such as American involvement in the War of 1812. The first non-interest-bearing paper currency was [13]_____ by Congress in 1862, at the height of the Civil War. At this point, citizens' old fears of [14]_____ paper currency had calmed, and the dollar bill was born. The new green-colored paper money quickly earned the nickname "[15]_____." Today, the American dollar bill is a product of the Federal Reserve and is issued from the 12 Federal Reserve banks around the United States. The government keeps a steady supply of approximately 2 billion bills in [16]_____ at all times. Controversy continues to [17]_____ the true value of the dollar bill, American history has seen generations of politicians argue in favor of a gold standard for American currency. However, for the present, the American dollar bill holds the value that is [18]_____ on it and little more. The only other guarantee on the bill is a Federal Reserve [19]_____ as a confirmation in the form of government securities.

2019年12月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Excuse me, where's your rock music section? Rock music. I'm sorry, we're a jazz store. We don't have any rock and roll. Oh, you only have [1]_____ music, nothing else. That's right. We're the only record store in London dedicated [2]_____ to jazz. Actually, we're more than just a record store. We have a cafe and library [3]_____, and a ticket office down the hall where you can buy tickets to all the major jazz concerts in the city. Also, we have our own [4]_____ next door where we produce albums for up-and-coming artists. We are committed to [5]_____ new music talent. Wow, that's so cool! I guess there's not much of a jazz scene anymore, not like there used to be. But here, you're trying to promote this great music [6]_____. Yes, indeed. [7]_____, most people like to listen to pop and rock music, hip hop music from America is also getting more and more popular. So as a result, there are fewer [8]_____ of jazz, which is a great shame, because it's an incredibly rich genre. But that's not to say there isn't any good new jazz music being made out there anymore? Far from it. It's just a much smaller market today. So, how would you define jazz? Well, [9]_____ enough, there's no agreed-upon definition of jazz. [10]_____, there are many different styles of jazz. Some have singing, but most don't. Some are electric and some aren't. Some contain live experimentation, but not always. While there's no simple [11]_____ for it, and while there are many different styles of jazz, you simply know it when you hear it. [12]_____, the only way to know what jazz is is listen to it yourself. As the great [13]_____ player Louis Armstrong said, "If you gotta ask, you'll never know."

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

How did it go at the bank this morning? Not well. My proposal was rejected. Really? But why? Bunch of reasons. For starters, they said my credit history was not good enough. Did they say how you could [1]_____ that? Yes, they said that after five more years of paying my mortgage, then I would become a more [2]_____ candidate for a business loan. But right now, it's too risky for them to [3]_____ me money. They fear I will

default on any business loan I'm given, well, that doesn't sound fair. Your business idea is amazing. Did you show them your business plan? What did they say? They didn't really [4]_____ any position regarding the actual business plan. They simply looked at my credit history and [5]_____ it was not good enough. They said the bank has strict [6]_____ and requirements as to who they can lend money to, and I simply don't meet their financial threshold. What if you asked for a smaller amount? Maybe you could gather capital from other sources, smaller loans from more [7]_____. You don't get it. It doesn't matter the size of the loan I ask for, or the type of business I [8]_____. That's all inconsequential. The first thing every bank will do is study how much money I have and how much debt I have before they decide whether or not to [9]_____ me any more money. If I want to continue ahead with this dream of owning my own business, I have no other choice but to build up my own [10]_____. I need around 20% more in personal [11]_____ and 50% less debt. That's all there is to it. I see now. Well, it's a huge [12]_____ that they rejected your request, but don't lose hope. I still think that your idea is great, and that you would turn it into a [13]_____ success.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

There's a lot about Leo Sanchez and his farm in Salinas, California, that seems [1]_____. The national average farm size is around 440 [2]_____, but his is only one acre. The average age of farmers [3]_____ around 58 years old, but he is just 26, and Sanchez constantly attempts to improve everything, from seeding techniques out in the field to the promotion and sale of his produce online. This is evidence of an experimental approach. It's an approach not dictated by the [4]_____ of conventional large-scale agriculture led by international corporations, while farming is often difficult for both the body and mind, Sanchez says he and many of his fellow young farmers are motivated by desire to set a new standard for agriculture. Many of them are [5]_____ a multitude of technologies, some new and some not so new. Recently, Sanchez bought a hand-operated tool which pulls out weeds and [6]_____ soil. It actually dates back to at least 1701. It stands in sharp contrast to Sanchez's other [7]_____, a gas-powered flame weed killer invented in 1997. He simply doesn't [8]_____ when it comes to the newness of tools. If it works, it works. Farmers have a long history of [9]_____, and it's no different today. Young farmers are guided by their love for [10]_____, and aided by their knowledge of technology. To find inexpensive and appropriately sized

tools, they collaborate and [11]_____. Sometimes the old stuff just works better, or more [12]_____.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Passage two: Eat Grub is Britain's first new food company that breaks Western food boundaries by introducing edible insects as a new source of food, and Sainsbury's is the first UK supermarket to stock the company's [1]_____ roasted crickets. Sainsbury's [2]_____ that such food is no joke, and could be a new sustainable source of protein. Out of curiosity, I paid a visit to Sainsbury's. As I put my hand into a [3]_____ of crickets with their tiny eyes and legs, the idea of one going in my mouth made me feel a little sick. But the first bite was a [4]_____ surprise, a little dry and lacking of taste, but at least a wing didn't get stuck in my throat. The roasted seasoning largely overpowered any other flavour, although there was a slightly bitter [5]_____. The texture was crunchy, but [6]_____ a little of cat food. Eat Grub also recommends the crickets as a topping for [7]_____, soups, and salads. The company [8]_____ that its dried crickets contain more protein than beef, chicken, and pork, as well as minerals like iron and calcium. Unlike the production of meat, bugs do not use up large amounts of land, water, or feed, and [9]_____ farming also produces far fewer greenhouse gases. However, despite 2 billion people worldwide already supplementing their diet with insects, consumer [10]_____ remains a large barrier in many Western countries. I'm not sure bugs will become a popular [11]_____ any time soon, but they're definitely food for thought.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Have you ever had someone try to explain something to you a dozen times with no luck, but then when you see a picture, the idea finally clicks. If that sounds familiar, maybe you might consider yourself a visual [1]_____, or if reading or listening does a trick? Maybe you feel like you're a verbal [2]_____. We call these labels learning styles. But is there really a way to [3]_____ different types of students? Well, it actually seems that multiple [4]_____ formats, especially if one of them is visual, help most people learn. When psychologists and [5]_____ test for learning styles, they're trying to figure out whether these are inherent traits that affect how well students learn, instead of just a preference. Usually, they start by giving a survey to

figure out what style a student favors, like visual or [6]_____ learning. Then they try to teach the students something with a specific [7]_____ style, like using visual aids, and do a follow-up test to see how much they learned. That way, the researchers can see if the self-identified verbal [8]_____ really learned better when the information was just spoken aloud, for example. But according to a 2008 review, only one study that followed this design found that students actually learned best with their preferred style, but the study had some big [9]_____. The researchers excluded two-thirds of the original participants because they didn't seem to have any clear learning style from the survey at the beginning, and they didn't even report the actual test scores in the final paper, so it doesn't really seem like learning styles are an inherent trait that we all have, but that doesn't mean that all students will do [10]_____ if they just spend all their time reading from a textbook. Instead, most people seem to learn better if they're taught in several ways, especially if one is [11]_____. In one study, [12]_____ tested whether students remembered lists of words better if they heard them, saw them, or both. And everyone seemed to do better if they got to see the words in print, even the self-identified [13]_____ learners, their preference didn't seem to matter. Similar studies tested whether students learned basic physics and [14]_____ concepts better by reading plain text or viewing pictures too, and everyone did better with the help of pictures.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Recording two, free market [1]_____ hasn't freed us; it has trapped us. It's [2]_____ for us to embrace a workplace revolution. We are unlikely to spend our last moments, regretting that we didn't spend enough of our lives slaving away at work, we may instead find ourselves feeling guilty about the time we didn't spend watching our children grow, or with our loved ones, or travelling, or on the cultural or [3]_____ pursuits that bring us happiness. Unfortunately, the average full-time employee in the world works 42 hours a week, well over a third of the time we're [4]_____. Some of our all-too-precious time is being [5]_____. Office workers do around 2 billion hours of [6]_____ overtime each year, so it's extremely welcome that some government coalitions have started looking into potentially cutting the working week to four days. The champions of free market [7]_____ promised their way of life would bring us freedom, but it wasn't freedom at all. From the lack of secure, affordable housing to growing job [8]_____ and rising personal

debt, the individual is trapped. Nine decades ago, leading [9]_____ predicted that technological advances and rising productivity would mean that we'd be working a 15-hour week by now. That target has been somewhat missed. Here is the most [10]_____ threat to our personal freedom, particularly as the balance of power in the workplace has been shifted so dramatically from worker to boss, a huge portion of our lives involves the surrender of our freedom and personal autonomy. It's time in which we are directed by the needs and desires of others, and [11]_____ the right to make our own choices. That's bad for us. It's [12]_____ surprising that over half a million workers suffer from work-related mental health conditions each year. All that 15.4 million working days were lost to work-related stress last year, a [13]_____ of nearly a quarter. Yes, there are those who, far from being [14]_____, actually seek more hours. But a shorter working week would enable us to [15]_____ hours from the overworked to the underworked. We need to look at ways of cutting the working week without slashing living standards, after all, the world's workers have already suffered the worst [16]_____ in wages since the early 1800s, and cutting the working week would be conducive to the individual, giving millions of workers more time to spend as they see fit.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Today I'm going to talk about Germany's dream airport in Berlin. The airport looks exactly like every other major modern airport in Europe, except for one big problem. More than seven years after it was originally supposed to open, it still stands [1]_____. Germany is known for its efficiency and [2]_____ engineering, but when it comes to its new ghost airport, this reputation could not be further from the truth. Plagued by long delays, perpetual [3]_____, and ever soaring costs, the airport has become something of a joke among Germans, and a source of frustration for local politicians, business leaders, and residents alike. Planning for the new airport began in 1989, at the time it became clear that the newly reunified Berlin would need a modern airport with far greater [4]_____ than its existing airports. The city broke ground on the new airport in 2006. The first major sign of problems came in summer 2010 when the construction [5]_____ pushed the opening from October 2011 to June 2012. In 2012, the city planned an opening ceremony, but less than a month [6]_____, inspectors found significant problems with the fire safety system, and pushed the opening back again to 2013. It wasn't just the smoke system; many other major

problems subsequently [7]_____. More than 90 meters of cable were incorrectly installed, 4000 doors were [8]_____ numbered. [9]_____ were too short, and there was a shortage of check-in desks. So why, with so many problems discovered, didn't the airport [10]_____ decide to give up on the project and start over? The reason is simple: people are often [11]_____ to terminate a project when they've already invested time or resources into it, even if it might make logical sense to do so. The longer the delays continued, the more problems [12]_____ found. Leadership of the planning [13]_____ has changed hands nearly as many times as the opening date has been pushed back. Initially, rather than [14]_____ a general contractor to run the project, the corporation decided to manage it themselves, despite lack of experience with an undertaking of that scale. To compound the delays, the [15]_____ airport is resulting in massive costs. Every month it remains [16]_____ costs between nine and 10 million euros. Assuming all goes well, the airport should open in October 2020, but the still empty airport stands as the biggest [17]_____ to Germany's reputation for efficiency, and a continuing drain on city and state resources.

2019年12月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Today our [1]_____ is Rosie Mullender, who works as a features editor for a fashion magazine. Hi, Rosie. You're features [2]_____ at one of the most widely read women's magazines in the UK. What kind of responsibilities does that job [3]_____? We spend our days looking at ideas from journalists writing copy for the magazine and website and [4]_____. We do [5]_____ things like asking people in the street questions and testing sports clothing. We also do less [6]_____ things like understanding what our readers want. It's certainly varied and sometimes bizarre. During your working day, what kind of work might you [7]_____ do? My day mainly [8]_____ responding to emails, writing and editing stories, and coming up with new feature ideas. How does the job of features editor differ from that of fashion editor or other editorial positions, the features team deals with articles such as careers, reports, confidence, and [9]_____. Everything except fashion and beauty. A lot of people believe that working at a magazine is a [10]_____ job. Is this an accurate representation of what you do, I'd say it's [11]_____ to an extent, but not in the way it's portrayed in films. We do have our moments, such as interviewing celebrities and attending parties, which is a huge [12]_____. Ultimately, though, we're the same as our [13]_____, but working in a job we're all very lucky to have. Did you have to [14]_____ any difficulties to reach this point in your career? How did you manage to do this? I had to be really [15]_____, and it was very hard work. After three years of working in a petrol station and doing [16]_____ work, I still hadn't managed to get an entry-level job. I was lucky that my last [17]_____ attempt led to a job. I told myself that all experiences make you a better journalist in the long run, and [18]_____ I was right.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Are you watching any good shows these days? Actually, yes. I'm watching a great satire called Frankie. I think you'd like it. Really, what's it about? It's about a real guy named Frankie. He's a famous comedian in New York, and the show's a mixture of comedy and drama, loosely [1]_____ his life. I'm sorry. Do you mean to say

it's a real life series about a real person? It's nonfiction, is it? No, not really. No, it's [2]_____, as what happens in every episode is made up. However, the lead role is a [3]_____ by the name of Frankie, and he plays himself. So Frankie in both real life and in the TV show lives in New York City, is a comic, is [4]_____, and has two little daughters. All those things are true, but aside from him, all his friends and family are played by actors, and the plots and events that take place are also [5]_____. Oh, I think I see now. That sounds like a very original concept. Yes, it is. In fact, the whole show is written, directed, [6]_____, and produced by him, and it's very funny and has won many awards. That's cool. I will try to download it. I'm watching a [7]_____ called The Big Bang Theory. It's a huge hit around the world. Oh yes, I've heard of it, but never actually watched it. Well, then you should check it out. It's also very funny. It's about four male scientists and a female [8]_____. The men are very socially awkward, but very bright, and this is [9]_____ by the lady's social skills and common sense. The show has been running for over 10 years, and some of the actors are practically global [10]_____ now that they are such famous celebrities.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

[1]_____ one, related to the use it or lose it law, is the keep moving principle. We learn about stagnation from nature. A river that stops moving gets smelly. The same thing happens to people who stop moving, either [2]_____ or physically. Those who play contact sports know that the player who usually gets hurt the most is the one who is standing still. Of course, you'll need some time to catch your breath every so often, but the essential message is: keep moving, [3]_____, and learning. Ships last a lot longer when they go to sea than when they stay in the [4]_____. The same is true for airplanes. You don't [5]_____ an airplane by keeping it on the ground; you preserve it by keeping it in service. We also get to live a long, healthy life by staying in service. [6]_____ statistics reveal that the average person doesn't last very long after retirement. The moral here is: don't retire. If a [7]_____ says, "I'm 94 years old and I've worked all my life," we need to realize that is how we got to be 94 by staying involved. George Bernard Shaw won a Nobel [8]_____ when he was nearly 70. Benjamin Franklin [9]_____ some of his best writings at the age of 84, and Pablo Picasso put brush to canvas right through his eighties. Isn't the issue how old we think we are? A bonus with the keep

moving [10]_____ is that while we keep moving, we don't have a chance to worry. Hence, we avoid the [11]_____ paralysis by analysis.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

In 2014, one in 16 Americans visited the hospital emergency room for home [1]_____. One of the main causes of these accidents, a [2]_____ mind. By one estimate, people [3]_____ through nearly half of their waking hours, psychologists have recently focused on the tendency to think about something other than the task one is doing. For one experiment, researchers developed an app to analyze the relationship between [4]_____ and happiness. They found that the average person's mind wandered most frequently, about 65 percent of the time during personal activities such as brushing their teeth and [5]_____ their hair. [6]_____' minds tended to wander more when they felt upset rather than happy. They were more likely to [7]_____ toward pleasant topics than unpleasant ones. How do daydreams affect daydreamers? A [8]_____ mind leaves us vulnerable when driving. In one study, [9]_____ interviewed 955 people involved in traffic accidents. The majority of them reported having [10]_____ just before the accident, yet other research suggests that daydreaming has benefits. [11]_____ have found that it gives us a chance to think about our goals, and it also seems to increase creativity. In one experiment, 145 [12]_____ completed four unusual uses tasks, each requiring them to list as many uses as possible for an everyday object. After the first pair of tasks was completed, one group of participants was assigned an [13]_____ activity intended to cause their minds to wander. When all the [14]_____ proceeded to the second pair of tasks, the daydreamers performed 40% better than the others.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Recording one, dating from as far back as the 12th century, they are claimed to be the rarest [1]_____ buildings in Western Europe. These buildings offer vital insights into Scandinavia's Viking past, but now with only 30 wooden churches remaining, and their condition [2]_____, experts are working to preserve the structures for future generations. Some of these spectacular churches are no more than small buildings, barely four [3]_____ wide and six metres tall. Others are much larger structures that [4]_____ up to 40 metres

into the cold air, most consist of timber frames that rest on stone blocks. This means that they have no foundations. Although many of the churches appear from the outside to be complex structures, they normally feature only a single [5]_____, but numerous different roof levels. Staff from the [6]_____ government have carried out conservation work on 10 of the churches over the past two years. Most of these churches date from between the 12th and 14th centuries. Other churches were conserved in previous years. So far, specialists have worked to add [7]_____ materials to the churches' exteriors. They also replaced [8]_____ roofs and halted the sinking of the churches into the ground. In two cases, huge machines have been used to lift the buildings up to 30 [9]_____ into the air. This was [10]_____ so that the team could examine and repair the church's original medieval stone blocks. The team plans to return to around a dozen of the buildings to [11]_____ progress and consider further action. The earliest free-standing wooden church was probably built in Norway in around 1080, however, the largest known wooden churches were built from the 1130s [12]_____. This period was one of inter-elite [13]_____, in which nobles sought to increase their influence by funding the construction of churches and other buildings. The reason for constructing the buildings from wood, is probably that ideally [14]_____, straight, and slender timber was available in large quantities in Scandinavia's vast pine forests. As wood was so [15]_____, it was cheaper to use than the stone used in the buildings of other European cultures. The area's shipbuilding tradition, partly established by the Vikings, also meant that sophisticated [16]_____ was a major aspect of the local culture. The complex style of the medieval wooden church [17]_____ and the skills used to make them almost certainly derive from the ancient Viking tradition.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

In last week's lecture, we discussed the characteristics of the newly born offspring of several [1]_____. You probably remember that human infants are less developed physically than other [2]_____ of the same age, but in today's lecture we'll look at three very interesting studies that hint at the surprising abilities of human babies. In the first study, three-year-olds watched two videos shown side by side, each featuring a different researcher, one of whom they'd met once two years earlier, the children spent longer watching the video showing the researcher they hadn't met. This is consistent with young children's usual [3]_____ to look longer at

things that aren't familiar. And really, this is amazing. It [4]_____ the children remembered the researcher they'd met just one time when they were only one-year-olds. Of course, as most of us forget memories from our first few years as we grow older, these early long-term memories will likely be lost in [5]_____ years. Our second study is about music. For this study, [6]_____ played music to babies through speakers located on either side of a human face. They waited until the babies got bored and [7]_____ their gaze from the face, and then they changed the mood of the music, either from sad to happy or the other way around. This mood switch made no difference to the three-month-olds, but for the nine-month-olds it was enough to [8]_____ their interest, and they started looking again in the direction of the face. This suggests that babies of that age can tell the difference between a happy [9]_____ and a sad tune. Our final study is from 1980, but it's still [10]_____ today. In fact, it's one of the most famous pieces of research about [11]_____ emotion ever published. The study involved ordinary adults watching video [12]_____ of babies nine months or younger. In the video clips, the babies made various facial expressions in response to real life events, including [13]_____ interactions and painful ones. The adult observers were able to reliably [14]_____ an assortment of emotions on the babies' faces. These emotions included interest, joy, surprise, sadness, anger, [15]_____, contempt, and fear. Next week, we'll be looking at this last study more [16]_____. In fact, we will be viewing some of the video clips from that study, and together see how well we do in [17]_____ the baby's emotions.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Today, I'd like to talk about the dangers of being too [1]_____. Being a good team player is an essential skill in our modern [2]_____. The ability to work well with others and [3]_____ on projects is a sought-after ability in nearly every position. However, placing too much emphasis on being a good team player can [4]_____ affect your career growth. Don't be overly focused on gaining consensus. Don't be too concerned with the opinions of others. This can [5]_____ your ability to make decisions, speak up, and gain recognition for your individual skills and strengths. Some people are too subordinate to others' opinions, too focused on decision consensus, too silent about their own point of view, too [6]_____ to take things on when they don't have time or energy. This leads to building a brand of underconfident, [7]_____, low-impact non-leaders, and hampers their growth and career advancement. Collaboration

certainly makes your individual [8]_____ and contributions more difficult for outsiders to identify. [9]_____ projects mean you sharing the spotlight with others. [10]_____ may then find it difficult to determine your contributions and strengths. This may end up costing you opportunities for [11]_____ or pay raises. You certainly shouldn't ditch teamwork, but how can you avoid the hazards of being an over [12]_____? Working in a team can have huge benefits. Your team may have [13]_____ successes and often gain recognition. You'll then have more opportunities to [14]_____ your professional network than if you worked alone. However, finding a balance between team efforts and individual projects that give you independent recognition is important for making a name for yourself and providing opportunities for [15]_____. Be selective in who you work with. This will maximize the benefits and minimize the downsides of being a team player, [16]_____ with people who have complementary expertise. [17]_____ projects where there's potential for mutual benefit. Perhaps you're bringing your [18]_____ knowledge and gaining access to someone else's professional network, or maybe you're able to learn a new skill by working with someone. Seek out your teammates [19]_____ rather than jumping on every new group project opportunity. When we are too [20]_____, we want everyone to agree with a decision before we proceed. This can create unnecessary delays as you hold meetings trying to achieve a [21]_____. It's fine to be [22]_____ when seeking input, but put a deadline on the input stage and arrive at a decision, even if it's a decision that doesn't have consensus.

2019年6月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Wow! I would give anything to be more like Audrey Hepburn. I never really understood why so many girls were such big fans of her. I mean, I've seen the famous films Roman Holiday, Breakfast at Tiffany's, and a few others, but I still don't fully get it. Was she that great of an actress? Well, for me, my [1]_____ goes beyond her movies. She had such a classic [2]_____ about her. She was always so [3]_____, in part because she spent years training as a ballet dancer before becoming an actress. Why didn't she stick to dancing as a career? It seems it was fate. She suffered from [4]_____ nutrition during the war, and therefore a career as a professional dancer would have been too demanding on her body. So she focused on acting instead. Roman Holiday was her first big break, which made her a star. Was that the film that opened with her shopping for [5]_____ in New York City? You know the scene. She was wearing a black dress and dark [6]_____ with a pearl necklace and long black gloves. I see the photo of her in that [7]_____ everywhere. No, that one is Breakfast at Tiffany's. That [8]_____ is often referred to as the most famous little black dress of all time. Her character in that film is very [9]_____ and charming, even though in real life Audrey always described herself as shy and quiet. So, what did she do after her acting career. She dedicated much of her life to helping children in need. Her family received international aid during the war when she was growing up. I think that left a big impression on her. That's where I got the idea to [10]_____ for children's charity next weekend. I'll join you. I may not be as [11]_____ as Audrey Hepburn, but I'm all for supporting a good cause.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

So, how's our presentation about the [1]_____ of the company coming along? Fine, I'm putting the finishing touches to it now, but we'll have to be prepared for questions. Yes, there's already a feeling that this is a top-down change. We really need to get everyone on board. Well, there's been an extensive consultation period. I know, but there's always the feeling that if it isn't broke, don't fix it. People are worried about their jobs too. I think we need to stress that while there will be some job changes, there won't be anyone getting [2]_____.

In fact, we're looking to take on more staff. Agreed. You can [3]_____ blame people for worrying, though. We need to make it clear that it's not just change for change's sake. In other words, we really must make the case for why we are doing it. So, what's the outline of the presentation? I'll start with a brief review of the reasons for the change, that we really need to make a clean break to [4]_____ growth. After that, I'll [5]_____ the new company structures and who's going where. Then I'll hand it over to you to discuss the timeline and [6]_____, and we'll take questions together at the end. Anything else? Oh yeah, we should let the staff know the channels of [7]_____. You know who they can contact or direct questions to about these changes. Yes, and we can [8]_____ some frequently asked questions and present some general answers. Hmm. And we'll make the [9]_____ and the questions available via the company's own computer network, right? Yes, we'll make a page on the network where staff can download all the [10]_____. All right. Perhaps we should do a practice run of the [11]_____ first. You bet.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: Airline passengers have to deal with a lot these days, getting bumped from flights and losing luggage, on top of the general anxiety that nervous passengers always feel, at the Cincinnati Northern Kentucky International Airport, miniature horses deliver a [1]_____ force two times a month. Denver and Ruby are two of the four therapy horses brought in from a local farm, they can usually be found in the ticket counter area, interacting with [2]_____. More than 30 airports across the country now have [3]_____ dogs. San Francisco has a therapy pig. San Jose, California, began a dog program after the [4]_____ attacks of September the 11th. Since its beginning, the program has now grown and has 21 [5]_____ dogs and a therapy cat. The animals don't get [6]_____; they have had hundreds of hours of airport training, so they are used to having luggage and people crowding around them, these professional animals are probably better at finding their way in the airports than the most frequent of travelers. The [7]_____ often say that seeing animals makes them feel much better and helps them to calm down before a flight. This little bit of support can sometimes make a big difference. Some [8]_____ enjoy the animals so much that they call the airport to schedule flights around their visits. Visits to nursing homes and schools are also a regular part of the horse's [9]_____. Their owner is already working on a new idea for a therapy animal, [10]_____.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Hello, viewers. Today I'm standing at a 2,000-year-old Roman-era site. Here, the brightly colored scenes that once [1]_____ a mansion are being dug up. These scenes are turning up in the southern French city of Arles, surprising the [2]_____ who have been working here since 2014. [3]_____ of paint still cling to the stone walls of a bedroom and reception hall. Some of these painted walls are [4]_____ in places to a height of one meter. In addition, thousands of [5]_____ that fell off the walls have been recovered. These pieces have been put back together with great care and [6]_____ a variety of images. Some of these images include figures never seen before in France, such as a woman playing a [7]_____ instrument, possibly a character from mythology. The paintings were done with such skill and with such expensive [8]_____ that experts believe the artists originally came from Italy. They were likely [9]_____ by one of the city's elite, perhaps a Roman official wanted Pompeii-like interior to remind him of home. He was probably stationed in this provincial trading port, founded in 46 B.C. as a colony for veterans of the Roman army, or maybe a wealthy local wanted to show off his worldly [10]_____. The paintings may yield even more stunning surprises as additional sections are put together like pieces of a [11]_____. Whoever it was that created such [12]_____ pieces of art, they surely had no idea that their work would still be around thousands of years later.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Good afternoon, class. Today I want to discuss with you a new approach to [1]_____ research. In the past, scientists often worked alone; they were confined to the university or research center where they worked. Today, though, we are seeing [2]_____ of some of the greatest scientific minds, regardless of their location. There has never been a better time for [3]_____ with foreign scientists. In fact, the European Union is taking the lead. Spurred on by [4]_____ policies, half of European research articles had international co-authors in 2007. This is more than twice the level of two [5]_____ ago. The European Union's level of international co-authorship is about twice that of the United States, Japan, and India. Even so, the levels in these countries are also rising. This is a sign of the continued [6]_____ of creating scientific

coalitions across borders. Andrus Schubert, a [7]_____ at the Institute for Science Policy Research, says that the rise in collaboration is partly out of necessity. This [8]_____ comes with the rise of big science. Many scientific endeavors have become more complicated. These new [9]_____ require the money and labor of many nations. But he says, collaborations have also [10]_____ because of increased possibilities. The internet allows like-minded scientists to find each other. [11]_____, dramatic drops in communication costs ease long-distance interactions, and there's a reward. Studies of citation counts show that internationally co-authored papers have better [12]_____. Schubert says, international [13]_____ is a way to spread ideas in wider and wider circles. Caroline Wagner, a research scientist at George Washington University, notes that international collaborations offer additional flexibility, whereas local collaborations sometimes persist past the point of [14]_____ because of social or academic obligations, international ones can be cultivated and dropped more freely. The [15]_____ trend is true across scientific Disciplines, some fields though have a greater tendency for it. Particle physicists and astronomers collaborate often. This is because they must share expensive [16]_____. Mathematicians, by contrast, tend historically towards solitude. As a consequence, they lag behind other [17]_____. However, Wagner says [18]_____ are rising there too. The level of collaboration also [19]_____ from country to country. There are historical and political reasons as to why collaborations [20]_____, says Wagner. This rise is also apparently boosted by policies [21]_____ in European framework funding schemes. These policies [22]_____ funding requirements that often require teamwork.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Good evening. In 1959, on the day that I was born, a headline in Life magazine [1]_____, "Target Venus. There may be life there." It told of how scientists rode a balloon to an altitude of 80,000 feet to make [2]_____ observations of Venus's atmosphere, and how their discovery of water raised hopes that there could be living things there. As a kid, I [3]_____ to tales of adventure in Isaac Asimov's juvenile science fiction novel Lucky Starr and the Oceans of Venus. For many of my [4]_____, though, Venus quickly lost its romance. The very first thing that scientists discovered with a mission to another planet was that Venus was not at all the [5]_____ paradise that fiction had portrayed. It is nearly identical to our own planet in bulk

properties such as mass, density, and size, but its surface has been cooked and dried by an ocean of carbon dioxide, trapped in the burning death grip of a [6]_____ greenhouse effect. Venus has long been held up as a [7]_____ tale for everything that could go wrong on a planet like Earth, as a possible home for alien life, it has been voted the planet least likely to succeed. But I have refused to give up on Venus, and over the years my [8]_____ loyalty has been justified. The rocky views glimpsed by Venera Nine and other Russian [9]_____ suggested a tortured volcanic history. That was confirmed in the early 1990s by the American Magellan [10]_____, which used radar to peer through the planet's thick clouds and map out a rich, varied, and dynamic surface. The surface formed mostly in the last billion years, which makes it fresher and more recently active than any [11]_____ planet other than Earth. Russian and American [12]_____ also found hints that its ancient climate might have been wetter, cooler, and possibly even friendly to life. Measurements of density and composition [13]_____ that Venus originally formed out of basically the same stuff as Earth, that presumably included much more water than the tiny trace we find blowing in the thick air today. Thus, our picture of Venus at around the time life was getting started on Earth is one of warm oceans, probably rich with organic [14]_____, splashing around rocky shores and volcanic vents. The sun was considerably less bright back then, so Venus was arguably a [15]_____ habitat for life than Earth.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

I'm a [1]_____ professor at the University of British Columbia. I specialize in cultural psychology, examining [2]_____ and differences between East Asians and North Americans. Our research team has been looking at cultural differences in self-enhancing [3]_____, how people have positive feelings towards not only themselves but things connected to themselves. For example, when you own something, you view it as more [4]_____ than when you don't own it. It's called the endowment effect. The strength of that effect is stronger in Western cultures than in East Asian cultures, so we've been looking at other ways of seeing whether this motivation to view oneself [5]_____ is shaped by cultural experiences. We've also started to look at how culture [6]_____ sleep. We are still in the exploratory stages of this project, although what's noteworthy is that East Asians, on average, sleep about an hour and a half less each night than North Americans do, and it's not a more efficient sleep, not like they're [7]_____ relatively more value out of

their hours. Other studies have found that even [8]_____ in East Asia sleep about an hour less than European infants. So we're trying to figure out how culture [9]_____ the way you sleep. Our [10]_____ does not take place in a sleep lab. Instead, we [11]_____ people motion-detecting watches, and they wear them for a week at a time. Whenever they are not having a shower or swimming, they keep it on. These kinds of watches are used in sleep studies as a way of measuring how long people are sleeping, how [12]_____ their sleep is, and whether they are waking up in the night. [13]_____, I'd like to take this into a controlled lab environment. We'll see where the research points us. We usually start off with the more affordable methods, and if everything looks [14]_____, then it'll justify trying to build a sleep lab and study sleep across cultures that way. Why do we study sleep? Sleep is something that has really been an [15]_____ topic cross-culturally. I'm attracted to it because culture isn't something that only shapes the way our minds operate, it shapes the way our bodies operate too, and sleep is at the [16]_____ of those.

2019年6月 第1套

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hi, my name's Cathy. Nice to meet you. Nice to meet you too, Cathy. My name's John. I'm a university friend of the bride. What about you? Who do you know at this party? I'm a colleague of Brenda. I was a little surprised to be [1]_____. To be honest, we've only been working together the last six months, but we quickly became good friends. We just wrapped up a project with a difficult [2]_____ last week. I bet Brenda is glad it's done with, and she can focus on wedding [3]_____. Oh yes, so you're Cathy from the office. Actually, I've heard a lot about you and that project. The client sounded like a real nightmare. Oh, he was. I mean, we deal with all kinds of people on a regular basis. It's part of the job, but he was especially particular. Enough about that. What line of work are you in? Well, right out of college, I worked in [4]_____ for a while. Recently, though, I turned my photography [5]_____ into a small business. I'll actually be taking photos during the big event as a wedding [6]_____. That sounds wonderful and very [7]_____ of you. I [8]_____ just as a hobby, but Brenda has asked me to do the cake for the wedding. I was a bit [9]_____ saying yes because I'm far from a professional. Did you [10]_____ the cookies here at the party tonight? Yes, I got the idea from a [11]_____. They're delicious. You've got nothing to worry about. You're a natural. You really think so? If you hadn't told me that, I would have guessed they were [12]_____ by the restaurant, you know. With your event planning experience, you could very well open your own shop. One step at a time. First, I'll see how [13]_____ the wedding cake goes. If it's not a [14]_____, maybe I'll give it some more thought.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

You're heading for a completely different world now that you're about to [1]_____ from high school. I know it's the end of high school, but many of my [2]_____ are going on to the same university, and we are still required to study hard. So, what's the difference? Many aspects are different here at university. The most important one is that you have to take more individual [3]_____ for your actions. It's up to your own self-discipline how much effort you put into study. Living in college [4]_____, there are no

parents to tell you to study harder or stop wasting time. [5]_____ have hundreds of students, and they're not going to follow you up or question you if you miss their lectures, nobody cares. You mean? It's not that nobody's concerned about you. It's just that suddenly at university you are expected to [6]_____ like an adult. That means [7]_____ on the direction of your life in general, and your own academic performance specifically, for example. Well, like you need to manage your daily, weekly, and monthly schedules so that you'll study [8]_____. Be sure to attend all classes and leave enough time to finish [9]_____ and prepare well for examinations. Okay, and what else is different? Well, in college, there are lots of [10]_____, and you need to control yourself. You will make interesting friends, but you need only keep the friends who respect your student [11]_____. Also, there are a lot of wonderful clubs, but you shouldn't [12]_____ too much time to club activities unless they're directly related to your study. It's also your choice if you want to go out at night, but you would be [13]_____ to let that affect your class performance during the day. Well, I'm [14]_____ to do well at university, and I guess I'm going to have to grow up fast.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Most successful people are [1]_____ persons whose minds wander outside traditional ways of thinking. Instead of trying to [2]_____ old formulas, they invent new ones. When Jean Claude Killy made the French national ski team in the early 1960s, he was prepared to work harder than anyone else to be the best. At the crack of dawn, he would run up the slopes with his skis on, an [3]_____ back-breaking activity. In the evening, he would do [4]_____ and running, but the other team members were working as hard and long as he was. He realized [5]_____ that simply training harder would never be enough. Killy then began challenging the basic theories of racing [6]_____. Each week he would try something different to see if he could find a better, faster way down the [7]_____. His [8]_____ resulted in a new style that was almost exactly opposite the accepted technique of the time. It involved skiing with his legs apart for better balance, and sitting back on the skis when he came to a turn, he also used ski poles in an [9]_____ way, to propel himself as he skied. The explosive new style helped cut Killy's racing time [10]_____. In 1966 and 1967, he captured virtually every major [11]_____ trophy. The next year, he

won three gold [12]_____ in the Winter Olympics, a record in ski racing that has never been topped. Killy learned an important secret shared by many creative people: innovations don't require genius, just a [13]_____ to question the way things have always been done.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

Passage two: Scientific experiments have demonstrated incredible ways to kill a guinea pig, a small [1]_____ animal. Emotional upsets generate powerful and [2]_____ toxic substances. Blood samples taken from persons experiencing intense fear or anger when [3]_____ into guinea pigs have killed them in less than two minutes. Imagine what these [4]_____ substances can do to your own body. Every thought that you have affects your body [5]_____ within a split second. Remember how you feel when you are speeding down the highway and a big truck suddenly [6]_____ 20 meters in front of you. A shock wave [7]_____ through your whole system. Your mind produces [8]_____ reactions in your body. The toxic substances that fear, anger, [9]_____, and stress produce, not only kill guinea pigs but kill us off in a similar manner. It is impossible to be fearful, anxious, [10]_____, and healthy at the same time, it is not just difficult; it is impossible. Simply put, your body's health is a [11]_____ of your mental health. Sickness will often then be a result of [12]_____ inner conflicts, which in time show up in the body. It is also fascinating how our [13]_____ mind shapes our health. Do you [14]_____ falling sick on a day when you didn't want to go to school? Headaches brought on by fear. The mind-body connection is such that if, for example, we want to avoid something, very often our [15]_____ mind will arrange it. Once we recognize that these things happen to us, we are [16]_____ to doing something about them.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Teachers and students alike have experienced the curious paradox that [1]_____, as a rule, tend to think too little about what they are doing because they think too much about what they are doing. Take, for example, people who are learning to play basketball or the piano, they have to give so much thought and attention to the low-level [2]_____ of handling the ball, or fingering the keys, or reading the music, that they are unable to give any thought to the thing that matters, the game, or the music, respectively. With [3]_____, it's just

the other way around. They're open to the [4]_____ possibilities and the musical challenges precisely because they're freed through skill from the need to pay attention to the low-level details of how to play. Indeed, when the expert pays attention to the mechanics, this is liable to [5]_____ performance. This has led some to say that the expert [6]_____ in a zone beyond thought, in a state of flow. But this is misleading. Expert performance is not beyond thought. Smart basketball players or [7]_____ musicians need to pay close attention to the demands of high performance, to the challenges to be overcome. What they don't need to do, what would be a [8]_____, is to have to think about where their fingers are or how to control the ball while running. It's not mechanics, but the play itself that [9]_____ the expert's intelligence. A nice video published online last month sheds light on [10]_____ and the conscious mind. The video reports a new study using an eye tracking device. It turns out that the less skilled [11]_____ spends more time looking at her fingers than does the expert, who, in contrast, is more likely to be looking at the sheet music, or looking ahead at keys he's not yet playing. In general, the expert's [12]_____ was calmer and more stable. This is not a surprising finding; it supports what we might almost think of as [13]_____ wisdom. But it's [14]_____ for all that, none the less. The eye tracker gives expert and learning [15]_____ a glimpse into what they do without thinking about it. The topic of the nature of skill and the differences between [16]_____ and experts has been one of considerable discussion in cognitive science and philosophy.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Every summer, when I top up my selection of summer [1]_____ from the department stores, my eyes would nearly pop out of my head. I'm overwhelmed with a wide range of different [2]_____ products each year, and more shockingly, these products are often advocated by very slim models. Having lived in Asia for almost 10 years now, I've seen various dieting [3]_____ come and go. I remember in Japan, people heading directly to the fruit section in the [4]_____ when the banana diet was at its peak. Then there was the black tea and oolong tea diet, followed by the [5]_____ diet and the tomato juice diet. The list goes on and on. Apart from what people eat, I've also seen many interesting [6]_____ products. In Hong Kong, I've seen girls wrapping their whole body or both legs up with a special type of [7]_____ tape, which is supposed to help make them thinner, but it just reminded me of the roasted ham my mother usually puts on the dinner table at

Christmas. Then there were the face [8]_____ rollers that were said to improve your blood circulation and make your face smaller. Personally, I do not believe in any of these [9]_____ gadgets, and I think I have a very different perspective when it comes to the definition of what is beautiful. Asian women prefer to avoid the sun because being pale or white is considered beautiful, whereas a [10]_____ complexion is considered much more beautiful and sexy in the West. It is most certainly shaped by a person's culture, as well as how they were raised in their [11]_____, as each summer season approaches, there's no escape from it. But it's not only women who are [12]_____ by this pressure to look good. Men aspire to be able to show off their six packs, or their V-shaped backs, and there's a growing market of [13]_____ pills aimed at men too. I think no matter what diets we follow or what [14]_____ products we obsess ourselves with, at the end of the day there's no magic trick to shape up for the summer. Eat in a balanced way and [15]_____ the right level of physical activity. For me, this still seems to be the best plan.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Skin may seem like a [1]_____ human attribute, but it's the first thing we notice about anyone we meet. As a [2]_____ focusing on the studies of apes and monkeys, I've been studying why humans evolved to become the naked ape, and why skin comes in so many different shades around the world. We can make a very good estimate from the fossil record that humans probably [3]_____ naked skin around a million and a half years ago, and meanwhile, they mostly lost their coat of fur. Today we have a few patches of hair remaining on various parts of our bodies, but compared with [4]_____ and monkeys, we have very little. Basically, we turned our skin darker to serve as a natural sun [5]_____ in the place of the hair we lost. We think we lost this hair because of the need to keep ourselves cool when we were moving around [6]_____ in a hot environment. We can't really lose heat by breathing quickly and [7]_____ like dogs. We have to do it by sweating, so we [8]_____ the ability to sweat plentifully and lost most of our fur. Most animals protect themselves from the sun with fur. What we did in our [9]_____ was to produce more permanent natural coloring in our skin cells. This was really an important revolution in human history, because it allowed us to continue to evolve in [10]_____ environments. It really made it possible for us to continue along the [11]_____ toward modern humans in Africa. For most of human history, we all had dark skin.

What we see today is the product of evolutionary events resulting from the [12]_____ of a few human populations out of Africa around 60,000 to 70,000 years ago. Our species originated around 200,000 years ago, and underwent tremendous diversification, culturally, technologically, [13]_____, artistically, for 130,000 years. After that, a few small populations left Africa to [14]_____ the rest of the world. These early ancestors of modern [15]_____ dispersed into parts of the world that had more seasonal sunshine and much lower levels of sun radiation. It's in these populations that we begin to see real changes in the genetic makeup of natural [16]_____. Today, skin color is [17]_____ via new mixtures of people coming together and having children with new mixtures of skin color genes. We can see this in almost every large city [18]_____. Not only the coloring [19]_____, but lots of other genes are getting mixed up too.

2018年12月 第2套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Do you mind taking my photo with the [1]_____ over there? I think it will make a great shot. Sure, no worries. You're always taking photos. What do you do with all the photos you take? Well, don't laugh. My dream is to become an online [2]_____ of sorts. You're not serious, are you? I am completely. I just got the idea a few months ago after posting some holiday photos on my social media accounts, a lot of people liked my photos and started asking me for travel [3]_____. So I figured I'd give it a go. I post a lot on social media anyway, so I've got nothing to lose. I guess that's true. So what do you have to do to become Internet famous, surprisingly, a lot more than I did as a [4]_____. Recently, I've been spending a lot more time [5]_____ photos, posting online, and clearing storage on my phone. It's always full now. That doesn't sound like too much work. Well, there's more to it. I spent all last weekend researching what topics are popular, what words to use in [6]_____, and similar accounts to follow, it really was a lot to take in, and I was up well past midnight. I'd say it's paying off, though. I increased the number of people following my accounts by 15% already. That is impressive. I guess I never thought much about all the effort behind the scene. Now that I think about it, there's always something wrong with my photos as it is: half smiles, closed eyes, [7]_____ hair. I hope you have better luck than I do. Then again, I think the only person interested in my photos is my mum.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Good evening and welcome to Physics Today. Here we interview some of the greatest minds in [1]_____ as they help us to understand some of the most complicated theories. Today, I'm very pleased to welcome Dr. [2]_____ Phillips, professor of theoretical physics. She's here to tell us a little about what it is she studies. Dr. Phillips, you seem to study everything. I guess that would be fair to say. I spend most of my time studying the Big Bang theory and where our [3]_____ came from. Can you tell us a little about that? Well, I'm very interested in why the [4]_____ exists at all. That may sound odd, but the fact is, at the moment of the Big Bang, both matter and [5]_____ were created. For a short time, and I mean just a fraction of a second,

the whole universe was a super hot soup of radiation filled with these [6]_____. So, what's [7]_____ scientists for so long is why is there a universe at all? That's because matter and [8]_____ are basically opposites of each other; they are exactly alike, except that they have opposite electrical charges. So when they [9]_____, they destroy each other. Exactly. So during the first few moments of the Big Bang, the [10]_____ was extremely hot and very small. Matter and the now more exotic [11]_____ would have had little space to avoid each other. This means that they should have totally wiped each other out, leaving the universe completely [12]_____. But a recent study seems to point to the fact that when matter and [13]_____ were first created, there were slightly more particles of matter, which allowed the universe we all live in to form. Exactly, because there was slightly more matter, the collisions quickly depleted all the [14]_____ and left just enough matter to create stars, planets, and eventually us.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

In this week's edition of special series on [1]_____ medical conditions, there's a report of the case of Michelle Myers. Myers is an American woman who woke up one day speaking with a British [2]_____, even though she's lived in the United States all her life. In 2015, Myers went to bed with a terrible [3]_____. She woke up sounding like someone from England. Her British [4]_____ has remained for the past two years. Previously, Myers had woken up speaking in Irish and Australian [5]_____. However, on both of those occasions, the [6]_____ lasted for only a week. Myers has been [7]_____ with foreign accent syndrome. It's a disorder in which a person experiences a sudden change to their speech so that they sound like they are speaking in a foreign accent, the condition is most often caused by a stroke or [8]_____ brain injury. Although people with the syndrome have [9]_____ speech, their manner of speaking is altered in terms of timing and tongue placement, which may distort their pronunciation. The result is that they may sound foreign when speaking their native language, it's not clear whether Myers has experienced a stroke or other brain damage, but she also has a separate medical condition, which can result in loose joints, easily [10]_____ skin, and other problems. Foreign [11]_____ syndrome is rare, with only about 60 cases reported within the past century. However, a different American woman reportedly spoke with a Russian accent in 2010 after she fell down the [12]_____ and hit her head.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

There is something about water that makes it a good [1]_____ for life. That may be one reason why so many people find relief in swimming when life's seas get rough, and it goes some way towards explaining why books about swimming, in which people [2]_____ icy lakes, race in rivers, and overcome oceans while reflecting on their lives, have recently become so popular. These books reflect a trend, particularly strong in Britain, where swimming in pools is declining, but more and more [3]_____ are opting for open water. Wild swimming seems to be especially popular among women. Jenny Landreth recently published a guide to the best swimming spots in London, her new book Swell interweaves her own story with a history of female [4]_____ who accomplished remarkable feats and paved the way for future generations. Notions of [5]_____ restricted women in the Victorian era, but they still swam. A bathing machine was rolled down to the [6]_____ so women would not be seen in swimwear. In 1892, the Gentlewoman's Book of Sport described a woman swimming in a heavy dress, boots, hat, [7]_____, and carrying an umbrella. Eventually, swimming became freer. Mixed [8]_____ was permitted on British beaches in 1901. Women won the right to swim in public pools, learned to swim properly, created appropriate [9]_____, and in time even competed against men. The first woman to cross the English Channel was Gertrude Ederle in 1926. She beat the record by almost two hours, and her father [10]_____ her with a red sports car.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Today I'm going to talk about a very special kind of person. Psychologists call them masters of [1]_____; those rare individuals with a natural ability to tell with complete confidence when someone is telling a lie. For decades, [2]_____ and law enforcement agencies have tried to build a machine that will do the same thing. Now, a company in Massachusetts says that by using magnetic brain [3]_____, they can determine with 97% accuracy whether someone is telling the truth. They hope that the technology will be cleared for use in American courts by early next year. But is this really the [4]_____ tool for you, the lawyers of tomorrow. You will not find many brain scientists celebrating this [5]_____. The company might be very optimistic, but the ability of their machine to detect [6]_____ has not provided credible proof. That's

because the technology has not been [7] _____ tested in real-world situations. In life, there are different kinds of lies and [8] _____ context in which they're told. These differences may elicit different brain responses. Does their [9] _____ behind the test apply in every case? We don't know the answer because studies done on how reliable this machine is have not yet been [10] _____. Much more research is badly needed. Whether the technology is eventually [11] _____ reliable enough for the courts will ultimately be decided by the judges. Let's hope they're wise enough not to be fooled by a machine that claims to determine [12] _____ at the flip of a switch, they should also be skeptical of the growing tendency to try to reduce all human traits and actions to the level of brain activity. Often, they do not map that easily. [13] _____, understanding the brain is not the same as understanding the mind. Some [14] _____ have suggested that thoughts cannot properly be seen as purely internal. Instead, thoughts make sense only in reference to the individual's [15] _____ world. So, while there may be [16] _____ to be gained from matching behavior to brain activity, those insights will not necessarily lead to justice in a court of law. Problems surround the use of machines to spot deception, at least until it has been [17] _____ tested. A high-tech test that can tell when a person is not telling the truth sounds too good to be true, and when something sounds too good to be true, it usually is.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

Last week, I attended a research [1] _____ on an island in the South Pacific. 30 people were present, and all except me came from the island, called Malakula in the nation of Vanuatu. They live in 16 different communities and speak 16 [2] _____ languages. In many cases, you could stand at the edge of one village and see the [3] _____ of the next community, yet the residents of each village speak a completely different language. According to recent work by my [4] _____ at the Max Planck Institute for the Science of Human History, this island, just 100 kilometers long and 20 kilometers wide is home to speakers of perhaps 40 different indigenous languages. Why so many? We could ask this same question of the entire [5] _____. People don't speak one [6] _____ language or even a handful. Instead, today our species [7] _____ speaks over 7000 distinct languages, and these languages are not spread randomly across the planet. For example, far more languages are found in tropical regions than in the [8] _____ zones. The [9] _____ island of New

Guinea is home to over 900 languages. Russia, 20 times larger, has 105 [10]_____ languages. Even within the [11]_____, language diversity varies widely. For example, the 250,000 people who live on Vanuatu's 80 islands speak 110 different languages. But in Bangladesh, a population 600 times greater speaks only 41 languages. How come humans speak so many languages, and why are they so [12]_____ spread across the planet? As it turns out, we have few clear answers to these fundamental questions about how humanity [13]_____. Most people can easily [14]_____ possible answers to these intriguing questions. They [15]_____ that language diversity must be about history, cultural differences, mountains or oceans dividing populations. But when our diverse team of [16]_____ from six different disciplines and eight different countries began to review what was known, we were shocked that only a dozen previous studies had been done, including one we ourselves completed on language diversity in the Pacific. These prior efforts all examined the degree to which different environmental, social, and geographic variables [17]_____ with a number of languages found in a given location. The results varied a lot from one study to another, and no clear patterns [18]_____. The studies also ran up against many [19]_____ challenges; the biggest of which centered on the old statistical saying, "Correlation does not equal causation."

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

We often hear people say that America is a land of opportunity, a country built on hope to [1]_____ to greatness, on the American dream. But is the dream as we once knew it dying? Today's demographics show that the middle class is disappearing, and now the richest 1% of the population has [2]_____ more wealth than the bottom 90%. Once upon a time, Americans thought that if they worked hard enough, even in the face of [3]_____, they would be rewarded with success. These days, though, the [4]_____ between rich and poor is greater than it has ever been. The question is, what is it going to take to change things. Maybe one day soon, real change will actually be made in our nation, and the gap will be [5]_____. But what happens in the meantime? Is there something that we can do to help close the gap? Is there something that we can do to prove that a little [6]_____ goes a long way? If we want to fix the problem of the income gap, first we have to understand it. It is a [7]_____ reality that you can have one person who only makes around $13,000 a year, while across town another is making millions. For me, it is kind of [8]_____, and if you ask low-

income people what's the one thing that would change their life? They'll say a full-time job. That's all they aspire to. So why is it so difficult for so many people to find [9]_____? It partly comes down to profit-driven business models that are built around low-wage work and part-time jobs that don't provide benefits, businesses in order to [10]_____ profits, hire employees as part-time workers only. This means they are paid the lowest legal [11]_____ and receive no health care or other benefits provided to full-time employees. Simultaneously, technological [12]_____ and a global economy has reduced the demand for well-paying blue-collar jobs here in the United States. The [13]_____ effect of these two factors is that many Americans are forced to take two or more part-time jobs just to make ends meet. What has become [14]_____ to me when it comes to the income gap is that there needs to be an opportunity for the people at the bottom to push them back up and push them into the middle class to give them hope in their lives.

2018年12月 第1套

听写本

Conversation One 第 1—4 题

Hey, I just read a great book about [1]_____. I think you'd like it. It's called The Physics of the World. It's written by a [2]_____ named Sylvia Mendez. Oh, I read that book. It was great. The writer is a warm and [3]_____ guide to the mysteries of physics. I think it promises enrichment for any reader, from those who know little about science to the career [4]_____, and it's refreshing to see a strong, curious, clever woman adding her voice to the scientific discourse in a field that has been traditionally dominated by men. I think she is to be commended for making an effort to include [5]_____ about little-known female scientists. You know, they were often victims of a generation [6]_____ convinced that the woman's place was in the home. I like how the book is clearly written, with each chapter brought to life by pieces of [7]_____ knowledge. For example, in one chapter, she [8]_____ a myth that I've heard taught by university physics professors. I've often heard that [9]_____ glass windows are thicker at the bottom because glass flows like a fluid. This she shows is not true. The distortion is actually thanks to a [10]_____ of the glass maker's process. Yeah, I like how she cultivates scientific engagement by providing a host of do-it-yourself experiments that bring the same [11]_____ principles of classical physics that govern everything from the solar system to your kitchen table. From using complex laws of physics to test whether a spinning egg is cooked to measuring atmospheric pressure by lifting a piece of [12]_____, her hands-on examples make her book a truly interactive read. Yes, I must say this equation-free book is an ideal read for scientists of all stripes, anyone teaching science, and even people who [13]_____ physics.

Conversation Two 第 5—8 题

Hi, Professor. was hoping I could have a moment of your time if you're not too [1]_____. I'm having some problems getting started on my [2]_____, and I was hoping you could give me some advice on how to begin. Sure, I have quite a few students though, so can you [3]_____ me what your topic is? The general topic I chose is [4]_____, but that's as far as I've got. I don't really know where to go from there. Yeah,

that's much too large a topic. You really need to narrow it down in order to make it more [5]_____. Otherwise, you'll be writing a book. Exactly. That's what I wanted to ask you about. I was hoping it would be possible for me to change [6]_____. I'm really more interested in nature than beauty. I'm afraid you have to adhere to the [7]_____ topic. Still, if you're interested in nature, then that certainly can be worked into your [8]_____. We've talked about Hume before in class, right? Oh yeah, he's the [9]_____ who wrote about where our ideas of beauty come from. Exactly. I suggest you go to the library and get a copy of his [10]_____. Start from there, but remember to stick to the [11]_____ of the assignment. This paper is a large part of your [12]_____ grade, so make sure to follow the instructions. If you take a look at his biography, you can get a good idea of how his life experiences [13]_____ themselves in his theories of beauty, specifically the way he looked towards nature as the origin of what we find beautiful. Great, thanks for taking the time to answer my questions, Professor. I'll let you get back to class now. If there's anything else you need, please come see me in my office any time.

Passage One 第 9—11 题

Passage one: During the Arctic winter, from October to March, the average temperature in the frozen north typically [1]_____ around minus 20 degrees Celsius, but this year the Arctic is experiencing much higher temperatures. On February 20th, the temperature in Greenland climbed above freezing or zero degrees [2]_____, and it stayed there for over 24 hours. Then, on February 24th, the temperature on Greenland's northern tip reached six degrees Celsius. Climate scientists describe the phenomenon as stunning. Weather conditions that drive this bizarre temperature [3]_____ have visited the Arctic before. They typically appear about once in a [4]_____. However, the last such increase in temperature took place two years ago, this is [5]_____ as climbing Arctic temperatures combined with rapid sea ice loss are creating a new type of climate feedback loop, which could accelerate Arctic warming. Indeed, sea ice cover in the Arctic is [6]_____ faster than expected. Without those masses of cooling sea ice, warm air brought to the Arctic can [7]_____ further inland than it ever did before. The air can stay warmer longer too. This drives additional melting. Overall, Earth is warming at a rapid [8]_____. 2014 through 2017 [9]_____ as the hottest years on record, and the Arctic is warming twice as fast as any place else on Earth. This raises unique challenges for Arctic

wildlife and Indigenous people, who depend on Arctic [10]_____ to survive. Previously, climate forecasts [11]_____ that Arctic summer ice would disappear entirely by around 2060, but based on what scientists are seeing now, the Arctic may be facing summers without ice within 20 years.

Passage Two 第 12—15 题

A good dose of [1]_____ is often necessary to see any task through, whether it's sticking to a spending plan or finishing a great novel, and if you want to increase that willpower, a new study suggests you just simply have to believe you have it. According to this study, what matters most is what we think about our [2]_____. If we believe it's a [3]_____ resource, we act that way; we feel exhausted and need breaks between demanding mental tasks. However, people who view their willpower as a limitless resource get [4]_____ instead. The researchers used a psychological assessment tool to test the [5]_____ of the study. They asked 1,100 Americans and 1,600 Europeans to grade different statements, such as, "After a challenging mental activity, my energy is [6]_____, and I must rest to get it refueled again," or, "I can focus on a mental task for long periods without feeling tired." Although there was little difference between men and women overall, Americans were more likely to admit to needing breaks after completing [7]_____ challenging tasks. European [8]_____, on the other hand, claimed they were able to keep going. Based on the findings, the researchers suggest that the key to boosting your [9]_____ is to believe that you have an abundant supply of it. Your feelings about your willpower affect the way you behave, but these feelings are [10]_____, they said. Changing your [11]_____ about the nature of your self-control can have positive effects on character development. This leads to healthier behaviors and [12]_____ of other people.

Recording One 第 16—18 题

Here is my baby niece, Sarah. Her mum is a doctor and her dad is a [1]_____. By the time Sarah goes to college, the jobs her parents do are going to look [2]_____ different. In 2013, [3]_____ at Oxford University did a study on the future of work. They concluded that almost one in every two jobs has a high risk of being [4]_____ by machines. Machine learning is the technology that's responsible for most

of this [5]_____. It's the most powerful [6]_____ of artificial intelligence. It allows machines to learn from data and [7]_____ some of the things that humans can do. My company, Kaggle, [8]_____ on the cutting edge of machine learning. We bring together hundreds of thousands of experts to solve important problems for industry and [9]_____. This gives us a unique perspective on what machines can do, what they can't do, and what jobs they might [10]_____ or threaten, machine learning started making its way into industry in the early 90s. It started with relatively simple tasks. It started with things like assessing credit risk from loan applications, sorting the mail by reading [11]_____ zip codes. Over the past few years, we have made dramatic [12]_____. Machine learning is now capable of far, far more complex tasks. In 2012, Kaggle challenged its community to build a program that could grade high school [13]_____. The winning programs were able to match the grades given by human teachers. Now, given the right data, machines are going to [14]_____ humans at tasks like this. A teacher might read 10,000 [15]_____ over a 40-year career. A machine can read millions of [16]_____ within minutes, we have no chance of competing against machines on frequent, high-volume tasks. But there are things we can do that machines cannot. Where machines have made very little progress is in [17]_____ novel situations. Machines can't handle things they haven't seen many times before, the fundamental [18]_____ of machine learning is that it needs to learn from large volumes of past data, but humans don't. We have the ability to connect [19]_____ different threads to solve problems we've never seen before.

Recording Two 第 19—21 题

We've talked recently about the importance of [1]_____ energy. We've also talked about the different theories on how that can be done. So far, our discussions have all been [2]_____. Now I have a practical question for you all: Can you run a 140,000 [3]_____ train on just the steam generated by solar power? Well, one engineer, Tim Castleman, believes it's possible, and his home city of Sacramento, California, should see the technology's first test as part of the upgrading of its rail yard, Castleman, who is an inventor and self-proclaimed steam visionary, is campaigning for a new steam train that runs without any fire and could run on an existing 10-kilometer line, drawing tourists and perhaps offering city commuters a green alternative to their cars, Castleman wants to build an array of solar [4]_____ mirrors at one end of the line to collect

and focus heat onto water-filled tubes. This would [5]_____ steam that could be used to fill tanks on a small steam train without the use of fire. Supplying power to trains in this way would offer the shortest distance from well to wheels, he says, with the least amount of energy lost. According to Harry Valentine, a Canadian engineer who is researching modern steam technology, a special tank measuring two by 10 meters could store over 750 [6]_____ hours of energy as high-pressure steam, enough to pull a two-car train for an hour or so. Energy to drive a steam [7]_____ can be stored in other materials besides water. For example, a team at Tohoku University in Japan has studied materials that can store large amounts of heat. When heated, these materials turn from a solid into a liquid, [8]_____ energy as they change phase. The [9]_____ is maintained above its melting point until steam is required, at which point the liquid is allowed to turn back into a solid, releasing its stored energy. Another team at Nagoya University in Japan has tested [10]_____ compound as an energy storage material. Heating this chemical compound drives off carbon dioxide gas, leaving calcium [11]_____. The gas can be stored under pressure in a [12]_____. To recover the energy, the gas is fed back over the calcium [13]_____. In theory, says Valentine, this can create a high enough temperature to generate [14]_____ steam.

Recording Three 第 22—25 题

Today's [1]_____ in care for older people in England has two main causes. First, people are living longer with a lot more complex needs. Second, they rely on a system that has long been marked by a poor [2]_____ between national health and social care services. Current services originate in two key measures; they are the National Health Service and the 1948 National [3]_____ Act. This required local governments to provide residential accommodation for older people and [4]_____ care homes run by independent organizations. They also provided home and community services, including meals, day centres, and home helpers, and other [5]_____ services. The National Health Service was free and [6]_____ publicly provided. It delivered the best healthcare for all. No such vision guided [7]_____ and community care, though. The care was substantially provided by voluntary services, which worked together with local authorities as they long had with [8]_____ based on income. Today, life expectancy has risen from 66 for a male at birth in 1948 to around 80 now. In addition, there is better overall health and improved medical knowledge and

care. This means an [9]_____ number of people are surviving longer in conditions requiring expert support. Families provide at least as much care as they ever did. Even so, they can really, without [10]_____ support, address serious personal needs. Care for older people faced [11]_____ criticism as these trends became apparent. From the early 1960s, local authorities were required to plan health and [12]_____ services. The aim was to enable older people to remain in their own homes for as long as possible, but this increased concern about the lack of [13]_____ between free health and paid-for social care. Through the 1970s, a number of measures [14]_____ to improve matters. However, at a time of financial crisis, funding [15]_____ and little changed. In the 1980s, the government cut spending. Meanwhile, [16]_____ for private over public services made management even more difficult. [17]_____, the number of sick older people grew. Governments emphasized the need to improve services. They did so, though, while doing little to stop the [18]_____ of available aid. Services were [19]_____ across authorities, unless you were prepared to pay they were increasingly difficult to obtain for any but the most severely disabled. Why has 60 years of [20]_____ produced so little change? [21]_____ against older people has a long history. Additionally, those affected by [22]_____ health and social care are too vulnerable to launch the protests that have addressed other forms of discrimination.